

CITY: PG 3

CM Rekha's surprise tribute to nurses



NATION: PG 5

Oppn attacks govt after NEET-UG cancellation, demands overhaul of NTA



FILM: PG 14

Sonakshi Sinha reflects on her evolving choices



PM-led panel meets to decide on next CBI Director; Rahul questions fairness of procedure

AAISHA SABIR

NEW DELHI: A high-level panel chaired by Prime Minister Narendra Modi met on Tuesday evening to decide on the next Director of the Central Bureau of Investigation, with the selection process drawing sharp disagreement from within the committee itself. The meeting, held at the prime minister's 7, Lok Kalyan Marg residence, included Chief Justice of India Surya Kant and Leader of Opposition Rahul Gandhi. It lasted for over an hour, though no official statement on the deliberations was issued. Sources indicated that an announcement on the appointment is expected soon, as the tenure of incumbent director Praveen Sood ends on May 24, 2026.

The committee is tasked with finalising the appointment from a panel of senior Indian Police Service officers. Names understood to be under consideration include Parag Jain, Shatrueet Kapoor, Yogesh Gupta, G P Singh and Praveen Ranjan, among others drawn from different states.

However, the meeting was marked by a strong dissent from Gandhi, who submitted a two-page note objecting to the manner in which the selection process was conducted. He alleged that the procedure had been reduced to a "mere formality" and declined to endorse what he described as a "biased exercise."

"By denying the Selection Committee crucial information, the government has reduced it to a mere formality."

Continued on P4

CBI takes over probe into Bengal CM Suwendu aide's murder

MPOST BUREAU

KOLKATA/LUCKNOW: The investigation into the murder of Chief Minister Suwendu Adhikari's personal assistant Chandranath Rath was taken over by the Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI) on Tuesday following a recommendation from the West Bengal government.

According to sources, the CBI has formed a seven-member Special Investigation Team (SIT), headed by Deputy Inspector General (DIG) Pan-kaj Kumar Singh, to probe the murder. The team reached Kolkata on Tuesday afternoon and visited Doharia in Madhyamgram around 3.30 pm. After making brief inquiries, the officers left the area.

Sources said the SIT investigation will be supervised by the Joint Director of the CBI in Kolkata, who may also induct officers from the Kolkata unit of the agency as required for the probe.

Continued on P4

Retail inflation rises to 3.48% in Apr on food, jewellery price surge

Trend shows gradual rise

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: Retail inflation edged up to 3.48 per cent in April, driven largely by rising prices of precious metals and select food items, according to data released on Tuesday by the National Statistics Office.

The Consumer Price Index-based inflation, calculated with a 2024 base year, had stood at 3.40 per cent in March, 3.21 per cent in February and 2.74 per cent in January, indicating a gradual firming up of price pressures over recent months.

Food inflation also rose to 4.20 per cent in April from 3.87 per cent in March, reflecting increases in key kitchen staples.

Among individual items, silver jewellery recorded the sharpest price rise at 144.34 per cent, followed by coconut copra at 44.55 per cent and gold, diamond and platinum jewellery at 40.72 per cent. Prices of vegetables such as tomato, which rose 35.28 per cent, and cauliflower, up 25.58 per cent, also contributed to the uptick.

However, some relief came from falling prices in items including potato, onion, peas, motor cars and jeeps, as well as air-conditioners, according to the official data.

Regionally, inflation remained higher in rural areas at 3.74 per cent compared to 3.16 per cent in urban centres. State-wise, Telangana recorded the highest inflation at 5.81 per cent, while Mizoram saw the lowest at 0.69 per cent.

Continued on P4

Regionally, inflation remained higher in rural areas at 3.74 per cent compared to 3.16 per cent in urban centres

NEET-UG 2026 cancelled over paper leak, CBI registers FIR

WE TAKE RESPONSIBILITY; PROCESS TO HOLD NEET-UG RE-EXAM TO BEGIN IN 7-10 DAYS, SAYS NTA DG

NARESH BISWANI

NEW DELHI: The National Testing Agency (NTA) on Tuesday cancelled the NEET-UG 2026 examination conducted on May 3, citing allegations of a question paper leak and other irregularities, casting doubts over the future of nearly 22.79 lakh aspirants into uncertainty.

The NTA failed to provide concrete details on the alleged leak or clarity on the re-examination schedule during its media briefing, drawing sharp criticism from protesting students and opposition parties that demanded accountability from the Centre.

In a damage control exercise, the government moved swiftly, asking the Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI) to register an FIR. The premier probe agency of the government was asked to carry out a comprehensive inquiry into the "irregularities".

The NTA, which conducts the exam for admission to undergraduate courses in medical colleges, said fresh dates will be notified in the "next seven to 10 days".

The cancellation triggered nationwide outrage among medical aspirants, with students raising questions on NTA's competence and demanding that the exam be conducted by AIIMS-Delhi.

The Opposition also attacked the Centre, alleging administrative failure, insensitivity toward students and "repeated lapses" in the conduct of national-level competitive examinations. It also demanded an overhaul of the NTA.

Continued on P4



SFI activists scuffle with security personnel during a protest demanding cancellation of NEET-UG 2026 over the alleged paper leak and admission scam, in Thiruvananthapuram, on Tuesday

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CBI PROBING ORGANISED RACKET, INSIDER ROLE

KEY POINTS

- » Question paper circulated in advance via closed, one-to-one networks
- » Early access copies reportedly moved from Nashik to Sikar, then nationwide
- » Distribution chain linked to coaching centres across Delhi, Bihar, Kerala, J&K, Uttarakhand
- » Telegram and private messaging used for discreet sharing of papers
- » Sold from Rs 30,000 up to Rs 28 lakh
- » "Guess paper" of 410 questions created; 120 later matched actual exam
- » Paper circulated nearly 10-15 days before May 3 test date

WHAT HAPPENS NEXT? HERE'S WHAT STUDENTS NEED TO KNOW

» THE CANCELLATION OF NEET-UG 2026 HAS LEFT MORE THAN 22 LAKH ASPIRANTS AWAITING CLARITY ON THE NEXT STEPS. HERE IS WHAT IS KNOWN SO FAR.

» QJ WHEN WILL THE RE-EXAM BE HELD?

The fresh schedule has not yet been announced. NTA Director General Abhishek Singh said dates will be declared within the next seven to 10 days. He added the agency aims to hold the exam at the earliest to avoid disruption to admissions.

» QJ WILL STUDENTS HAVE TO REGISTER AGAIN?

No. The National Testing Agency confirmed that candidature and registration data from the May 2026 cycle will remain valid.

» QJ WILL CANDIDATES HAVE TO PAY THE EXAMINATION FEE AGAIN?

No additional fee will be charged. The agency said fees already paid will be refunded.

» QJ WILL FRESH ADMIT CARDS BE ISSUED?

Yes. The NTA stated that the schedule for re-issued admit cards will be shared through official channels.

» QJ WILL STUDENTS GET THE SAME EXAMINATION CENTRES?

Centres selected earlier will be carried forward, though clarity on possible changes in allotment is awaited.

» QJ HOW WILL THE EXAM BE CONDUCTED?

The NTA said it will reconduct the exam using its internal resources.

» QJ WHAT SHOULD STUDENTS DO NOW?

Candidates have been advised to follow only official updates and ignore unverified social media reports.

4 MLAs SWORN IN AS MINISTERS

NDA begins 3rd term in Assam as Himanta Sarma takes oath as CM

OUR CORRESPONDENT

GUWAHATI: The BJP-led National Democratic Alliance (NDA) began its third consecutive term in Assam on Tuesday, with Himanta Biswa Sarma sworn in again as chief minister at a ceremony attended by top national leaders. Assam Governor Lakshman Prasad Acharya administered the oath of office to Sarma and four ministers. Prime Minister Narendra Modi, Union Home Minister Amit Shah, and senior Union ministers including Rajnath Singh, Nitin Gadkari, Sarbananda Sonowal and Pabitra Margherita were present. Chief ministers and deputy chief ministers from BJP-ruled states, along with state BJP president Nitin Nabin, also attended.

In a post on X, Modi described the occasion as a "great day for Assam" and congratulated Sarma on starting his second term. He said the chief minister had distinguished himself as a "wonderful administrator" and noted his contribution to the state's progress.



Prime Minister Narendra Modi with newly sworn-in Assam Chief Minister Himanta Biswa Sarma during the swearing-in ceremony of the state government, at Khanapara in Guwahati, on Tuesday

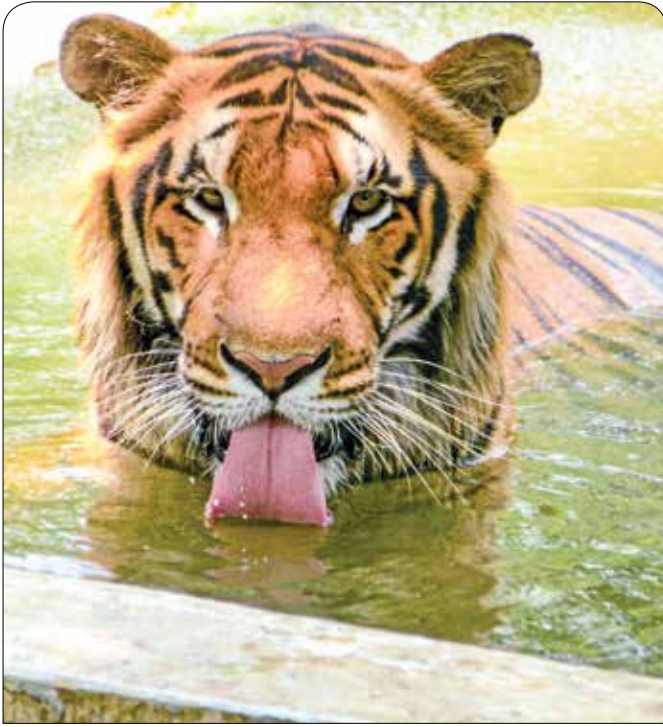
PTI

gratulated Sarma on starting his second term. He said the chief minister had distinguished himself as a "wonderful administrator" and noted his contribution to the state's progress.

Sarma, dressed in traditional attire with a gamosa draped around his neck, took the oath in Assamese. Calling it an emotional moment, he said, "With all

Continued on P4

COOLS HIMSELF OFF



Tiger 'Bagheera' cools off himself in a water pond inside the enclosures of Kanpur Zoological Park, in Kanpur, Uttar Pradesh, on Tuesday

PTI

COURT CRITICISES REPEATED PLEAS STALLING DEVELOPMENT PROJECTS

Show us a single project welcomed by environmentalists, green lobby: SC

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: The Supreme Court has refused to entertain a plea challenging the expansion of Pipavav Port in Gujarat, while raising sharp questions about repeated litigation against infrastructure projects and its impact on the country's progress.

Hearing an appeal against a decision of the National Green Tribunal, a bench led by Chief Justice Surya Kant and Justice Joymalya Bagchi said courts cannot be used to stall development at every stage. "Show us even a single project in this country where these environmental activists have said we welcome this project," the bench remarked, adding that such litigation sends a concerning message about the



COURT SAID ECONOMIC CONCERNS NOT PART OF EIA REVIEW

intent behind these challenges.

The case relates to the expansion and modernisation of Pipavav Port, which had received environmental and coastal regulation zone clearances. The tribunal's western zone bench had

earlier dismissed a plea seeking to quash these approvals, relying on findings from the Environmental Impact Assessment report and other studies.

Senior advocate Anitha Shenoy, appearing for the petitioner,

argued that the project posed risks to marine biodiversity and local livelihoods. She pointed to concerns involving Olive Ridley turtles, marine mammals, avian species and mangroves, and said the project had been

CLOSER LOOK

- » Case challenged environmental clearance for Pipavav Port expansion
- » Court said infrastructure is essential for national growth
- » Judges questioned feasibility of ports outside Gujarat's coastline
- » EIA report found no significant environmental impact
- » Studies showed no turtle nesting at project site
- » Counsel cited risks to marine life, mangroves, birds
- » Counsel said 90% fish landings occur near Saurashtra coast

stalled for over a decade before being cleared. She also told the court that nearly 90 per cent of fish landings along the Saurashtra coast take place near the port, warning that expansion could severely affect fisherfolk and related economic activity.

The bench, however, said such economic concerns are not central to environmental impact assessments. Justice Bagchi noted that the Expert Appraisal Committee had examined claims about turtle nesting and found them to be incorrect. Referring to inspection findings, he said the report clearly indicated that the project site is not a turtle nesting ground. The court added that occasional sightings of marine species cannot be taken as proof of nesting habitats.

Continued on P4

'India has 2 months of fuel, but OMC losses could hit Rs 1 lakh cr'

Puri says there is 'no cause for anxiety'

SIMONTINI BHATTACHARJEE

NEW DELHI: India has sufficient fuel reserves for about two months and faces no immediate supply concerns despite disruptions in global energy flows, Petroleum Minister Hardeep Singh Puri said on Tuesday. However, he cautioned that prolonged high crude prices combined with unchanged retail fuel rates could inflict heavy financial losses on state-run oil companies.

Speaking at the Confederation of Indian Industry's annual summit, Puri said the country entered the current geopolitical crisis with strong inventories and has since strengthened domestic production. "We have no supply-side problems," he said, noting that LPG output has increased to 54,000 tonnes per day from around 36,000 tonnes earlier.

Even as supplies remain stable, financial pressures are mounting on public sector oil marketing companies, including Indian Oil Corporation, Bharat Petroleum Corporation Limited and Hindustan Petroleum Corporation Limited. These firms have continued selling petrol, diesel and cooking gas below cost since the outbreak of conflict in West Asia about 10 weeks ago.

Puri said the companies are losing around Rs 1,000 crore daily, with cumulative under-recoveries nearing Rs 1.98 lakh crore for the current quarter. Actual losses are estimated at about Rs 1 lakh crore, a figure



TAKEAWAYS

- » Domestic LPG production increased to 54,000 tonnes/day from 36,000 tonnes/day
- » Oil companies losing Rs 1,000 crore per day
- » Under-recoveries near Rs 1.98 lakh crore; actual quarterly loss about Rs 1 lakh crore
- » Losses in one quarter could wipe out annual profits of oil companies
- » Fuel prices unchanged for four years despite 50% rise in crude prices

he said could erase their annual profits. "How long will the oil companies be able to take it... frankly, that's something that worries me," he said.

Retail fuel prices have not been revised for four years, even as global crude prices have surged by about 50 per cent. Petrol is currently priced at Rs 94.77 per litre and diesel at Rs 87.67 per litre, while LPG cylinder

Continued on P4

AIADMK rebel MLAs challenge EPS leadership, extend support to ruling TVK

MPOST BUREAU

CHENNAI: A political churn gripped Tamil Nadu on Tuesday as a section of the opposition All India Anna Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam broke ranks and announced support for the ruling coalition led by Chief Minister C Joseph Vijay ahead of a crucial floor test, intensifying pressure on party chief Edappadi K Palaniswami and raising the prospect of a split.

The dissident camp, led by senior figures SP Velumani and C Ve Shanmugam, said around 30 MLAs had backed the move and would formally submit a letter of support to Vijay. The development follows the party's poor showing in the April 23 Assembly election, where it secured 47 of the 164 seats it contested.

Shanmugam cited repeated electoral setbacks, including three defeats to the Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam and a recent loss to Vijay's Tamilaga Vettri Kazhagam, as reasons for the shift. "We need to revive the party and discuss its future," he said, urging the leadership to convene a general council meeting.

At the centre of the rebellion is an allegation that Palaniswami explored a post-poll arrangement with the DMK, a claim strongly denied by both parties. Shanmugam argued that any such alliance would contradict the AIADMK's founding principles. "We founded this party against the DMK. For decades, our politics has been opposed to it. If such an alliance had materialised, the party would not survive," he said.

The DMK leadership rejected the charge, reiterating that it would sit in the opposition.

Continued on P4

WORTH RS 72 CRORE

Police destroys 1,700 kg drug haul, announces dedicated ANTF station

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Delhi Police on Tuesday destroyed nearly 1,700 kilograms of seized narcotics worth around Rs 72 crore and announced the setting up of the capital's first dedicated Anti-Narcotics Task Force police station, officials said.

The ninth mega drug destruction event was led by Delhi Lieutenant Governor Taranjit Singh Sandhu in the presence of Delhi Police Commissioner Satish Golcha and senior police officers at a waste disposal facility in north Delhi.

According to police, the destruction exercise was part of Delhi Police's "zero tolerance" policy against narcotics and an ongoing crackdown on drug traffickers, peddlers and organised drug syndicates operating in the national capital.

"The destroyed contraband included around 1,610 kilograms of cannabis, 21 kilograms of charas, 11 kilo-



grams of heroin, 591 grams of cocaine, 21 kilograms of cannabis sativa and 30 kilograms of Alprazolam tablets seized by the crime branch and south district police units," a senior police officer said.

Addressing the gathering, Sandhu said the event was not merely about destroying narcotic substances but about dismantling an ecosystem that

threatens the youth and harms society. He said the initiative reflected the vision of Prime Minister Narendra Modi for a 'Drug-Free India' and the Union government's resolve to curb narcotics trafficking across the country.

The L-G also lauded the Delhi Police for its sustained anti-drug operations and called upon citizens and all stakehold-

HIGHLIGHTS

» Addressing the gathering, Sandhu said the event was not merely about destroying narcotic substances but about dismantling an ecosystem that threatens the youth, harms society

» He said the initiative reflected the vision of PM Modi for a 'Drug-Free India' and the Union government's resolve to curb narcotics trafficking

ers to join the campaign against substance abuse.

"With Tuesday's destruction exercise, Delhi Police has so far destroyed approximately 46,500 kilograms of narcotics worth an estimated Rs 13,830 crore in the international market since the launch of the anti-drug drive," the officer said.

The force has conducted multiple destruction drives

over the past three years, including destruction of more than 15,700 kg drugs in June 2023 and over 10,600 kg in February 2024 and December 2024. The Delhi Police said it has intensified financial investigations against narcotics networks and seized assets worth over Rs 11.25 crore this year. Data shared by the police showed that 1,129 cases under the NDPS Act were registered in Delhi till April 30 this year, leading to the arrest of 1,397 alleged drug traffickers and peddlers.

Police also said detention orders under the PITNDPS Act had been issued against nine alleged drug peddlers, while proposals against 48 repeat offenders involved in narco-smuggling were under process.

The event was organised at Biotic Waste Solutions Pvt Ltd near the Jahangirpuri Metro station in compliance with Supreme Court-mandated procedures for disposal of seized narcotics.

Cops return 12,600 stolen and lost phones to owners

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Delhi Police on Tuesday handed over more than 12,600 stolen and lost mobile phones to their rightful owners under its special initiative 'Operation Vishwas', officials said.

The phones were returned during a program held at the Multi-Purpose Hall of Delhi University's North Campus in the presence of Lieutenant Governor Taranjit Singh Sandhu and Delhi Police Commissioner Satish Golcha.

According to the police, more than 19,000 mobile phones have been recovered in the last 45 days with the help of the Central Equipment Identity Register (CEIR) portal, pushing the recovery rate of stolen and lost phones to 74 per cent in 2026, compared to 12 per cent in 2025 and five per cent in 2024. "Dedicated police teams across all districts worked for the last few months to trace and recover the devices, travelling to several states during the operation," a senior police officer said.

Addressing the gathering, the L-G praised Delhi Police for launching the initiative



“Dedicated teams across all dists worked for the last few months to recover the devices, travelling to several states during the op”

and said the recovery drive reflected a more citizen-centric and technology-enabled policing system.

"The smile on a citizen's face and the confidence in the system is the real success of this initiative," he said, adding that the operation also sent a message to offenders that police systems were becoming smarter, faster and more connected.

Delhi Police Chief Satish Golcha said the primary aim

of Delhi Police was not limited to registering complaints but ensuring action that leads to recovery and restoration of stolen property.

"Behind every recovered phone lies countless hours of effort, coordination and dedication of police teams," he said.

During the programme, the L-G also inaugurated a traffic exhibition van aimed at spreading awareness about road safety and launched a traffic safety guide booklet.

Temple theft kingpin held

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Delhi Police Crime Branch has arrested an alleged inter-state temple theft kingpin and proclaimed offender wanted in multiple cases across Punjab, Kerala and Karnataka, officials said on Tuesday.

The accused, identified as Mohit Sharma alias Mama (44), a resident of Aligarh in Uttar Pradesh, had been absconding for a long period and was declared a proclaimed offender by a Punjab court in connection with a temple theft case registered at City Khanna police station.

According to police, Sharma specialised in targeting temples and religious places in isolated or poorly guarded areas. He allegedly stole silver idols, donation box collections, religious ornaments and other valuables, while frequently changing hideouts and travelling across states to evade arrest. Police said he was wanted in several temple theft cases registered in Kozhikode and Ernakulam in Kerala, Karwar Town in Karnataka, and Punjab. Acting on a tip-off regarding his movement in Delhi, a Crime Branch team laid a trap near Patiala House Court on May 11 and apprehended him after a brief chase.

During interrogation, Sharma allegedly revealed that he was introduced to temple thefts by an associate while working at a dairy in his village.

Investigators said Sharma has a long criminal history, with cases related to theft, robbery, arms offences and gangster activities registered against him in several states.

Hry man nabbed for abducting & assaulting Excise dept staffer

PRAJYOT DEOGHARE

NEW DELHI: The Delhi Police Crime Branch has arrested a man in connection with the alleged abduction and assault of an on-duty Excise Department official, police said on Tuesday.

The accused, identified as Sahab Singh (34), a resident of Sonapat in Haryana, was wanted in a case registered at Shalimar Bagh police station earlier this year.

According to police, the incident took place on the intervening night of February 22 and 23, when the complainant, an Excise Department staff member, was performing official duty.

Singh and his associates allegedly assaulted the official and forcibly abducted him in an i10 car. Investigators said the victim was taken to Bahalgarh in Haryana, where he was assaulted again inside a liquor warehouse.

An FIR was registered on February 23 under multiple sections of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita pertaining to abduction, assault and obstruction of



“The operation was carried out under the supervision of ACP Ramesh Chander and Inspector Kamal Kumar”

a public servant from discharging official duty.

Police said three accused had earlier been arrested in the case, while Singh had evaded arrest for several months despite repeated raids. Proceedings under Section 84 of the Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita were subsequently initiated against him by a court.

Acting on a tip-off regarding his movement towards Khatu Shyam, a Crime Branch

team laid a trap near Dhaura Kuan bus stand and apprehended him on May 11 at around 10.30 am.

The operation was carried out under the supervision of ACP Ramesh Chander and Inspector Kamal Kumar, police said.

During investigation, police found Singh had played an active role in the alleged abduction and assault. Officials added that he is a habitual offender and has been involved in five criminal cases in Delhi and Haryana, including cases related to human trafficking, rape, kidnapping, assault and excise violations.

The accused was produced before a court, formally arrested and remanded to judicial custody.

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: A 28-year-old newlywed woman was found stuffed inside a bed box in a rented room in central Delhi's Nabi Karim area, police said on Tuesday, adding that her husband remains absconding.

The police said the absconding husband is now the prime suspect, as an allegation of dowry harassment had also surfaced.

The incident came to light on the night of May 8 when police received a PCR call from a landlord in the Laxmanpuri area about a foul smell emanating from a tenant's room, police said.

"A police team rushed to the spot and found the decomposed body of the woman lying on a bed inside the room. The deceased is a native of Haldwani in Uttarakhand, aged around 28 years," a senior police officer said.

During an inquiry, police learnt that the woman had married Mohammad Ejaz, a resident of Vaishali district in Bihar, on April 26, and the couple moved into the Laxminagar house shortly

‘Family members of both the deceased woman and the accused are being questioned to ascertain the sequence of events’

after the marriage.

Police said both the victim and the accused belonged to the same community and had recently started living together in the Nabi Karim area.

"The husband was missing from the room when the body was recovered. He has not been arrested so far. An FIR was registered at Nabi Karim police station, and an investigation has been initiated," the officer added.

During the probe, the woman's father levelled allegations of dowry harassment against Ejaz and his brother Sarfaraz, police said.

Following the allegations, Sarfaraz was arrested, while teams are conducting raids to trace Ejaz.

Police said multiple teams

have been formed and are examining CCTV footage to reconstruct the couple's movements in the days leading up to the woman's death.

According to police sources, the couple's documents are being verified, along with the identification submitted to the landlord at the time of taking the accommodation. Police said technical surveillance and local intelligence inputs are also being used to track the accused.

"Raids are being conducted at several locations linked to the accused, including his relatives' houses and native place," the officer said.

Family members of both the deceased woman and the accused are being questioned to ascertain the sequence of events after the marriage and to verify claims related to alleged dowry harassment, he added.

Police sources said investigators have obtained some important leads regarding the movements and possible hideouts of the accused, and expressed confidence that he would be arrested soon.

Woman strangled, body found hidden under neighbour's bed in Gurugram

GURUGRAM: A 22-year-old woman was allegedly strangled to death in a village near Manesar, with her body later found hidden under a bed in a neighbour's room, police said on Tuesday. The victim, identified as Soni, a native of Uttar Pradesh's Rae Bareilly, worked for a private company in Gurugram and lived in a rented accommodation in Shankar Ki Dhani village along with two other women, they said.

Police said the body was discovered around 12.30 am on Tuesday under the bed of a young man staying in an adjacent room. The accused has been absconding since the incident. The police suspect the man murdered Soni and concealed her body in an attempt to evade detection. Police teams collected forensic evidence from the spot.

MPOST

AIIMS hosts 51st convocation at Bharat Mandapam

NEW DELHI: The 51st Convocation Ceremony of All India Institute of Medical Sciences, New Delhi was held at Bharat Mandapam on Tuesday, where over 300 students from various medical and healthcare disciplines were conferred degrees in the presence of distinguished dignitaries, faculty members and healthcare professionals.



Addressing the ceremony, Vice President CP Radhakrishnan praised AIIMS for emerging as the country's leading centre for medical innovation and healthcare excellence. He said the institution was no longer merely pursuing international benchmarks but was now establishing them through its achievements

in research, patient care and medical education. Highlighting AIIMS' contribution to affordable healthcare, the VP said the institute had become synonymous with trust and integrity. He lauded the institution for maintaining high academic standards while efficiently managing an enormous patient load.

MPOST

Noida Airport gets Akasa Air services

DIPIKA KIROLA

NOIDA: Noida International Airport is steadily expanding its flight network ahead of the start of commercial operations, with Akasa Air announcing daily direct flights to Bengaluru and Navi Mumbai from June 16. The announcement comes a day after IndiGo confirmed its inaugural service from the airport on June 15.

Akasa Air has opened ticket bookings for the two routes through its website, mobile applications and online travel portals. The airline will operate daily non-stop flights connecting the Jewar airport with Bengaluru and Navi Mumbai. The services are expected to improve connectivity for passengers from Noida, Greater Noida, Ghaziabad and western Uttar Pradesh, while easing pressure on Delhi's Indira Gandhi International Airport.

Ticket prices from the new airport are currently higher than fares for similar routes operating from Delhi. Aviation analysts attribute the higher fares to airport user charges and operational costs associated with the greenfield airport project. Despite Uttar Pradesh offering lower aviation turbine fuel tax compared to Delhi, the higher airport charges are likely to keep fares at par with or above those from IGI Air-



port during the initial phase of operations.

IndiGo is scheduled to operate the first commercial flight to the airport from Lucknow on June 15 and plans to gradually launch services on multiple domestic routes. With Akasa Air becoming the second airline to announce operations.

Anand Srinivasan, co-founder and chief commercial officer of Akasa Air, said the expansion aligns with the rapid growth of India's aviation market. He added that Noida airport's modern infrastructure, multimodal connectivity and long-term expansion capacity would significantly transform access to the National Capital Region.

Akasa Air currently operates flights to 27 domestic and seven international destinations and is expected to further expand its network from Jewar in the coming months.

GOKALPURI

Juveniles apprehended after two men stabbed

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Delhi Police has apprehended two juveniles in connection with the stabbing of two people in north-east Delhi's Gokalpuri area over an old dispute, an official said on Tuesday. The two juveniles, both aged 17 years, were apprehended in connection with the attempt-to-murder case registered after the attack took place on Monday evening, he said.

During sustained questioning, the accused said an old dispute with the victims had led to the attack. "At their instance, two knives used in the offence were also recovered," the police officer said.

The stabbing incident was reported near a dairy outlet in the Gokalpuri area on Monday. By the time police reached the spot, the injured had already



The accused said an old dispute with the victims had led to the attack

been rushed to the GTB Hospital. The victims were identified as Rahul (18) and Vijay (23), both residents of Sanjay Colony in Gokalpuri.

Further investigation in the case is underway, police said.

SUSAN ELIAS TO HEAD VARSITY

St Stephen's College appoints first woman principal in 145-yr history

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Delhi University's St Stephen's College on Tuesday appointed Professor Susan Elias as its first woman principal since its inception in 1881, according to official notification.

The official notification read, "The Supreme Council of the college is pleased to announce that Prof Susan Elias will take charge as the XIV (14th) Principal of the College and as its first lady Principal, effective June 1, 2026."

It was signed by Rt Revd Dr Paul Swarup, Bishop of Delhi and chairman of the college.

According to Elias's LinkedIn profile, she served as the pro vice chancellor (research) at Chandigarh University,

“The principal's post has officially been vacant since March 1, 2026”

situated in Lucknow, Uttar Pradesh, from January to May 2026. Before that, she served as the director of research at Hindustan University between October 2024 and December 2025. She has also served in several roles at Vellore Institute of Technology, including professor and dean of the School of Electronics Engineering, professor and deputy director at the Centre for Advanced Data Science, and associate professor and head of the School of Electronics Engineering.

St Stephen's College was founded on February 1, 1881, by the Cambridge Mission to

Delhi in collaboration with the Society for the Propagation of the Gospel, with Samuel Scott Allnutt serving as its founder and first principal.

According to the College's website, it was established after the closure of Delhi College in 1879, and it initially operated from rented premises in Chandni Chowk before shifting to Kashmere Gate in 1891 and later to its present campus in the Delhi University enclave in 1941. Malay Neerav, dean of academics and head of the History department at St Stephen's College, said that the college already has a rich repository

of history, and now it is set to have its first woman principal.

"A similar landmark event took place in 1906, when Susil Kumar Rudra became the first Indian to become principal of the college," she said. Neerav said, "Interestingly, Mahatma Gandhi used to stay at Rudra's house, and the non-cooperation movement was conceived there as well." According to professors and officials at the college, who wish to remain anonymous, the principal's post has officially been vacant since March 1, 2026, after the 13th principal, John Varghese, completed his term in February.

Administrative disputes persisted as Varghese continued acting principal despite post remaining officially vacant for months.

CM Rekha’s surprise tribute to nurses

International Nurses Day: Announces 27-fold stipend hike for LNJP Hospital nursing interns

AIMAN FATIMA

NEW DELHI: In a heart-warming gesture ahead of International Nurses Day, Chief Minister Rekha Gupta made an unannounced visit to Lok Nayak Jai Prakash Hospital on Tuesday, interacting with nurses, appreciating their contribution to healthcare and boosting their morale through personal conversations and gestures of gratitude.

Walking through different wards of LNJP Hospital, the Chief Minister met nursing staff on duty, listened to their experiences and acknowledged the challenges they face while caring for patients round the clock. She also presented flowers to nurses as a mark of respect, a gesture that left many staff members emotional. Several nurses clicked selfies with the Chief Minister and described the interaction as a memorable moment in their professional lives.



Addressing the nursing staff during the visit, Rekha Gupta said, “Nursing is not merely a profession but a reflection of compassion, humanity and service.” She added, “Doctors provide treatment, but it is nurses who give patients emotional strength and care that often helps them heal.” The Chief Minister praised the dedication and patience shown by nurses even under difficult circumstances, saying their service forms the backbone of Delhi’s healthcare system. She also interacted with nurses from different states, including Kerala, Rajasthan and Punjab, and acknowledged their contribution towards strengthening healthcare services in the Capital.

“Nurses from across the country have helped make Delhi’s healthcare system world-class,” the Chief Minister said,

HIGHLIGHTS

» ‘Nursing is not merely a profession but a reflection of compassion, humanity and service’

» Delhi government has implemented a 27-fold increase in the stipend for nursing interns after a wait of 27 years

» The stipend has been raised from Rs 500 to Rs 13,150, benefiting around 180 nursing interns

adding that healthcare workers from different regions have collectively elevated medical care standards in Delhi hospitals.

During the interaction, the Chief Minister also announced a major decision regarding nursing interns. She said the Delhi government has implemented

a 27-fold increase in the stipend for nursing interns after a wait of 27 years. The stipend has been raised from Rs 500 to Rs 13,150, benefiting around 180 nursing interns.

In another major development, the government has also distributed appointment letters to 1,388 nursing officers and 41 paramedical staff members to strengthen healthcare services in the capital. Reaffirming the government’s commitment to healthcare workers, Rekha Gupta said the Delhi Government is focused on improving the work culture and safeguarding the rights of nurses and medical staff. “Respecting nursing staff, who work tirelessly day and night in service of patients, is the shared responsibility of both the government and society,” she said.

Extending greetings on International Nurses Day, the CM wished nurses good health, strength and continued success in their service to humanity.



Assam gets Himanta 2.0; CM attends oath

OUR CIRRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Chief Minister Rekha Gupta on Tuesday attended the swearing-in ceremony of Himanta Biswa Sarma in Guwahati and congratulated him on assuming office for a second consecutive term as Assam Chief Minister.

Calling the BJP’s victory in Assam a “historic mandate”, Rekha Gupta said the result reflected the people’s trust in Himanta Biswa Sarma’s leadership and commitment to governance and public service. “The people have once again endorsed the politics of development, stability and national interest,” she said.

The Chief Minister noted that Assam has witnessed rapid progress in infrastructure, governance, tourism, investment and public welfare in recent years. She said that under Himanta Biswa Sarma’s leadership, the state has emerged as a major development model for the Northeast.

Rekha Gupta also credited Prime Minister Narendra Modi for bringing the Northeast into the mainstream of India’s development journey. She said Assam is seeing significant growth in connectivity, education, employment and tourism while contributing strongly to the vision of a “Viksit Bharat”.

During her visit, the Delhi Chief Minister also offered prayers at the revered Kamakhya Temple along with Baglamukhi Temple and Umananda Temple. She performed traditional rituals and prayed for the nation’s peace, prosperity and overall development.

“The people of Assam have once again endorsed the politics of development, good governance and public service,” Rekha Gupta said while expressing gratitude for the BJP’s third consecutive electoral victory in the state.

She also expressed confidence that Assam would continue to achieve new milestones of development while preserving its rich cultural heritage over the next five years.

“The people have once again endorsed the politics of development, stability and national interest

Delhi Assembly backs Uniform Legislative Rules across India: Speaker Gupta

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Delhi Legislative Assembly Speaker Vijender Gupta on Tuesday strongly supported the proposal for a Uniform Model of Rules of Procedure and Conduct of Business for legislative bodies across the country, calling it a major democratic reform aimed at improving transparency, accountability and efficiency in legislative functioning.

Speaking at the preliminary meeting of the Committee of Presiding Officers in Mysore, Karnataka, Gupta said harmonised legislative procedures had become an “institutional necessity” in the era of digital governance and technology-driven legislatures.

“Uniformity in legislative procedures is no longer merely desirable; it has become an institutional necessity in the era of digital legislatures and technology-driven governance,” Gupta said.

He added that harmonised rules would strengthen transparency, executive accountability and coherence across democratic institutions in India.

Delhi plans to turn 38,000 classrooms smart

AIMAN FATIMA

NEW DELHI: Stressing that education reforms must go beyond examination results and focus on creating a safe, modern and student-friendly learning environment, Delhi Education Minister Ashish Sood on Tuesday held an extensive interaction with principals and Heads of Schools (HoS) from Zone-1 and Zone-2 of East Delhi.

The dialogue programme, organised by the Education Department at CM Shri School in Surajmal Vihar, focused on improving academic quality, infrastructure, school safety,



cleanliness, digital education and student well-being. Before reaching the venue, the minister travelled by Delhi Metro from INA to Karkardooma Court and then took an e-rickshaw to the school. Addressing principals and school heads, Sood said, “The objective of this interaction programme is to directly understand the challenges faced at the school level and make government schools more modern, empowered

and student-friendly.” Reviewing school infrastructure, the minister directed officials to strengthen classrooms, laboratories, libraries, sports facilities, toilets, drinking water arrangements and digital education systems. He announced that the Delhi government plans to convert all 38,000 classrooms in the Capital into smart classrooms.

“In the current phase, nearly 9,000 smart classrooms, 175 ICT labs, 100 language labs and 100 digital libraries are being developed,” Sood said. Highlighting improvements in board examination results, the minister said Zone-1 recorded

an increase in Class 10 results from 94.57 per cent in 2024-25 to 98.53 per cent in 2025-26, while Zone-2 improved from 89.30 per cent to 96.54 per cent. The number of schools achieving 100 per cent results also rose significantly in both zones. Sood stressed the importance of mental health and safety in schools. “Schools must not focus only on academic results but also identify stress, depression and emotional issues among students,” he said, adding that there should not be any “dark spot” in schools where any unpleasant incident could occur.

DDA rolls out AI-driven single-window system to streamline building approvals

ANAMTA FATIMA

NEW DELHI: In a significant push towards digital governance and citizen-centric urban administration, the Delhi Development Authority has launched a Single Window Clearance System under its Online Building Permit System (OBPS), aimed at simplifying and accelerating the process of obtaining building permissions in the national capital.

The initiative, introduced under the directions of Delhi Lieutenant Governor Taranjit Singh Sandhu, seeks to enhance Ease of Living and Ease of Doing Business by reducing procedural delays, limiting physical interaction with officials and bringing greater transparency to the approval mechanism.

One of the key features of the platform is the incorporation of Artificial Intelligence-based scrutiny and automated compliance checks, aimed at reducing manual intervention and operational errors.

The system also includes geo-tagged mobile inspections and instant SMS and email notifications, which officials say will improve accountability and efficiency in the approval process.

According to DDA officials, the move is expected to address long-standing complaints regarding bureaucratic delays, red tape and corruption linked to building clearances. The Lieutenant Governor’s office and senior DDA officials will periodically review the functioning and effectiveness of the system.

The reform marks a major step in modernising Delhi’s urban planning framework through technology-driven governance and streamlined public service delivery.

the approval mechanism. The newly launched platform provides an integrated digital interface through which citizens, architects, homeowners and developers can submit building plans, upload documents and apply for multiple No Objection Certificates (NOCs) through a unified online system. Applicants will also be able to track their applications in real time, pay fees online and receive digitally signed approvals without repeated visits to DDA offices.

NDMC reviews monsoon prep

ANAMTA FATIMA

NEW DELHI: New Delhi Municipal Council Vice-Chairperson Kuljeet Singh Chahal on Tuesday conducted inspections across several waterlogging-prone areas in the national capital to assess monsoon preparedness and review ongoing civic infrastructure works, including redevelopment projects at Khan Market.

Accompanied by senior officials from the civil, electrical, horticulture, health and road departments, Chahal visited Bharti Nagar, Golf Links, Tughlaq Lane and Pandara Road to evaluate preventive measures being undertaken ahead of the monsoon season. He directed officials to ensure timely completion of desilting and drainage-related works while maintaining coordination among departments for prompt response during heavy rainfall.



According to NDMC officials, the first phase of desilting operations was completed by March 31, while the second phase is expected to conclude by June 15. During the initial phase, NDMC cleaned 7,888 bell mouths, 4,833 gully traps and 8,913 manholes across multiple divisions to strengthen the drainage network and minimise waterlogging. Later, Chahal conducted a midnight inspection of sanitation and redevelopment works at Khan Market, one of the capital’s busiest commercial centres. He reviewed

night sweeping operations and assessed progress on pavement improvement, drainage works and granite flooring installation. NDMC stated that redevelopment works at the main entrance of Khan Market on Subramaniam Bharti Marg have reached nearly 95 per cent completion, while footpath and middle-lane improvement projects remain underway. Chahal said the civic body aims to improve cleanliness, accessibility and urban infrastructure in line with the vision of a modern and resilient capital city.

Delhi Mayor reviews Goyla Dairy biogas plant project, pushes for timely launch

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Delhi Mayor Pravesh Wahi on Tuesday inspected the under-construction Goyla Dairy biogas plant in Delhi’s Najafgarh area and directed officials to make the facility operational without delay ahead of its proposed July commissioning.

The mayor said the plant, which will process around 200 metric tonnes of cow dung daily, is expected to help reduce pollution and prevent untreated waste from flowing into the Yamuna river.

“The commissioning of this plant will provide relief to local residents from pollution and help curb the discharge of waste into the Yamuna River,” Wahi said during the inspection.

He added that the project would be a “significant step towards environmental conservation, waste management and improvement of sanitation” and would support efforts to transform Delhi into a “clean and green capital”. According to civic officials, nearly 1,500 dairies operate in the Nangli and Goyla areas, generating large quantities of cow dung that often enter drains connected to the Najafgarh drain and the Yamuna river.

The mayor directed officials and executing agencies to complete all pending construction work on priority and ensure there are no delays in operationalising the plant.

MCD officials said the civic body’s biogas plants together have the capacity to scientifically process about 200 metric tonnes of cow dung every day. The Nangli Sakrawati biogas plant was set up last year, while the Goyla compressed biogas (CBG) plant is expected to be ready before July, they added.

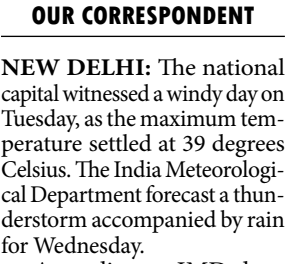
AQI REMAINS MODERATE Delhi logs max temp of 39 degrees Celsius

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The national capital witnessed a windy day on Tuesday, as the maximum temperature settled at 39 degrees Celsius. The India Meteorological Department forecast a thunderstorm accompanied by rain for Wednesday.

According to IMD data, Safdarjung, the city’s primary weather station, recorded a maximum temperature of 39 degrees Celsius (0.5 degrees below normal), and no rainfall was recorded there until 5:30 pm. Palam recorded 0.1 mm of rainfall between 8:30 am and 5:30 pm, while other stations largely reported trace or no rainfall, according to the weather department.

Among other stations, Lodhi Road recorded a maximum temperature of 37.2 degrees Celsius (1.8 degrees below normal); Ridge recorded 37.8 (2.1 degrees below normal); Ayanagar recorded 38.4 (1.6 degrees below normal); and Palam recorded 37.9 (2.6 degrees below normal). Minimum temperatures remained above normal at several stations. Safdarjung recorded a



minimum temperature of 27.6 degrees Celsius (2.2 degrees above normal), followed by Ayanagar at 26.7 (1.8 degrees above normal), and Lodhi Road at 26.4 (2.4 degrees above normal). Palam and Ridge recorded minimum temperatures of 25.5 degrees Celsius and 25.6 degrees Celsius, respectively, 0.8 degrees and 0.5 degrees below normal.

The IMD forecasts a partly cloudy sky for Wednesday with a thunderstorm accompanied by rain. The maximum and minimum temperatures are likely to settle around 39 degrees Celsius and 27 degrees Celsius, respectively.

Meanwhile, Delhi’s air quality remained in the “moderate” category, with the Air Quality Index recorded at 170 at 4 pm, according to the Central Pollution Control Board (CPCB).

Discoms issue fire safety advisory

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: In the wake of recent fire tragedies leading to loss of lives, the power discoms have issued an advisory for people to prevent electrical accidents by avoiding overloaded circuits, faulty wiring and ensuring regular checks of air conditioners.

Air conditioners, often used continuously, are especially prone to overheating if not properly maintained or connected to adequately rated circuits, says the advisory.

The overloaded circuits, faulty wiring and lack of regular servicing of air conditioners can turn homes into fire zones. However, simple precautions taken in time can prevent devastating electrical fires, discom officials said.

In most cases, electrical fires originate within homes due to internal faults like loose connections, damaged cables or the absence of safety devices such as Residual Current Circuit Breakers (RCCBs) and Earth Leakage Circuit Breakers (ELCBs).

Understanding these risks and taking simple, preventive steps, from upgrading wiring and installing certified protection systems to servicing ACs and avoiding overloading circuits, can go a long way in safeguarding lives and property,

KEY POINTS

» Air conditioners, often used continuously, are especially prone to overheating if not properly maintained or connected to adequately rated circuits: Advisory

» The overloaded circuits, faulty wiring and lack of regular servicing of air conditioners can

turn homes into fire zones. However, simple precautions taken in time can prevent devastating electrical fires

» The excessive use of power, often exceeding the sanctioned load at residents’ premises, especially for appliances like air conditioners, can overload circuits or cause electrical short circuits

officials said. Increased heat and an increased power demand strain electrical systems, raising the risk of overheating and electrical fires at a consumer’s premises. The excessive use of power, often exceeding the sanctioned load at residents’ premises, especially for appliances like air conditioners, can overload circuits or cause electrical short circuits, they said.

Further, internal wiring in some consumer premises may not be designed to handle the load-carrying capacity required in summer. Improper maintenance of air conditioners, power theft and other electrical equipment also contribute to the increased risk of fire incidents.

Fire incidents at a consumer’s premises are almost always

due to internal factors. These include faulty wiring, loose connections, overloaded circuits, damaged electrical cords/plugs, sockets or outlets. Old or poorly maintained electrical equipment and air conditioners are also causing fire incidents.

Use of ELCBs or Residual Current Breakers (RCBs) to trip circuits in case of overloading and short circuits can significantly reduce the risk of fire incidents, said the advisory. Regular inspection of home wiring, installation of ELCBs and RCCBs, use of ISI-marked wiring and appliances, and avoiding overloading sockets with multiple devices can prevent mishaps, according to the advisory.

Some simple things like switching off appliances when

not in use, unplugging power cords safely and servicing of air conditioners periodically also reduce the risk of overheating and sparking.

According to power distribution officials and safety experts, electrical fires during summer are primarily caused by excessive load on domestic circuits as air conditioners, coolers, geysers and other heavy appliances operate continuously for long durations.

Old and poorly maintained air conditioners have become a major source of concern. Experts warned that ageing AC units consume more electricity and place additional stress on circuits, increasing the possibility of short circuits and compressor failures.

In some cases, overheating compressors and airflow obstruction due to clogged filters or condenser coils can even lead to fires or explosions.

To minimise risks, consumers have been advised not to run air conditioners continuously for extended periods and to keep outdoor units free from dust and debris for proper airflow. Using voltage stabilisers, setting thermostats at 24 degrees Celsius and operating ACs in “Auto” mode instead of continuous “on” mode can also help reduce stress on electrical systems, added the advisory.

COUNTRY LIKELY TO RECEIVE 80 CM OF RAINFALL

Monsoon onset likely over Bay of Bengal, Andaman & Nicobar by week-end: IMD

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Conditions are becoming favourable for the onset of the southwest monsoon over parts of the south Bay of Bengal, Andaman Sea and Andaman and Nicobar Islands towards the end of this week, the India Meteorological Department (IMD) said on Tuesday.

“The low-pressure area over southwest Bay of Bengal lay over the same region at 8.30 am of today, the 12th May 2026, with the associated cyclonic circulation extending up to 4.5km above mean sea level. It is likely to become more marked during the next 48 hours,” said the IMD in its daily forecast.

Typically, the monsoon hits the Andaman and Nicobar around May 20, and it subsequently advances further west toward mainland India.



Priests perform Ganga ‘Aarti’ during heavy rainfall at Dashashwamedh Ghat, in Varanasi, Uttar Pradesh PFI

Highlights

- » Kerala usually sees the onset of the monsoon on June 1, which marks the beginning of the south-west monsoon season (June to September)
- » Earlier, the IMD had said that India might witness below-normal rainfall this year during the monsoon season

According to the IMD, it could be due to the emergence of the El Nino conditions, which cause less rainfall in the country.

In its monthly forecast on May 1, the department had said that El Nino-Southern Oscillation (ENSO)-neutral conditions over the equatorial Pacific were evolving toward El Nino conditions.

Arunachal: Two NSCN cadres killed in gunfight with Assam Rifles

OUR CORRESPONDENT

ITANAGAR: Two suspected NSCN cadres were killed in an encounter with Assam Rifles in Changlang district of Arunachal Pradesh, after security forces launched a counter-insurgency operation based on inputs about the movement of armed insurgents allegedly involved in extortion activities, police said on Tuesday.

Changlang Superintendent of Police Kirli Padu said that the 8th Assam Rifles unit at Miao received specific inputs on Monday, regarding the presence and movement of armed NSCN cadres in the general area of Songking village and adjoining locations for extortion from villagers.

Acting on the intelligence, Assam Rifles launched a counter-insurgency operation in the

area.

At around 8:30 pm, the security forces reportedly noticed movement of around 12 to 13 armed cadres near Duimukh Nallah.

When challenged by security personnel, the insurgents allegedly opened fire, prompting retaliation by the Assam Rifles in self-defence, the SP said.

Following the exchange of fire and subsequent search operation, security forces recovered two unidentified bodies of insurgents along with arms and war-like stores from the area.

The deceased were later identified as self-styled Lt Col Umkong and self-styled Sgt Enu, the SP said.

Police from Miao Police Station subsequently reached the spot and brought the bodies along with the recovered arms and ammunition.

NEET-UG 2026 cancelled over paper leak, CBI registers FIR

Continued from Page 1

Reports of protests by activists of NSUI, SFI and other organisations at several places also came in.

Though Union Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan did not respond to media queries on the cancellation, the NTA said this is a matter of concern for the children, for their parents, and for the entire ecosystem.

By the end of the day, the CBI registered a case of criminal conspiracy, cheating, criminal breach of trust, theft and destruction of evidence under Bhartiya Nyay Sanhita (BNS), offences under Prevention of Corruption Act and under the Public Examination Prevention of Unfair Means Act 2024.

The agency dispatched multiple special teams to various locations and will also collect material from the Special Operations Group (SOG) of Rajasthan Police.

The Rajasthan Police SOG

had claimed that a “guess paper” for chemistry that was allegedly circulated among students ahead of the examination had approximately 410 questions and roughly 120 of these were in the question paper.

In Maharashtra’s Nashik, a man was detained in connection with the paper leak. Nashik Deputy Commissioner of Police Kirankumar Chauhan said a team of Rajasthan Police would arrive in the city to take his custody.

The NTA, in a statement on X, said the decision to cancel the exam was taken in the interest of maintaining transparency and preserving trust in the national examination system.

The examination was conducted on May 3 across 551 cities in India and 14 cities abroad with nearly 23 lakh candidates appearing nationwide with a turnout of 96.92 per cent.

The agency said the inputs received, taken together with

findings shared by law enforcement agencies, established that the “present examination process could not be allowed to stand”.

Later, talking to reporters, NTA Director General Abhishek Singh said, “Paper leaks must end with immediate effect. It is unfortunate that we are at this stage. This is a matter of concern for the children of our country, for their parents, and for the entire ecosystem.”

“I understand that more than two lakh people were involved in the examination system. This is distressing for everyone involved. We take responsibility for what has happened; it was wrong. We are cancelling it and preparing to conduct it again with the assurance that such incidents will not be repeated...”

Under fire, the NTA said the registration data, candidature and examination centres opted for in the May 2026 cycle will be carried forward for the

re-conducted examination.

“No fresh registration will be required, and no additional examination fee will be levied,” the NTA statement said, adding that fees already paid by students will be refunded and the examination will be re-conducted using the NTA’s internal resources.

The NTA on Sunday had said question papers were transported in GPS-tracked vehicles carrying unique, traceable watermark identifiers, while examination centres were monitored through AI-assisted CCTV surveillance from a central control room.

According to a report in India Today, Sikar, fast emerging as Rajasthan’s new Kota, is now the biggest focus area of the CBI in its probe into the NEET paper leak case. So far, the investigation by the Rajasthan Police SOG has revealed a complex trail from Nashik, where the paper was allegedly printed, to Sikar, to other

parts of the country. Sources said that the NEET paper got distributed through a one-to-one network across the country, reaching coaching centres in Delhi, Jammu and Kashmir, Bihar, Kerala and Uttarakhand.

In fact, the paper had been circulating for nearly 15 days before the May 3 examination, being sold to medical aspirants for anywhere between Rs 30,000 and Rs 28 lakh. In fact, a student from Nagaur, who arrived in Sikar four days before the May 3 exam, shelled out Rs 28 lakh for the paper. During questioning, this student said he received a call from Delhi saying the “paper had arrived”.

According to an India Today report, it started with Rakesh selling the paper for Rs 30,000 to one of his aides, a Sikar student studying MBBS in Kerala. Just a day before the exam, the MBBS student sent the paper to his father, a PG operator in Sikar.

“Papa, a friend from Sikar sent this to me. Please give it to the girls in your hostel. This is what will come in tomorrow’s exam,” the message read. Without giving it much thought, the PG operator allegedly circulated the paper among the girls staying at the hostel, investigators said. A BAMS student has been arrested in Maharashtra’s Nashik for allegedly buying the leaked 2026 NEET-UG question paper on Telegram and further selling it to a Haryana-based buyer, sources said.

The accused has been identified as Shubham Khairnar. He has been arrested by the Nashik Crime Branch. As many as four teams of the CBI have arrived in Nashik to take custody of Khairnar.

The arrest has also cast fresh doubts over the earlier theory that the paper was leaked directly from a Nashik printing press, with police sources now saying the exam paper was not printed there. WITH AGENCY INPUTS

From Page 1

OMC losses

prices, though increased by Rs 60 in March, remain below cost. Oil firms are losing roughly Rs 14 per litre on petrol, Rs 42 per litre on diesel and Rs 674 per LPG cylinder.

Despite these challenges, India has maintained uninterrupted fuel supply across the country, avoiding the shortages and price spikes seen in several other nations.

“There are no shortages anywhere. Every petrol pump in the country has had petrol and diesel. LPG supply is more than enough,” Puri said.

India currently holds about 60 days of crude oil and LNG supplies and around 45 days of LPG reserves. Officials are monitoring the situation closely through continuous reviews of supply chains and refining operations.

The minister also addressed concerns around calls for fuel conservation made by Narendra Modi, clarifying that they do not signal any imminent restrictions. “It’s not that any lockdown is going to happen tomorrow,” Puri said, adding that there is “absolutely no cause for anxiety”.

He described the Prime Minister’s appeal as a forward-looking approach aimed at reducing long-term vulnerabilities. “There are certain activities which we can curtail,” he said, referring to voluntary moderation in consumption.

Puri also urged households and industries to shift from LPG to piped natural gas where possible, citing expanding infrastructure and improved availability. “We have no shortage of pipe gas. It is cleaner, cheaper and helps us scale up the energy transition,” he said.

The crisis has prompted the government to reassess its strategic energy storage policies. Puri said India would need to build larger reserves in the future as global supply chains remain uncertain. “The experience since February 2026 means you have to

rethink everything,” he said.

India, which imports about 88 per cent of its crude oil and previously relied heavily on shipments passing through the Strait of Hormuz, has diversified sourcing to ensure uninterrupted supply. Nearly 20 per cent of global energy flows transit through the strait.

Fuel demand has remained steady, with petrol consumption rising about 6 per cent. LPG demand has eased to around 75,000 tonnes per day from nearly 90,000 tonnes earlier, partly due to seasonal trends.

Looking ahead, India plans to expand its refining capacity to 320 million metric tonnes annually by 2030, up from around 260 million tonnes currently. The government is also pushing for increased domestic oil and gas exploration through policy changes and expanded licensing rounds.

Puri said India has managed the situation effectively so far and remains confident of handling future challenges, while acknowledging the need for careful management of consumption and fiscal pressures.

PM-led panel

The leader of opposition is not a rubber stamp,” Gandhi wrote, adding that he could not “abdicate” his constitutional responsibility by participating under such conditions.

In his note, Gandhi also accused the government of using the CBI to target political opponents, journalists and critics.

He said that the presence of the Leader of Opposition in the selection panel was intended to safeguard institutional independence, but claimed he had been denied a meaningful role.

The Congress leader stated that despite repeated requests, he was not provided with self-appraisal or 360-degree evaluation reports of candidates. Instead, he said he was expected to review records of 69 candidates during the meeting itself. “This deliberate denial of information, without any legal basis, makes a mockery of the selection process,” he

said, alleging that it ensured the selection of a predetermined candidate.

Gandhi also referred to earlier correspondence, including a dissent recorded in May last year and a letter sent in October suggesting reforms to improve transparency, which he said had not received a response.

CM Suvendu

Rath was shot dead by unidentified assailants on May 6 at Doharia in Madhyamgram while he was returning home. During the investigation, police arrested three persons from Bihar and Uttar Pradesh.

Sources said two of the accused — identified as Mayank Raj Mishra and Vicky Maurya — were detained from Buxar in Bihar, while another accused, Raj Singh, was detained from Ballia in Uttar Pradesh. The trio was brought to Madhyamgram and formally arrested on Monday morning.

Investigators have learnt that the vehicle used by the accused had been spotted near Barasat rail gate number 11. The car allegedly proceeded to Birati, where Mayank got down, before taking a U-turn towards Madhyamgram.

Meanwhile, according to Millennium Post’s Lucknow correspondent Biswajeet Banerjee, sources in the investigation claimed that the conspiracy behind Rath’s murder may have roots in eastern Uttar Pradesh, with investigators suspecting that the plot was hatched in Varanasi before being executed in North 24-Parganas.

Sources further claimed that a notorious shooter from Ghazipur and another from Buxar remain absconding. Investigators suspect that a Ghazipur-based criminal could be the kingpin behind the conspiracy to murder Rath.

According to the sources, the accused persons had boarded a train to Dhanbad from Pandit Deendayal Upadhyay Junction. From there, they allegedly travelled to Kolkata in a Swift Dzire and a Nissan vehicle before Rath was shot dead in Madhyamgram.

Retail inflation

The Reserve Bank of India, which uses CPI data to frame its monetary policy, recently projected inflation at 4.6 per cent for 2026 to 27, with 4 per cent expected in the first quarter. It cautioned that elevated energy prices due to the West Asia conflict and the possibility of El Niño conditions affecting the southwest monsoon could pose upside risks.

The NSO compiles inflation data by collecting real-time prices from 1,407 urban markets, including online platforms, and 1,465 villages across all states and Union Territories. Core inflation remained steady at 3.4 per cent during April.

NDA begins

humility I bow down to the people of Assam.” He attributed the achievement to the guidance of the prime minister, describing it as a key motivating force, and credited Amit Shah’s support in efforts aimed at peace, development and delivery of promises.

The chief minister also thanked party leadership and workers, including Nitin Nabin, for carrying the message of governance to people across the state. “Together, we shall work towards creating a Viksit and Surakshit Assam,” he said while congratulating his cabinet colleagues.

Four ministers took oath alongside him, representing different sections of society. These included BJP leaders Rameshwar Teli and Ajanta Neog, Asom Gana Parishad’s Atul Bora and Bodol and People’s Front’s Charan Boro. While Teli, Bora and Neog took their oath in Assamese, Boro took his in Bodo. Teli is seen as representing the tea community, Neog as a prominent woman leader, Bora as a regional voice and Boro as a representative of the indigenous Bodo community.

Neog, Bora and Boro were part of Sarma’s previous cabinet, where Neog handled finance, Bora oversaw agriculture and Boro managed transport. Teli, a

former Union minister, returned to state-level politics with his induction.

After the ceremony, Modi greeted the gathering with folded hands before leaving the venue. Nitin Nabin said the continuation of a “double-engine” government would accelerate development, investment and welfare programmes in Assam. Amit Shah stated that the NDA had laid a strong base for development and security, and that the electoral mandate reflected public trust.

The NDA secured 102 seats in the 126-member Assam Assembly, including 82 won by the BJP, while its allies, the Asom Gana Parishad and the Bodoland People’s Front, won 10 seats each.

AIADMK rebel

Organising secretary R S Bharati described the allegations as baseless and aimed at triggering internal discord within the AIADMK. Earlier, party chief M K Stalin had also ruled out any such post-poll understanding.

The AIADMK leadership hit back, accusing the dissidents of spreading misinformation after electoral setbacks in their constituencies. In a statement on X, the party’s IT wing labelled the rebel leaders “betrayers” and insisted that cadre support remained firmly behind Palaniswami. It also alleged that some among the rebels were seeking ministerial positions in the new government.

Despite the sharp internal divide, Shanmugam maintained that the group had no intention of splitting the party. He said the decision to support the TVK government was backed by a resolution adopted by AIADMK MLAs and framed as a step towards rebuilding the organisation and reviving what he called the “Amma rule”.

The political uncertainty comes days after Vijay’s party emerged as the single largest formation with 108 seats in the 234-member Assembly, falling short of the majority mark by 10. Support from the Congress and smaller parties, including Left groups, the Viduthalaai Chiruthai-

gal Katchi and the Indian Union Muslim League, helped the coalition cross the halfway mark, though its stability remains under scrutiny.

Adding another twist, VCK leader Thol Thirumavalavan claimed both the DMK and AIADMK had explored a possible arrangement projecting him as chief minister to keep the TVK out of power, an offer he said was declined after internal consultations.

The unfolding developments revive memories of earlier leadership struggles within the AIADMK following the deaths of M G Ramachandran in 1987 and J Jayalalithaa in 2016, signalling another critical phase for the party.

SC

The judges also pointed out that the tribunal had passed a detailed order after considering studies on marine ecology, biodiversity and avian diversity, which found no significant adverse environmental impact. One of the studies even described the port area as supportive of bird diversity.

At the same time, the court clarified that it remains mindful of environmental protection and would welcome constructive suggestions from activists. “We appreciate if a person comes and says these are the precautions required. Please go ahead but ensure safeguards,” the Chief Justice said, urging a balanced approach between development and environmental care.

While declining to interfere with the tribunal’s order, the court allowed the petitioner to approach the tribunal again to highlight any specific objections that may not have been considered earlier. It asked the tribunal to examine such concerns if raised through a review plea.

The bench also observed that while initial apprehensions about environmental impact may be genuine, seeking to halt projects altogether could hinder national progress. It questioned where large ports could be developed if

not in regions like Gujarat, where natural conditions such as sea depth are suitable, and warned that blocking such projects could push related economic activity to other countries.

Bareilly resident seeks FIR against hospital after wall collapse damages house

OUR CORRESPONDENT

BAREILLY: A 74-year-old Bareilly resident has filed a formal complaint seeking registration of an FIR against Al Hind Hospital and its managing director, alleging criminal negligence and illegal construction after a portion of the hospital structure allegedly collapsed onto his residence on Monday morning.

In the complaint addressed to local authorities, Munnoo Singh Parmar claimed that between 10 am and 11:30 am, the structural walls of the hospital, located behind his house near University Road Bypass, collapsed suddenly, causing severe damage to his property.

“The impact was devastating, resulting in the complete destruction of my house’s roof, walls and veranda,” Parmar said in the complaint. He alleged that the sound of the collapse created panic in the neighbourhood and left his family traumatised.

According to the complaint, Parmar’s 72-year-old wife Gita Singh and his 13-year-old grandson Abhiraj were inside the house at the time of the incident. “It is only by the grace of God that they were not physically crushed, which would have resulted in certain fatalities,” he stated.

Parmar further alleged that the hospital was operating in violation of government norms and lacked mandatory safety clearances. He claimed the hospital had failed to conduct a structural audit and did not possess a valid fire safety audit or No Objection Certificate (NOC).

NEET-UG CANCELLATION

Oppn attacks govt, demands overhaul of NTA

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Opposition leaders on Tuesday attacked the government after the cancellation of the NEET-UG examination, alleging administrative failure and insensitivity toward students, and also slammed the “repeated lapses” in the conduct of national-level competitive examinations.

Several Opposition leaders took to X questioning the functioning of the National Testing Agency (NTA) and demanding accountability over the recurring controversies surrounding entrance tests.

The NTA on Tuesday cancelled the NEET (UG) 2026 exam held on May 3 amid allegations of paper leak, with the government asking the CBI to carry out a comprehensive inquiry into the “irregularities”.



Security personnel stand guard at National Testing Agency (NTA) headquarters, over alleged paper leak concerns following the cancellation of the NEET-UG 2026 examination, in New Delhi, Tuesday

Highlights

- » The NTA on Tuesday cancelled the NEET (UG) 2026 exam held on May 3 amid allegations of paper leak
- » Modi's so-called 'amrit kaal' has turned into a 'vish kaal' for the country, said Rahul
- » Kejriwal said affected students will have to resort to mass protests as the govt only understands language of agitation

a crime against the future of the youth,” the Leader of Opposition in the Lok Sabha said.

AAP national convener Arvind Kejriwal said affected students will have to resort to mass protests as the government only understands the language of agitation. At a press conference, he alleged “political patronage” in paper leaks, saying the NEET question paper was leaked four times in the past nine years and none of the accused were punished.

He said that paper leaks did not happen out of nowhere, as he alleged complicity of higher ups, and accused the government of toying with the future of lakhs of students.

Rashtriya Janata Dal Rajya Sabha member Manoj Jha also lashed out at the NTA, posting on X, “Do anything but first dismantle NTA, NEET.”

Talking to the news agency, Jha said the agency was “incapable” and recalled that he had earlier raised the issue in Parliament.

“I had said in Parliament, throw it in the Bay of Bengal. Have you ever thought about the impact on students coming from ordinary backgrounds? The CBI probe is an eyewash. This is extremely insensitive,” he said.

“Democracy is not just fighting and winning elections. How sensitive are you towards the people,” Jha asked.

CPI(M) Rajya Sabha member John Brittas said repeated failures in national examinations were eroding public trust in the system.

RJD spokesperson Priyanka Bharti linked the latest controversy to earlier allegations of paper leaks connected to Bihar.

Assam Cabinet adds longest-serving woman MLA, tea tribe leader

4 ministers sworn into new Cabinet with CM Himanta Biswa Sarma



PM Narendra Modi with Assam Governor Lakshman Prasad Acharya, newly sworn-in Chief Minister Himanta Biswa Sarma and state ministers during the swearing-in ceremony, in Guwahati PTI

OUR CORRESPONDENT

GUWAHATI: Assam's longest-serving woman legislator, a veteran tea tribe leader, and senior representatives of allies AGP and BPF were among the four ministers sworn into the new Cabinet on Tuesday alongside Chief Minister Himanta Biswa Sarma, as the BJP-led NDA government began its third consecutive term in the state.

Governor Lakshman Prasad Acharya administered the oath of office and secrecy to BJP leaders Ajanta Neog and Rameswar Teli, along with Atul Bora of the Asom Gana Parishad (AGP) and Charan Boro of the Bodol- and People's Front (BPF).

The swearing-in ceremony was attended by Prime Minister Narendra Modi, Union ministers, and chief ministers and deputy chief ministers of NDA-ruled states. Portfolios for the ministers are yet to be announced. Except for Teli, the other three ministers were also part of the previous NDA government in Assam.

Ajanta Neog: A six-time MLA from Golaghat, Neog is the state's longest-serving woman legislator, representing the constituency continuously since 2001. She also became the state's first and only woman

finance minister after assuming the portfolio in 2021.

Previously a Congress leader and minister in the Tarun Gogoi-led governments, 62-year-old Neog joined the BJP in 2020 and retained her seat in a bypoll. Her husband, former Congress minister Nagen Neog, was killed in a militant attack in 1996.

Rameswar Teli: A prominent tea tribe leader, Teli is making his debut in the state Cabinet after serving as a Union minister of state in the Narendra Modi government. Associated with politics since his student days, he first entered the Assembly in 2001 from Duliajan constituency and retained the seat in 2006.

After losing the 2011 Assembly election, he shifted to national politics, winning the Dibrugarh Lok Sabha seat in 2014 and retaining it in 2019. He has also served as a Rajya Sabha MP. Teli, 55, returned to the Assembly this year from Duliajan.

Atul Bora: AGP president Bora has been leading the regional party since 2014. A former president of the All Assam Students' Union, he was among the leaders shaped by the anti-foreigners Assam Agitation of 1979-85.

TMC questions Centre over NEET leak, demands accountability

AGNIHOTRI GUPTA

KOLKATA: The Trinamool Congress on Tuesday questioned the accountability of the BJP-led Central government over the NEET question paper leak and the subsequent re-examination process. “Lakhs of students’ lives have been affected because of them,” the party said after the National Testing Agency (NTA) announced the cancellation of the NEET-UG examination held on May 3.

Amid allegations of a question paper leak, the Central government has asked the CBI to conduct a comprehensive inquiry into the alleged “irregularities” in the examination process.

Leader of Opposition Sobhandeb Chattopadhyay questioned the competency of the Centre, saying, “They lectured Bengal on its education system, yet failed to conduct a national examination properly. They have made the future of lakhs of students uncertain. The Centre should apologise.”

Senior TMC leader Mahua Moitra referred to previous controversies surrounding national examinations and said, “Almost 100 paper leaks and 50 re-examinations have taken place in the past decade of Modi Raj.”

TMC Rajya Sabha MP Sagarika Ghose also raised questions over the functioning of the National Testing Agency. “In 2014, I had written to Education minister Dharmendra Pradhan seeking details about the NTA- who its members are and why annual reports are not published. If you visit the NTA website, you will not find this information. There is no transparency or accountability in the NTA. It is a total collapse of the system,” she said.

CM Vijay orders closure of 717 liquor shops across TN

CHENNAI: Amid demands from women and some political parties for implementing prohibition, Tamil Nadu Chief Minister C Joseph Vijay on Tuesday ordered the closure of 717 state-run retail liquor outlets, including 276 shops near places of worship across the state.

The move was done keeping in mind the welfare of the public and Vijay issued orders to shut down the retail liquor outlets, an official release said.

Opposition DMK mocked the move as “mere PR.”

Liquor sales is one of government's key revenue generators in Tamil Nadu. Accordingly, 276 outlets near places of worship, 186 shops near educational institutions, and 255 outlets near bus stands will be closed within the next two weeks, it said.

There has been widespread demand, especially from women

and a few political parties such as the PMK, that all the liquor shops in the state should be closed and prohibition implemented. Responding, DMK spokesperson Saravanan Annadurai claimed TASMAL outlets were not present outside places of religious worship and educational institutions.

“Will they open new shops and close them down. This is mere PR (public relations),” he said on social media platform ‘X’. The Tamil Nadu State Marketing Corporation (TASMAC) operates 4,765 retail liquor outlets across the state.

In 2025, the revenue from liquor sales in Tamil Nadu was Rs 48,344 crore. TASMAC sells 551 brands of liquor imported from foreign countries, including 223 brands of wine being sold through licensed retail outlets.

Austerity appeal: Sharad Pawar urges PM to convene all-party meet

OUR CORRESPONDENT

MUMBAI: NCP (SP) chief Sharad Pawar on Tuesday said Prime Minister Narendra Modi's appeal for austerity is likely to have a far-reaching impact on the economy and urged him to convene an all-party meeting to discuss the situation.

Pawar said the sudden appeal had created unease among ordinary citizens, businesses, industrial sectors and investors.

At this juncture, the government's foremost priority should be to restore public confidence and safeguard stability in the country, the former Union minister said in a statement.

Emphasising that the Centre is trying to shield people from the adverse impact of the West Asia conflict, PM Modi



has called for judicious use of fuel, postponement of gold purchases and foreign travel, among other measures to strengthen the economy.

Modi suggested reducing petrol and diesel consumption, using Metro rail services in cities, carpooling, increased use of electric vehicles, utilising railway services for parcel movement, and working from home to conserve foreign exchange amid the crisis in West Asia.

Pawar said that against the backdrop of the “unstable and

warlike situation in the Middle East,” the PM made some announcements two days ago that are likely to have far-reaching impacts on the country's economy.

Describing the issue as a matter of serious concern, he said decisions on matters of national importance should be taken after consulting leaders of all political parties.

“The prime minister should convene an all-party meeting under his chairmanship and take all political parties into confidence while formulating decisions in the national interest,” the Rajya Sabha member said.

He also called on the Centre to act with greater sensitivity and undertake wider consultations in view of the current international situation on future policy measures.

No diplomatic setback with Nepal, Foreign Secretary visit to be finalised soon: India

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: India reiterated its relationship with Nepal on Tuesday, in response to reports of tensions between the two countries and amid the delay in the Indian Foreign Secretary's visit to Nepal.

The spokesperson for the Ministry of External Affairs, Randhir Jaiswal, stressed, during a press briefing here in the national capital that India and Nepal continue to maintain “a warm and multifaceted relationship,” noting that New Delhi is dedicated to improving relations with its Himalayan neighbour.

“As we have already congratulated the Prime Minister of Nepal on the completion of the elections, and formation of the new government, the Prime Minister Narendra Modi has now congratulated

him again. We are committed towards further strengthening our relations with Nepal,” Jaiswal said.

He also informed that there had been talks between our External Affairs Minister, S Jaishankar and the Foreign Minister of Nepal, Shashikala Khanal in Mauritius.”Efforts are being made by both sides to build up this relationship,” he said.

The statements are made against the backdrop of reports from certain parts of the Nepalese media indicating tension between India and Nepal, especially because of reports that the Nepalese Prime Minister had failed to schedule a meeting with the Indian Foreign Secretary.

It was also speculated that the postponement of the proposed visit was connected with disagreements over the issue of

Lipulekh as well as other border issues.

While quizzed regarding the postponement and whether the visit had been called off altogether, Jaiswal dispelled any speculation about any diplomatic setbacks and stated that the visit will happen following consultations.

“We have been invited by the Nepali side for the Foreign Secretary to visit Nepal. The dates of the visit will be finalised based on the convenience of both parties,” he added.

India and Nepal have had their fair share of disputes in recent times despite being culturally, economically, and strategically close nations.

Their relations were strained due to Nepal's decision to publish a new political map in 2020, which incorporated Lipulekh, Kalapani,

and Limpiyadhura as parts of Nepal, territories claimed by India to belong to Uttarakhand. The matter was revisited when the construction of various infrastructural and connectivity projects around the borders attracted political backlash from Kathmandu.

Moreover, the developments that have been taking place in Nepal and Kathmandu's closer involvement with China have provided another dimension to Sino-Indian relations. In such a situation, both countries have to take care of their diplomatic sensitivities as well.

However, despite all these tensions, India's focus on the policy of “Neighbourhood First” continues to be visible. The two countries have stayed in touch through various economic and developmental cooperation programmes.

Congress leaders in Kerala divided on UDF coalition partners’ role in Chief Minister selection

The three main contenders for the post of chief minister are senior leaders Ramesh Chennithala, V D Satheesan and the AICC general secretary (Organisation) K C Venugopal

OUR CORRESPONDENT

THIRUVANANTHAPURAM/ NEW DELHI: The Congress leaders from Kerala appear to be divided on whether coalition partners should have a say in the CM selection as the party high command continued to hold talks with senior leaders in the southern state.

Leaders who have been called to Delhi by the central leadership include former KPCC presidents V M Sudheeran, Mullappally Ramachandran, K Muraleedharan, K Sudhakaran and M M Hassan.

The party has also asked senior MLA Thiruvanchoor Radhakrishnan and working presidents P C Vishnunath, Shafi Parambil and A P Anil Kumar to come to Delhi.

After the discussions, on the way out, Sudhakaran told reporters in Delhi that his stance on the issue has not changed and, in his view, MLAs' views should be considered when deciding the CM.

Radhakrishnan said that he communicated his views to the high command and answered their

Key Points

- » Leaders who have been called to Delhi by the central leadership include former KPCC presidents V M Sudheeran, Mullappally Ramachandran, K

Muraleedharan, K Sudhakaran and M M Hassan

- » Muraleedharan said he had told the party high command what he had to say, and a decision can be expected by Wednesday

queries to the best of his ability as a party worker.

On whether the UDF coalition party, the Indian Union Muslim League (IUML) should have a say in the matter, he asked reporters in Delhi why it was being “dragged” into the issue.

“Why are you bringing IUML into this? They need not be involved in this,” he said, adding that a decision on the Kerala CM will come as soon as possible.

Muraleedharan said he had told the party high command what he had to say, and a decision can be expected by Wednesday.

A P Anil Kumar, the MLA-elect from the Wandoor Assembly

seat, said the high command will examine all aspects before taking a decision.

The three main contenders for the post of chief minister are senior leaders Ramesh Chennithala, V D Satheesan and AICC general secretary (Organisation) K C Venugopal.

Earlier in the day, Muraleedharan said that the Kerala CM would not be decided merely based on the opinion of MLAs, instead views of the UDF partners and the general public would also be taken into consideration.

He said that since it is the UDF CM, and not just the Congress, who is being decided, the front

partners' views will also have to be considered.

If the decision had to be taken just on the views of the MLAs, it would already be done by now, Muraleedharan added, while speaking to a TV channel in Thiruvananthapuram.

On the other hand, senior Congress leader M M Hassan asserted that coalition partners have no role in deciding the Congress Legislature Party leader in Kerala.

Rejecting suggestions that the stand taken by allies could influence the decision-making process, he said the Congress alone would decide its Assembly leader and chief minister.

The high command's decision to seek the opinions of former KPCC presidents has raised hopes in the camp of Satheesan, who also enjoys strong grassroots support among UDF workers, backed by key ally IUML.

Besides Muraleedharan, Sudheeran is also said to be of the view that public sentiment should be taken into consideration before

deciding the new chief minister.

Satheesan's camp also argues that if Venugopal is given the post, the UDF will have to face two by-elections -- one to elect him to the Assembly and another to elect a new MP for the Alappuzha Lok Sabha seat currently represented by Venugopal.

According to them, that would be highly risky under the prevailing political conditions in the state.

However, the working presidents, who have been called to Delhi, are believed to belong to Venugopal's camp.

The Venugopal camp claims that the AICC general secretary (Organisation) enjoys the support of most elected MLAs and is a strategist capable of ensuring UDF victories in the by-elections. His camp also claims that most of the Congress MPs from Kerala also support Venugopal.

The Chennithala camp says he is the senior most leader who has always stood by the party and the Nehru-Gandhi family like a rock, even during difficult times.

Centre ‘destroying’ dignity of federalism by misusing Central agencies: Punjab minister

OUR CORRESPONDENT

CHANDIGARH: A day after the CBI raided the Punjab Vigilance Bureau office in connection with a bribery case, state cabinet minister Aman Arora on Tuesday accused the BJP-led Centre of destroying the dignity of federalism by misusing Central agencies.

He slammed the Union government for allegedly bypassing Centre-state coordination mechanisms, and asserted that Punjab could not be intimidated or controlled like other states.

The Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI) raided the Punjab Vigilance Bureau office late on Monday night and

arrested two middlemen and another person in a Rs 13-lakh bribery case involving senior officers of the department, officials said.

The CBI action followed a complaint from a Punjab State Tax Officer, who had accused the middlemen Vikas Goyal and his son Raghav Goyal of demanding an illegal gratification of Rs 20 lakh to close a complaint against him in the office of the Director General (Vigilance), Punjab.

Aman Arora, who is also the Punjab AAP president, said CBI and ED (Enforcement Directorate) raids are nothing but political vendetta carried out by the BJP-led Central government.

GOVERNMENT OF NAGALAND
OFFICE OF THE ADDITIONAL CHIEF ENGINEER
URBAN ENGINEERING WING (UEW)
KOHIMA : NAGALAND
Dated: Kohima, the 12th May, 2026.

NOTICE INVITING TENDER

The Additional Chief Engineer, Urban Engineering Wing (UEW) Kohima : Nagaland on behalf of the Governor of Nagaland invites bids on percentage basis at par/above/below the Tendered Amount in Double Envelope System from eligible class-I registered contractor of NPWD/CPWD for the under mentioned works in Nagaland.

Sl. No	Name of Work	Tendered Amount	Earnest Money		Time of Completion
			Local	Non Local	
1	Improvement of Model Colony Circular road and drainage at East Dimapur	339.80	3.40	6.80	12 Months
2	Improvement of road from Clock Tower Jn. To Samziuram road via Catholic Church Jn, Jalukie Town	485.42	4.86	9.72	12 Months

Sealed tender in double envelope will be received upto 26th May, 2026 till 1:00 PM along with Earnest money affixing court stamps of Rs.7,50/- (Rupees Seven and Fifty Paise) and will be opened on the same day at 1:30 PM. Contractor are advised to purchase the bidding documents from 13th April to 26th May, 2026 and other terms and conditions can be obtained from the office of the Executive Engineer-II, UEW, Sd/-
Addl. Chief Engineer
Urban Engineering Wing, Kohima



PARTICIPATION DETAILS AWAITED

West Asia conflict casts shadow over ‘crucial’ BRICS meeting in Delhi

SIMONTINI BHATTACHARJEE

NEW DELHI: Amid mounting global uncertainty triggered by the continuing conflict in West Asia, the upcoming BRICS Foreign Ministers’ Meeting assumes significance as it will offer member nations a platform to deliberate on key global and regional issues and strengthen cooperation across critical sectors, the government said on Tuesday.

Briefing the media persons in New Delhi, Ministry of External Affairs spokesman Randhir Jaiswal mentioned: “India will host the BRICS Foreign Ministers’ meeting on May 14 and 15. The meeting will be chaired by the External Affairs Minister S. Jaishankar.”

The senior official further said that during the meeting, the foreign ministers of BRICS member countries will exchange views on global and regional issues of mutual interest.

Following a recent expansion, the meeting brings together the original members (Brazil, Russia, India, China, South Africa) with new members—Egypt, Ethiopia, Iran, Saudi Arabia, the UAE, and Indonesia—to strengthen unity among developing nations.

However, the MEA is yet to officially confirm the number of foreign ministers attending the meeting in New Delhi on Thursday and Friday, and whether Iranian Foreign Minister Seyed Abbas Araghchi will participate.

The official version by MEA only underlined that foreign ministers and heads of delegations from BRICS

HIGHLIGHTS

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» The official version by MEA only underlined that foreign ministers and heads of delegations from BRICS nations and partner countries would participate in the two-day event in New Delhi

» Delegates are also scheduled to call on Prime Minister Narendra



Modi during their visit

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» The last meeting of BRICS Foreign Ministers was held on the sidelines of the 80th Session of the United Nations General Assembly on September 26, 2025

nations and partner countries would participate in the two-day event in New Delhi.

Delegates are also scheduled to call on Prime Minister Narendra Modi during their visit.

On the second day, discussions will focus on the theme, “BRICS @ 20: Building for Resilience, Innovation, Cooperation and Sustainability,” followed by deliberations on reforming global governance and the multilateral system, Jaiswal informed.

The last meeting of BRICS Foreign Ministers was held on the sidelines of the 80th Session of the United Nations General Assembly on September 26, 2025, when India

chaired the discussions as the incoming BRICS Chair for 2026. Moreover, a core focus will be on discussing reforms to international institutions and the multilateral system to better reflect the interests of emerging markets. This is seen as an important platform because foreign ministers discuss regional security issues and coordinate stances on major global issues at a very crucial time.

Economic and practical cooperation is also set to play a major role as the discussions include enhancing economic, financial, and people-to-people exchanges to foster self-reliance and navigate global supply chain challenges.

CHINA-PAK COLLUSIVITY DURING OPERATION SINDOOR

It’s for responsible nations to reflect: India on China’s support to Pakistan

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: India on Tuesday said reports of Chinese support for Pakistan during Operation Sindoor corroborated what was already known and that responsible nations must reflect on how backing efforts to shield terrorist infrastructure would affect their global standing.

New Delhi’s comments came days after China confirmed that it provided on-site technical support to Pakistan during its four-day military conflict with India.

External Affairs Ministry spokesperson Randhir Jaiswal, responding to a question on the issue, said Operation Sindoor was a precise, targeted and calibrated response to the terrorist attack in Pahalgam.

“We have seen these reports that corroborate what was known earlier. Operation Sindoor was a precise, targeted and



calibrated response to the terrorist attack in Pahalgam, aimed at destroying state-sponsored terrorist infrastructure operating out of Pakistan and at its behest,” he said at his weekly media briefing.

“It is for nations who consider themselves responsible to reflect whether supporting attempts to protect terrorist infrastructure affects their reputation and standing,” Jaiswal added.

Last week, China, for the first time, confirmed that it provided on-site technical support

to Pakistan during the conflict, according to Chinese official media reports.

China’s state broadcaster CCTV aired an interview with Zhang Heng, an engineer from the Aviation Industry Corporation of China’s (AVIC) Chengdu Aircraft Design and Research Institute.

The AVIC is a key developer of China’s advanced fighter aircraft and unmanned aerial vehicle design. Zhang had provided technical support to Pakistan during the four-day war last May, Hong Kong-based South

China Morning Post reported, quoting CCTV.

Pakistan’s air force operates a fleet of Chinese-made J-10CE jets, produced by an AVIC subsidiary.

Lt Gen Rajiv Ghai, Deputy Chief of the Indian Army Staff (strategy), on May 7 spoke about “collusivity” between Pakistan and China.

“The fact is that Pakistan and China in their own words have a relationship that is deeper than the seas, higher than the mountains, that’s a given. The fact that Pakistan has 80 per cent of its military equipment of Chinese origin is a given,” he had said at a media briefing.

In response to the Pahalgam terror attack, India launched Operation Sindoor on May 7 last year carrying out airstrikes on nine terror infrastructure sites in Pakistan and Pakistan-Occupied Kashmir, eliminating at least 100 terrorists.

I4C, RBIH ink MoU to combat financial frauds

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Indian Cyber Crime Coordination Centre (I4C) under the Ministry of Home Affairs and the Reserve Bank Innovation Hub (RBIH) have signed a Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) to enhance cooperation in detecting and preventing financial frauds and curbing mule accounts in the banking and digital payments ecosystem.

The partnership aims to facilitate sharing of fraud-risk intelligence, analytical support and operational coordination to build stronger and proactive fraud prevention mechanisms.

Union Home Minister Amit Shah said the government is continuously working towards



building a cyber-secure India. In a post on X, he said the agreement would leverage artificial intelligence to detect and eliminate hidden mule accounts by integrating data from I4C’s Suspect Registry with AI-driven fraud detection systems.

The MoU was signed by Roopa M, Inspector General (Admin), I4C, and Sahil Kinni, Chief Executive Officer of RBIH, in the presence of senior RBI and I4C officials.

‘Sikhya Kranti drives strong PSEB Class 10 results’

MPOST BUREAU

CHANDIGARH: Punjab’s government schools have recorded a “major academic milestone” under the Bhagwant Mann government’s ‘Sikhya Kranti’, with the Punjab School Education Board (PSEB) Class 10 results registering an impressive overall pass percentage of 94.52 per cent and government school students making a strong mark in the merit list, officials said on Tuesday.

Out of 2,69,505 students who appeared for the examinations, 2,54,744 cleared the exams. Girls once again outperformed boys, securing a pass percentage of 95.96 per cent compared to 93.23 per cent among boys. A total of 272 students made it to the merit list, including 220 girls and 52 boys, while 88 students from government schools featured among



Punjab CM Bhagwant Mann felicitates a PSEB Class 10 examination topper on Tuesday

MPOST

the toppers.

Chief Minister Bhagwant Mann on Tuesday felicitated the top three rank holders and described the results as proof of the state’s ongoing “Sikhya Kranti”. Harleen Sharma secured the first position with 99.38 per cent marks, while Manimahesh Sharma and Riya Rani jointly secured the second and third positions with 99.23 per cent.

Congratulating the students, the Chief Minister said their hard work, determination and dedication had brought pride to Punjab. He added that these students would inspire younger generations to excel in academics and prove that Punjab’s children can compete with the best in the country when provided proper opportunities and infrastructure.

As a mark of appreciation,

the Chief Minister announced direct admission for all three toppers to the Schools of Eminence in the stream of their choice and handed over cheques of Rs 50,000 each.

Highlighting reforms introduced by the state government, Mann said Punjab had strengthened school infrastructure through smart classrooms, upgraded facilities and advanced teacher training programmes.

He claimed that Punjab had surpassed states such as Kerala, Maharashtra and Delhi in primary and middle-school education rankings.

In another achievement, 3,718 schools across Punjab recorded 100 per cent results, including 1,688 government schools. Amritsar district registered the highest pass percentage at 98.41 per cent, while Ludhiana recorded the highest number of merit positions.

CISF expands mental health support for personnel

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: In a major initiative aimed at strengthening the mental well-being and emotional resilience of its personnel, the Central Industrial Security Force has signed a five-year Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) with the Heartfulness Institute to introduce meditation, mindfulness and holistic wellness programmes for CISF personnel and their families.

The initiative seeks to help personnel cope with stress arising from demanding operational duties, long deployments and challenging working conditions. Under the partnership, structured wellness programmes will be implemented across the force to promote mental health, emotional stability and an improved quality of life.

As part of the collaboration, CISF personnel will participate in regular meditation and mindfulness workshops, stress management sessions and counselling services. Tailored wellness activities will also be extended to family members. Heartfulness practices will be integrated into the daily routines of CISF training institutes to help personnel develop emotional strength and psychological well-being from the early stages of training.

The programme will provide free wellness sessions to personnel and their families, multilingual emotional support through the “Voice that Cares” service, webinars by experts and specialised learning modules for young people. Senior officials are also expected to take part in restorative gatherings focused on guidance and emotional balance.

CISF Director General Praveer Ranjan stressed the importance of mental health in disciplined forces. He said simple meditation practices could help personnel reduce stress, maintain positivity and build emotional resilience while handling the pressures of duty.

PROJECT ALONG GURGAON CANAL/RAJ LINK CANAL

Haryana CM approves Rs 6.21 cr for installation of 50 shallow tubewells

MPOST BUREAU

CHANDIGARH: Haryana Chief Minister Nayab Singh Saini has approved over Rs 6.21 crore for the installation of 50 shallow tubewells along the Gurgaon Canal/Rajasthan Link Canal. The decision has been taken to strengthen irrigation facilities and promote groundwater development in the state.

Sharing information in this regard, an official spokesperson said that this project will be implemented under the scheme “Ground Water Development and Other Related Activities”. The office of the Chief Engineer/TWS and Superintending Engineer, YWS Circle Faridabad, has been appointed as

The decision has been taken to boost irrigation facilities & promote groundwater development

the nodal agency for the successful implementation and monitoring of the project. The spokesperson said that more than 15 villages of Nuh district have been facing the problem of waterlogging for a long time. Due to the continuously high water level in these areas, water remains standing in the fields, making thousands of acres of land unsuitable for farming. Farmers face difficulties every

season and are unable to grow crops on their land.

To provide a permanent solution to this problem, 50 shallow tubewells will be installed along the Gurgaon Canal/Rajasthan Link Canal. These tubewells will help in draining out excess water, reducing the problem of waterlogging and making thousands of acres of land cultivable again. This will provide major relief to farmers in the affected villages and help them restart farming on their land. The spokesperson further said that the project will not only solve the problem of waterlogging but will also improve groundwater management in the area and strengthen the economic condition of farmers.

AN ANALYSIS OF 138 CITIES IN INDIA

Humidity and airflow, along with vegetation, important for greenery’s cooling effect: Study

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: Along with vegetation cover, greenery in urban places should be planned looking at humidity and airflow in order to have a cooling effect, an analysis of 138 cities in India has revealed.

Tree shade is among the fastest ways to make heat more bearable. It cuts direct sunlight, protects people outdoors, and therefore remains essential for heat action plans.

Lead author Angana Borah, research graduate at the Indian Institute of Technology Gandhinagar’s department of civil engineering, said findings published in the journal Nature Communications point to a more practical approach to urban greening.

“The question is not whether cities should green. They should. The question is what kind of green, where, and how much,” she said.

“In dry cities, vegetation can provide strong cooling benefits. In humid and compact neighbourhoods, planners

KEY POINTS

- » Tree shade is among the fastest ways to make heat more bearable
- » It cuts direct sunlight, protects people outdoors, and therefore remains essential for heat action plans
- » Green cover is not a single variable -- canopy structure and canopy activity can affect humid heat differently, the researchers said



» ‘Cities need greening strategies that are designed for shade, moisture, and ventilation together’

also need to think about airflow and moisture build-up,” Borah said.

Researchers analysed temperature and humidity data recorded during 2003-2020 across tropical savanna, semi-arid steppe, and humid subtropical climates.

Instead of relying only on land surface temperature, the team reconstructed the ‘heat index,’ which combines temperature and humidity and is closer to how heat is felt by the human body.

“Greening is essential for climate adaptation, and shade gives people immediate relief,”

author Udit Bhatia, associate professor at Indian Institute of Technology Gandhinagar, said.

“Our results show that one-size-fits-all plantation targets miss part of the problem. Cities need greening strategies that are designed for shade, moisture, and ventilation together,” Bhatia said.

Green cover is not a single variable -- canopy structure and canopy activity can affect humid heat differently, the researchers said.

They found that vegetation cover and canopy structure were associated with lower model-predicted heat index,

but a high canopy activity was associated with a higher heat index in certain settings, with an earlier onset of warming in humid, dense urban cores.

The reason is physical and intuitive -- trees cool through shade and evapotranspiration, the team said.

They explained that in dry air, evapotranspiration can be strongly beneficial because the released moisture evaporates into air that can still absorb it.

However, in humid and compact neighbourhoods, extra moisture can remain trapped near the ground --

the result can be a higher heat index even though shade continues to provide immediate relief at the street level, the researchers said.

The takeaway is not to slow greening, but to make it climate-responsive, they said.

“Vegetation can cool urban environments but can also intensify humidity and thermal discomfort, raising questions about when green adaptation succeeds or backfires,” the authors wrote.

The findings “indicate that green adaptation can shift from a cooling asset to a humid-heat liability under some conditions, underscoring the need for climate-responsive and equitable design strategies in the Global South,” they said.

People most exposed to dangerous heat often live or work in dense, poorly ventilated neighbourhoods and have limited access to cooling. A better planned greening could help the communities by improving shade while reducing long-term humid-heat stress more effectively, the team said.

Vinesh Phogat row: Hooda seeks Sports Min’s intervention

CHANDIGARH: Former Haryana Chief Minister and Leader of Opposition Bhupinder Singh Hooda has urged immediate intervention by the Union Sports minister in the matter concerning Olympian wrestler Vinesh Phogat, calling the allegations raised by her “extremely serious”.

Hooda said Phogat has brought glory to the country on several occasions and deserves respect and equal opportunity. He alleged that despite her merit, she was neither allowed to participate in a competition in Gonda nor permitted to use the training hall. Questioning the functioning of the Wrestling Federation of India, he said the Sports minister should personally take cognisance of the matter to ensure no athlete is denied rightful entitlements.

MPOST

CJI forms high-powered panel for ‘judicial infrastructure overhaul’

The purpose of the committee is to ensure a unified infrastructural ecosystem

NEW DELHI: Chief Justice of India Surya Kant has decided to set up a high-powered committee headed by Supreme Court judge Aravind Kumar to prepare a blueprint for the modernisation of courts across the country and secure government allocation of funds.

The CJI announced the constitution of the Judicial Infrastructure Advisory Committee to address infrastructural deficiencies in courts through substantial financial support from the government.

Apart from Justice Kumar, the committee will comprise Justices Debangsu Basak, Ashwani Kumar Mishra and Somaskhar Sundaresan of the high courts of Calcutta, Punjab and Haryana, and Bombay, respec-

tively. “A Judicial Infrastructure Advisory Committee has been constituted by the Chief Justice of India keeping in view the varied infrastructural requirements of different High Courts and District Courts.

“The purpose of the Committee is to ensure a unified infrastructural ecosystem on a pan-India basis,” the secretary general of the apex court said in a statement. “The committee will submit its report to the

Chief Justice of India who shall, on consideration thereof, take up the matter with the Government of India and the state governments,” the statement said.

The director general of the Central Public Works Department and the secretary general of the Supreme Court will also be members of the panel.

The committee is likely to focus on seven key areas, including identifying systemic constraints, improving facilities for litigants and lawyers and implementing cutting-edge technology to accelerate case disposal. It will also focus on the “e-courts” initiative to bridge the digital divide and the construction of “modern court complexes” designed for the 21st century.

AGENCIES

Nation Briefs

MILKFED’S SMART VENDING MACHINE INAUGURATED AT PUNJAB SECRETARIAT

CHANDIGARH: In a move aimed at strengthening the cooperative sector and expanding its outreach, an ultra-modern vending machine of Milkfed was inaugurated at Punjab Civil Secretariat-1 by Punjab Chief Secretary K. A. P. Sinha on Tuesday. The machine will dispense Tetrapack flavoured milk beverages, lassi, fruit juices, mineral water and ice creams, enhancing easy access to products under Brand Verka, Brand Sohna and Brand Five Rivers. The initiative aims to provide fresh, hygienic and easily accessible Verka products at prominent public locations across the state. On the occasion, “Guddi”, the girl companion of Verka’s popular mascot Veera, was also unveiled.

NFR CENTRAL HOSPITAL PARTICIPATES IN DRIVE TO IMPROVE NEW-BORN SURVIVAL

MALIGAON: The Central Hospital of Northeast Frontier Railway actively participated in the nationwide Neonatal Resuscitation Program (NRP) Day on May 10, reaffirming its commitment towards strengthening new-born healthcare and reducing preventable neonatal deaths. As part of the programme, 15 healthcare professionals participated in a dedicated training session conducted at Central Hospital, Maligaon. The session was led by Dr Immanuel Tuolor, Senior Divisional Medical Officer, Paediatrics Department, who served as the Lead Instructor. The event was coordinated by Dr KMSK Krishna, Senior Divisional Medical Officer, Paediatrics Department.



EDITORIAL
DREAMS
INTERRUPTED

For millions of students across India, NEET is not just another entrance examination. It is a test that quietly takes over entire households for years. Meals are planned around coaching schedules, family outings are postponed, sleep becomes irregular, and adolescence itself is often sacrificed at the altar of a single dream — securing a medical seat. That is why the cancellation of NEET-UG 2026 after allegations of paper leaks and examination irregularities feels far bigger than an administrative failure. From a student's perspective, it feels like the collapse of trust. The decision to cancel the examination may have been necessary if the integrity of the process had indeed been compromised. No honest student can argue that a tainted examination should stand. But acknowledging the necessity of the decision does not erase the emotional devastation it has caused. Students who had spent two or three years preparing relentlessly believed they had finally crossed the finish line on May 3. Some had performed well enough to secure admission to government medical colleges. Many had already begun imagining a different life — perhaps the first relaxed conversations with family in months, perhaps a rare holiday after years of pressure, perhaps simply the relief of waking up without a physics formula waiting beside the bed. That sense of closure has now been violently interrupted.

What makes the situation worse is that this crisis no longer feels exceptional. The fear among students today is not only about this year's examination but about the future of the system itself. Repeated allegations of leaks, inflated scores, cheating rackets, and organised malpractice have slowly created the impression that large national examinations are vulnerable despite elaborate claims of security. Students are repeatedly told about AI surveillance, GPS-tracked transport, biometric verification, and encrypted systems. Yet each scandal deepens the gap between official assurances and lived reality. For a teenager preparing in Kota, Patna, Lucknow, Guwahati, or Bhubaneswar, the question becomes painfully simple: if such extensive safeguards still fail, what exactly is protecting honest effort? This uncertainty creates a unique kind of psychological exhaustion. Competitive examinations are already emotionally brutal. The preparation demands long hours, isolation, financial sacrifice, and the constant fear of failure. Many aspirants begin preparing from Class VI or VII, gradually turning childhood into a prolonged cycle of tests and coaching modules. By the time the actual examination arrives, students are mentally depleted. A re-examination, therefore, is not merely "another test." It means restarting a process that had emotionally concluded. Students who had finally allowed themselves to relax must now return to revision schedules, anxiety, and uncertainty. Those who underperformed may see the re-test as an opportunity, but even they now enter a system overshadowed by suspicion rather than confidence. The emotional burden also extends far beyond the students themselves. In India, examinations like NEET are deeply collective experiences. Entire families invest emotionally and financially in the journey. Parents often relocate children to coaching hubs, borrow money for tuition fees, and reorganise family life around preparation schedules. When such an examination collapses under allegations of malpractice, the damage spreads through thousands of homes. It breeds cynicism among parents and despair among students who already feel trapped in a hyper-competitive system where a single mark can decide a future.

At the same time, the anger among honest candidates is understandable. Many students feel they are being punished for the actions of a dishonest minority. The cancellation has reinforced a painful perception that sincerity alone is no longer sufficient. A student who studied honestly for two years now has to repeat the ordeal because someone else found a way to manipulate the system. That feeling of unfairness is perhaps the most dangerous consequence of all. A nation cannot sustain a competitive examination culture if hardworking students begin believing that integrity offers no guarantee of justice. The debate over whether NEET should move fully online will now grow louder. Many students believe digital examinations could reduce the possibility of paper leaks and organised cheating networks. While online testing comes with its own concerns — unequal internet access, infrastructure gaps, and technical failures — the present model clearly demands urgent reform. India cannot continue conducting examinations for more than 22 lakh students with recurring allegations that undermine credibility every few years. The issue is no longer only about leaks; it is about restoring faith. The government's decision to involve the CBI signals the seriousness of the crisis, but investigations alone will not heal the emotional damage already done. Students need more than inquiries and press statements. They need transparency. They need timelines that are clear and realistic. They need accountability that extends beyond symbolic arrests. Most importantly, they need reassurance that their futures are not being treated casually by institutions entrusted with their aspirations.

For students, NEET is not simply an exam conducted on one day in May. It represents years of discipline, loneliness, hope, and sacrifice. When such an examination becomes vulnerable to allegations of manipulation, the injury is not merely academic. It is deeply personal. India often speaks proudly about its young population and future doctors, scientists, and innovators. But no educational system can truly nurture talent if its brightest students grow up associating merit with uncertainty and ambition with anxiety. The cancellation of NEET-UG 2026 may have been intended to protect fairness. Yet the larger challenge now is rebuilding credibility in a generation that is slowly losing faith in the very system meant to reward its hard work.

BHARAT
KI SOCH



ANIL RAJPUT
THE WRITER IS
CHAIRPERSON
BHARAT KI SOCH

Her story continues to inspire conversations about courage, women's leadership, moral conviction and the defence of dignity in difficult times

Leadership Forged Through Adversity

Rani Lakshmibai's life was not merely a story of battlefield resistance, but a profound lesson in courage, duty and moral conviction

Rani Lakshmibai emerged from one of the most turbulent periods in Indian history as a figure whose courage, patriotism and moral resolve left a lasting imprint far beyond the brief course of her life. Shaped by discipline from an early age, she rose to confront personal bereavement, political betrayal and the violence of war without allowing adversity to diminish her sense of duty. As a queen, she viewed authority not as privilege but as responsibility, as a mother, she carried grief with dignity, and as a leader, in moments of uncertainty, she combined national pride with moral conviction. It also reminds us that the measure of a life is not determined by how many years one lives, but by what one achieves within that time in the service of a purpose larger than oneself.

Born as Manikarnika Tambe in Kashi, she grew up in an environment that fostered independence and courage. Her father, Moropant Tambe, allowed her to train in horse riding, swordsmanship and martial exercises alongside boys, giving her a foundation of physical fitness and mental strength, while the early loss of her mother exposed her to hardship from childhood itself. Her marriage to Maharaja Gangadhar Rao brought her into the ruling house of Jhansi, a kingdom governed by the Newalkar lineage within the wider Maratha political world of Bundelkhand. Gangadhar Rao was not merely a royal figure, but a capable administrator who inherited a state burdened by financial strain and worked to restore order, effective governance and public confidence. In that sense, Jhansi was not simply a throne, but a responsibility grounded in lawful succession, administrative duty and the protection of its people. When Manikarnika became Rani Lakshmibai, and later came to be remembered as Jhansi ki Rani, the title reflected a deep union between ruler, kingdom and public duty. Over time, her identity became inseparable from the fate and honour of Jhansi itself.

The crisis deepened after the death of her infant son and later the passing of Maharaja Gangadhar Rao. Before his death, the royal family adopted Damodar Rao so that the line of succession could continue. In Indian political and social practice, adoption carried moral and legal significance, especially when a ruling house sought continuity. The British East India Company, however, refused to recognise the adopted heir under the Doctrine of Lapse and annexed Jhansi in 1854. This policy allowed the Company to absorb princely states where it denied succession claims, particularly when there was no natural male heir. The motive was not merely administrative but part of a wider effort to consolidate territorial power, revenue and political control. For Rani Lakshmibai, the issue was not simply personal loss or royal entitlement but the disregard of a lineage, a lawful claim and the dignity of a state. Her response illustrates a major lesson of her life, that responsibility must be placed above personal ambition and comfort.



Rani Lakshmibai remains relevant because her life represents more than military bravery

For Rani Lakshmibai, the issue was not simply personal loss or royal entitlement but the disregard of a lineage, a lawful claim and the dignity of a state. Her response illustrates a major lesson of her life, that responsibility must be placed above personal ambition and comfort.

At the same time, another lesson emerges from the way she carried sorrow. Widowhood, the death of her child and the denial of her adopted son's claim could have crushed her resolve. Yet she did not allow grief to define her identity or weaken her judgement. Her life shows resilience and perseverance despite setbacks, not as abstract virtues, but as fortitude that was an inspiration to her subjects.

Her response to the British annexation also teaches us that the response to injustice should be through principled action. She did not resist merely because power had been taken from her. She resisted because an external authority had dismissed the customs, rights and political continuity of Jhansi. Her stand was not an impulsive reaction of wounded pride. It came from the recognition that injustice, when accepted silently, becomes a precedent for further humiliation. A person, institution or nation must know when accommodation preserves peace and when it begins to erode principles and self-respect. Rani Lakshmibai's decision reminds us that moral action often begins with the refusal to call unfairness inevitable.

Another lesson from her life is the necessity to stand firm when concession and compromise appear easier. It is convenient to applaud bravery after history has made it famous. It is harder to understand the isolation that often surrounds it at the moment. Rani

Lakshmibai faced an expanding colonial power with limited resources and uncertain support. The practical choice may have seemed to be surrender, negotiation or retreat into symbolic authority, but she chose to stand with Jhansi in its hour of injustice. Some positions cannot be abandoned without losing something larger than territory. There are moments when survival without honour becomes a diminished form of existence.

Her example also challenges narrow assumptions about public authority and stands as a powerful expression of women empowerment, though not in the language of slogans. She lived in a time when warfare, political decision-making and statecraft were largely in the domain of men. Yet she entered these spaces not as an inconsequential figure of the court, but as the person upon whom Jhansi's future had come to rest. This teaches that dignity is established more through conduct than through assertion. She did not need to announce equality in abstract terms as her actions made the argument stronger than any proclamation could. She led because circumstances demanded leadership, and she fulfilled that responsibility with honesty and seriousness.

As a ruler in crisis, she showed leadership under pressure. Leadership is not tested when conditions are orderly and authority is secure. It is tested when information is incomplete, opposition is formidable, resources are limited and every decision carries consequences. Rani Lakshmibai had to think as a ruler, organise as an administrator, inspire as a commander and endure as a human being. Such a combination required discipline over impulse and clarity over fear. Anger may begin a struggle, but

only judgment can sustain it. Her life teaches that fearless leadership is not noise or aggression, but the ability to act with conviction when uncertainty surrounds every choice.

Her bond with Jhansi reveals another important value of authority as trust. She did not treat the kingdom as personal property but something that was entrusted to her care. This is why the name Jhansi ki Rani continues to carry such force. The people and the ruler became joined in a shared fate. In any age, authority without trusteeship becomes hollow. Whether in governance, institutions, families or public life, power becomes respectable only when it protects those who depend on it and are assured that their interests are in safe hands. In this sense, her life also reflects service before self, where personal interest was placed below the responsibility owed to Jhansi.

Subhadra Kumari Chauhan's immortal line, "Khoob ladi mardani, woh to Jhansi wali Rani thi," captured the place Rani Lakshmibai came to occupy in the national imagination. It reflects the language of an earlier age, expressing fearlessness. Yet, the truth of her life is larger. Rani Lakshmibai made courage a matter of character, not gender. She did not merely challenge the British on the battlefield but defied the limits that society placed on women, rulers and those expected to surrender quietly.

Rani Lakshmibai died near Gwalior in 1858, but the meaning of her life did not end with that battlefield. Jhansi was lost in military terms, yet her example lived far beyond the event itself. Temporary defeat did not define her legacy. History remembers those who show future generations how to respond when justice and honour are in peril. Her life entered the moral memory of the nation because the worth of action is not always measured by immediate success but by the accomplishment of a moral duty.

Rani Lakshmibai's story, therefore, is not a tale of military bravery alone. It is a study of how a human being responds when life removes comfort, power challenges fairness, and history demands a decision. From her journey, we learn that service is larger than self, discipline over impulse, responsibility in the face of loss and the defence of what has been entrusted to us. She remains Jhansi ki Rani not only because she ruled Jhansi, but because she gave Jhansi a place in the conscience of future generations. Her life continues to remind us that greatness is created when position, character and action converge in the service of something higher than personal survival. To remember her is to learn how to live with courage, lead with purpose and stand unwavering in the face of adversity.

Views expressed are personal

POLITICAL
DRIFT



ASIF ULLAH KHAN
THE WRITER
HAS WORKED IN
SENIOR EDITORIAL
POSITIONS FOR
MANY RENOWNED
INTERNATIONAL
PUBLICATIONS

The simultaneous rise of Reform UK and the Green Party reveals a Britain united not by ideology, but by disillusionment

Collapse of Consensus?

Opposite political movements are growing simultaneously as Britons increasingly lose faith in economic stability, public services and traditional parties

The impressive showing of Reform UK and the Green Party in Britain's recent local elections has exposed a striking paradox at the heart of modern UK politics. Two movements that appear ideologically opposite — one nationalist and anti-immigration, the other progressive and climate-focused — are rising simultaneously from the same political soil.

On one side stands Reform UK, led by Nigel Farage, channelling anti-establishment anger, hostility toward immigration, and distrust of Westminster elites. On the other side stand the Greens, increasingly shaped by figures such as Zack Polanski, attracting younger voters frustrated by inequality, housing insecurity, and climate inaction.

At first glance, their politics could hardly seem more different. Reform speaks the language of borders, sovereignty, and national identity. The Greens speak of sustainability, redistribution, and social justice. One movement fears cultural decline; the other fears ecological and economic collapse.

Yet both are growing because Britain's deeper crisis is not fundamentally ideological. It is structural.

For more than a decade, Britain has endured weak productivity growth, stagnant wages, severe housing shortages, deteriorating infrastructure, widening regional inequality, and overloaded public services. These failures have accumulated slowly but relentlessly, creating a national mood of frustration and exhaustion. The issue is no longer simply whether people dislike particular politicians. Increasingly, many Britons doubt whether the country itself still functions effectively.



Both parties are growing because Britain's crisis is not ideological, it is structural

That loss of confidence is transforming politics.

The old two-party system depended on an implicit social bargain. Voters tolerated imperfect governments because they broadly believed living standards would improve over time. Stable employment, accessible housing, functioning public services, and gradual upward mobility created enough confidence to sustain political moderation.

Today, that confidence has eroded.

Britain's productivity slowdown has left wages stagnant for years. Younger workers often feel poorer than their parents despite being more educated. Housing costs, especially in southern England, have detached dramatically from incomes, turning homeownership into an increasingly distant aspiration. Public infrastructure — from railways to local transport to roads — often appears visibly strained. Meanwhile, the NHS and

local councils struggle under rising demand and limited capacity.

These conditions produce not merely economic stress but political fragmentation.

Reform UK converts frustration into a politics of national control. Its central argument is that Britain's elites lost control — of borders, immigration, and national direction. Immigration becomes more than a policy debate; it becomes a symbol of state incapacity. Housing shortages, pressure on public services, and economic insecurity are folded into a broader narrative of decline overseen by disconnected political elites.

Farage's success lies in offering a simple emotional diagnosis for complex structural problems: ordinary people versus a political class that no longer understands the country it governs.

The Greens interpret the same crisis through a different lens. Their supporters see economic insecurity, unaffordable housing, and deteriorating public

services as evidence that Britain's economic model no longer serves younger generations. Climate change intensifies this anxiety, reinforcing the sense that mainstream politics is incapable of planning for the future.

In this sense, Reform UK and the Greens are paradoxically mirror images of one another. Both reject the political establishment. Both thrive on distrust of traditional parties. Both attract voters who feel excluded from the promises of modern Britain. But they offer radically different explanations for why the country feels broken — and radically different visions of how to fix it.

This is what makes the current moment so politically significant. Britain is not simply shifting left or right. It is entering a post-consensus era in which the old political center no longer commands automatic public loyalty.

The danger is not necessarily extremism. It is instability. When large parts of the electorate lose faith that mainstream parties can deliver rising living standards, functioning infrastructure, affordable housing, or competent public services, politics becomes increasingly driven by anger, identity, and protest. Some voters gravitate toward nationalism and border control; others toward climate activism and economic redistribution. What unites them is a belief that the status quo is failing.

The rise of Reform UK and the Greens should therefore not be viewed as separate phenomena. Together, they are symptoms of the same national condition: a Britain struggling to restore faith in its institutions, its economy, and its future.

Views expressed are personal

TRUMP TO LAND IN BEIJING TODAY FOR CRUCIAL TALKS ON IRAN WAR, TARIFFS

Trump, Xi appear intent on keeping deep differences over Iran war

WASHINGTON: President Donald Trump on Tuesday is set to leave for Beijing to meet with President Xi Jinping after weeks of trying, and failing, to persuade the Chinese government to use its considerable leverage to prod Iran to agree to US terms to end the two-month old war — or at the very least, reopen the critical Strait of Hormuz.

Trump has veered between venting that China, the world's biggest buyer of Iranian oil, hasn't done more to get the Islamic Republic in line, and acknowledging that Xi's government helped de-escalate the conflict last month by nudging Tehran back to ceasefire talks when negotiations wobbled.

But ahead of the US leader's high-stakes visit, the White House has set low expectations that Trump will be able to persuade Xi to change China's posture.

Instead, the administration seems determined not to let differences on Iran overshadow efforts to make headway on other difficult matters in the complicated relationship — ranging from trade to further Chinese cooperation to block exports ofentanyl precursors.

"We don't want this to be something that derails the broader relationship or the agreements that might come out of our meeting in Bei-



US President Donald Trump with Chinese counterpart Xi Jinping

jing," US Trade Representative Jamieson Greer said on Bloomberg TV last week.

US administration sanctioned China ahead of the trip. Beijing publicly insists that it wants to see the war end, and has been working diplomatically behind the scenes to help its ally Pakistan push to broker a peace agreement.

It has also sent a "subtle message of discontent to Iran" for closing the Strait of Hormuz, and to the US for its blockade of Iranian shipping, said Ahmed Aboudouh, a spe-

Highlights

» Trump was the last US President to visit China in 2017, during his first term

» Trump's schedule included a visit to the Temple of Heaven, a complex of imperial temples where emperors would pray for a good harvest

cialist on China's influence in

the Middle East with the London-based Chatham House think tank.

"They are very cautious, risk-averse, and they don't want to be involved in anything that would drag them into something that they don't consider their problem," he said.

In recent days, Secretary of State Marco Rubio and Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent have stepped up their calls for China to use its influence to help reopen the strait, through which about 20 per cent of the world's crude flowed

before the war began.

The State Department announced on Friday that it was sanctioning four entities, including three China-based firms, for providing sensitive satellite imagery that enables Iranian military strikes against US forces in the Middle East.

Earlier, the Treasury Department moved to target Chinese oil refineries accused of purchasing oil from Tehran, as well as shippers of the oil.

The sanctions cut off the companies from the US financial system and penalise anyone who does business with them. Beijing has called the sanctions "illegal unilateral pressure" and enacted a blocking statute — passed in 2021 and never used until now — that prohibits any Chinese entity from recognising or complying with the sanctions.

Ahead of Trump's arrival, Chinese Foreign Minister Wang Yi last week hosted his Iranian counterpart Abbas Araghchi in Beijing. The Chinese foreign minister used the moment to defend Iran's right to develop civilian nuclear energy.

He has said that safeguarding international rule of law is paramount, adding it "must not be selectively applied or disregarded," nor should the world be allowed to revert "to the law of the jungle."

AGENCIES

Kuwait accuses Iran of sending armed IRGC to attack an island

DUBAI: Kuwait accused Iran on Tuesday of sending an armed paramilitary Revolutionary Guard team to attack an island in the Middle East nation home to a China-funded port project, just before US President Donald Trump travels to Beijing for a meeting with Chinese President Xi Jinping.

Iran didn't immediately acknowledge the allegation by Kuwait, which came under repeated attack by Iran in the war and even during the shaky ceasefire still holding in the region. However, the allegation and ongoing attacks throughout the region have threatened to tip the region back into open warfare. The accusation came as the US ambassador to Israel, Mike Huckabee, said that Israel sent Iron Dome anti-missile batteries and personnel to operate them to the United Arab Emirates to defend the country during the war as well.

That underlined the growing defence relationship between Israel and the UAE,



BUBIYAN ISLAND IS HOME TO MUBARAK AL KABEER PORT, WHICH IS UNDER CONSTRUCTION AS PART OF BRI

countries long suspicious of Iran.

It also represents the first publicly acknowledged deployment of Israel's military to the Emirates, a federation of seven sheikdoms on the Arabian Peninsula home to Abu

Dhabi and Dubai. The narrow Strait of Hormuz remains in Tehran's chokehold, and negotiations between the US and Iran appear at a standstill for the moment — also raising the risk of the conflict breaking out again.

Kuwait said that a team of six armed members of the Guard tried to infiltrate Bubiyan Island in the northwest corner of the Persian Gulf near Iraq and Iran.

It accused the team of planning to carry out "hostile acts." Kuwait said that it detained four of the men, while two escaped. Kuwait, which said one of its security officials had been wounded in the attack.

Bubiyan Island is home to Mubarak Al Kabeer Port, which is under construction as part of China's "Belt and Road" initiative. That project also came under attack during the war by Iran.

Trump is travelling this week to China for a summit with Xi, during which Iran will likely be a topic.

AGENCIES

Hezbollah leader urges Lebanon to quit direct Israel talks

BEIRUT: The leader of Lebanon's militant Hezbollah group called on the government Tuesday to withdraw from direct talks with Israel, calling them a concession and urging "indirect negotiations."

Lebanon and Israel are scheduled to hold two days of

talks in Washington starting Thursday in an attempt to end the latest fighting that broke out two months ago, following the Iran war, and discuss the future of relations between the two sides that have been at war since Israel was created in 1948.

AGENCIES

Spain reports new hantavirus case; confirmed infections at 9

THE HAGUE: A Spanish passenger evacuated from the cruise ship at the centre of a hantavirus outbreak has tested positive for the virus, Spain's health ministry announced Tuesday as the World Health Organisation said it has now confirmed nine cases. Three people on the cruise died.

The passenger with the new confirmed case of hantavirus was in quarantine at a military hospital in Madrid, where 13 other Spanish nationals evacuated Sunday also are staying.

They all tested negative for the virus. After evacuation, the MV Hondius is now sailing back to the Netherlands.

AGENCIES

Hegseth faces bipartisan grilling about weapons drawdown during Iran war

WASHINGTON: Defence Secretary Pete Hegseth faced tough questions Tuesday from Republican and Democratic lawmakers about the Trump administration's end game for the Iran war, the cost of the conflict and its impact on diminishing US weapons stockpiles.

For his part, the Penta-

gon chief softened his tone from hearings before Congress nearly two weeks ago, notably avoiding the same pointed criticism of lawmakers in his opening remarks as he outlined the Trump administration's efforts to ramp up production of weapons and other military capabilities.

Even so, Hegseth insisted that the military has plenty of missile defence systems and other munitions for the Iran war or future conflicts as both Republicans and Democrats hammered him with those concerns.

"I take issue with the characterisation that munitions are

depleted in a public forum," Hegseth said. "That's not true."

The cost of the Iran war has risen to about \$29 billion, the vast bulk of which — \$24 billion — is related to replacing and repairing munitions but also includes operational costs to keep forces deployed, Pentagon said.

AGENCIES

UK PM Starmer remains defiant in face of Cabinet rebellion



UK PM Keir Starmer

'The past 48 hours have been destabilising for govt, and that has a real economic cost for our country and for families'

ment could be seen as a dare by some Labour members of Parliament who have been pressuring Starmer to set out a timetable for his departure.

"Our country faces enormous challenges and people are crying out for the scale of change that this requires. The public does not believe that you can lead this change — and nor do I," said Fahnehle, in her ministerial resignation letter

to Starmer. "Therefore, I urge you to do the right thing for the country and the Party and set a timetable for an orderly transition so that a new team can deliver the change we promised the country," she said.

It follows former Indo-Pacific minister Catherine West "giving notice" that she was collecting names to push Starmer into setting a timetable for the "election of a new leader in September".

At least 81 Labour MPs are required to mount a public challenge to pave the way for a leadership election.

According to media reports, some senior Cabinet figures, including Home Secretary Shabana Mahmood and Foreign Secretary Yvette Cooper, are among those calling for Starmer to go.

AGENCIES

ONE DIES LATER

Thailand: 4 Indian tourists 'mysteriously' faint at cafe

BANGKOK: An Indian national, who was among four tourists who were hospitalised after mysteriously losing consciousness at a cafe in Thailand's Phuket, has died, the Indian embassy here said on Tuesday.

The circumstances surrounding his death were not immediately clear.

The embassy said it has

been in touch with the Thai authorities and it's closely monitoring the incident in which four Indian tourists fell unconscious in Phuket on May 9 and were subsequently hospitalised for treatment.

"Our deepest condolences for the death of one young Indian tourist among them," the Indian mission said in a post on X.

AGENCIES

COURT NOTICE
(U/o 5 Rule 20 CPC)
IN THE COURT OF
Sh. Sohan Lal Malik
Additional Civil Judge (Senior Division), Bhiwani
Diya (minor) Daughter of Nisha Grewal
Vs.
General Public
CNR No. HRBH02-001590-2021
Next Date 18-05-2026
PUBLICATION ISSUED TO:
General Public
->
Bhiwani
In above titled case, the defendant (s)/ respondent(s) could not be served. It is ordered that defendant(s)/ respondent(s) should appear in person or through counsel on **18-05-2026** at **10:00 am**.
For details logon to https://highcourthd.gov.in/?mod=district_notice&district=Bhiwani
Sd/- Sh. Sohan Lal Malik
Additional Civil Judge (Senior Division), Bhiwani
Dated 11.05-2026 Bhiwani

S. E. RAILWAY – TENDER
DRM/ENGG, South Eastern Railway, Chakradharpur acting for & on behalf of the President of India invites E-Tenders against Open Tender. Manual Offers are not allowed against these tenders, and any such manual offer received shall be ignored. **SI.No.-1, Tender Notice No.: CKP-CENTRAL-26-27-08, Date: 11.05.2026, Name of work:** Provision of Standard Height Gauge for 3 nos. of Level Crossings (viz. RB-14, RB-15 and RB-3) under the jurisdiction of DEN/Central in Chakradharpur Division. **Tender Value:** ₹ 39,76,117.19. **EMD:** ₹ 79,500. **SI.No.-2, Tender Notice No.: CKP-CENTRAL-26-27-09, Date: 11.05.2026, Name of work:** (I) Construction of badminton court at Chakradharpur and (II) Renovation of AICTC Training Hostel at Chakradharpur. **Tender Value:** ₹ 1,03,00,471.14. **EMD:** ₹ 2,06,000. **SI.No.-3, Tender Notice No.: CKP-CENTRAL-26-27-10, Date: 11.05.2026, Name of work:** (I) CTR (P) for 13.702 KM new 60 KG 260 Mtr Rail on PSC (RT - 8746) (1660 Nos./KM) (Existing PSC Sleepers) in between A - Cabin Bondamunda-Bimalgarh-Barsuan under the jurisdiction of ADEN/Bondamunda. (II) Casual Sleeper Renewal (CSR) between Patasahi-Bimalgarh Up/Line KM: 451.752-452.821 = 1.069 KMs under the jurisdiction of SSE/P.WAY/Dumerta Unit. **Tender Value:** ₹ 2,88,19,822.88. **EMD:** ₹ 5,76,400. **SI.No.-4, Tender Notice No.: CKP-EAST-26-27-09, Date: 11.05.2026, Name of work:** Construction of LHS in lieu of existing manned level crossing No.137 at Km. 242/23-25 between section Asanboni - Salgaighani. **Tender Value:** ₹ 29,09,927.79. **EMD:** ₹ 14,58,200. **Cost of Tender form:** ₹ 0 (for SI.No. 1 to 4 each). **Date of Opening:** 05.06.2026 (for SI.No. 1) & 09.06.2026 (for SI.No. 2 to 4 each). The tender can be viewed at website <http://www.ireps.gov.in>. The tender/bidders must have class-III Digital Signature Certificate & must be registered under on IREPS Portal. Only registered tenderer/bidder can participate on e-tendering. All relevant paper must be uploaded at the time of participating in e-tendering. **Note:** e-Tender Forms shall be issued free of cost to all tenderers. (Authority – Railway Board's letter no. 2020/CE-I/CT/3E/GCC/Policy/ dtd. 16.07.2020). (PR-160)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 82 CrPC
Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused (1) Kuldeep S/o Shyam Babu R/o B-39, Karan Vihar, Kirari Suleman Nagar, North West Delhi (2) Niket S/o Rajesh Sharma R/o A-122, B-39, Karan Vihar, Phase 5, Kirari Suleman Nagar, North West Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case registered vide **FIR No. 0043/2023 U/S 379/411/34 IPC, PS IGI Airport, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest their upon issued that the said accused (1) **Kuldeep & (2) Niket** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said (1) **Kuldeep & (2) Niket** has absconded (or is concealing themselves to avoid the serve of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused (1) **Kuldeep & (2) Niket** of **FIR No. 0043/2023 U/S 379/411/34 IPC, PS IGI Airport, Delhi** is required to appear before this court (or before me) to answer the complaint on or before the day of **30.07.2026**

By Order,
Sh. Pranav Joshi
Addl. Chief Judicial Magistrate-01
Court No. 02, Ground Floor, Main Building
Patiala House Courts, New Delhi

UJVN Ltd.
(An Uttarakhand Govt. Enterprises)
H.Q.: "UJJWAL", Maharani Bagh, G.M.S. ROAD, Dehradun-248006. Phone : 0135-276388 & Fax : 0135-276388
CIN No. - U40101UR2001SGC025866 Website: www.ujvn.com
RO No. 405 TENDER NOTICE Date: 12.05.2026
The Office of Executive Engineer (Maintenance), Maneri Bhali Stage-II, Chinyalisaur (Uttarkashi) invites sealed tenders from interested parties. Brief summary of tenders is given below:
Tender No: NIT- 19/EE (M)/MB-II/2026-27,02/EE (M)/MB-II/2026-27, & 21/EE (M)/MB-II/2026-27,
Name of work / Supply/Services: 1. Servicing of EHG-100/G-40 Governor of Turbine at Dharasu Power House.
2. Rewiring in residential/non-residential buildings at Shaktipuram Colony, Chinyalisaur.
3. Repairing and Overhauling of Centralized Greasing System and other works at Dharasu Power House, MB-II, Uttarkashi.
Estimated cost: Rs 5,30,775 /- Only (Taxes extra), Rs 18,17,840 /- (Taxes Extra), Rs 9,87,766/- (Taxes Extra).
Date of availability of bid document on website: - 13.05.2026
Last date for submission of tender: - 03.06.2026 up to 11:00 Hrs.
For fuller & further details, kindly visit our website. The tender documents can be downloaded from the Nigam's website "www.ujvn.com" **Executive Engineer (Maintenance)**
"AVOID WASTEFUL USE OF ELECTRICITY"

M.P. ROAD DEVELOPMENT CORPORATION LTD.
(Govt. of M.P. Undertaking)
45-A, Arera Hills, Bhopal – 462011
MPRDC Ph. : 0755-2597290/2765205, Fax : 0755-2572643, Website : www.mprdc.gov.in
Advertisement for the Post of परामर्शी
M.P. Road Development Corporation Ltd., is a wholly owned company of Govt. of M.P. looking after State Highways and other Infrastructure Development projects of Madhya Pradesh. MPRDC invites applications from eligible candidates for the following posts for various road projects and the development of surrounding land under the corporation for the Special Area Development Authority (SADA) :-

S.No.	Name of Post & Salary	Source	No. of Post
1.	परामर्शी (विशेष क्षेत्र विकास प्राधिकरण (SADA) अधिकारी) (वित्त विभाग द्वारा जारी परिपत्र क्र. एफ 11-01/2025/नियम/चार भोपाल, दिनांक 02 मई, 2025 अनुसार) राशि रु. 17.50 लाख वार्षिक	Contract	Total-01 UR-01
2.	परामर्शी (लेण्ड पुलिंग अधिकारी) (वित्त विभाग द्वारा जारी परिपत्र क्र. एफ 11-01/2025/नियम/चार भोपाल, दिनांक 02 मई, 2025 अनुसार) राशि रु. 7.50 लाख वार्षिक	Contract	Total-01 UR-01

The General Terms and Conditions:
1. Application submitted in the office of Chief General Manager (Admin.), MPRDC, 45-A, Arera Hills, Bhopal (MP) upto **12.06.2026**. Application not submitted in the prescribed format or incomplete in any respect shall stand rejected.
2. Selection will be made on the basis of merit-cum-interview.
3. Appointment on Contract basis initially for One (01) year, which can be extended, based upon satisfactory performance and mutual consent as per the requirements of the MPRDC.
4. MD, MPRDC reserves the right to accept or reject any or all applications without assigning any reason thereof or increase/decrease the positions (no. of post, based on actual position of required) advertised and to fill/not fill them from the merit/waiting list. MPRDC reserves the right not to declare any waiting list.
5. All other details are mentioned in Rule Book and all future Addendum/Corrigendum/Clarifications will be uploaded only the website of www.mprdc.gov.in
M.P. Madhyam/125731/2026 **Dy. GENERAL MANAGER (HR)**

UT of Jammu & Kashmir
Office of the Executive Engineer,
Trans. Line Maintn. Division-VII,
JKPTCL Bemina, Srinagar-190010
Ph. No. 0194-3516481 e-mail: tlmd-vii.sgr@jk.gov.in
TENDER CANCELLATION NOTICE
Due to Technical reasons the e-NIT No. TLMD-7/15 of 2025-26 Dated: 14: 03 : 2026 (Tender ID 2026_PDD_306128_1) for "Augmentation of Grid Station Alusteng from 320 MVA to 475 MVA at 220/132kV level alongwith allied works" is hereby cancelled abinitio.
The e-NIT shall be floated afresh.
No. TLMD7/TS/ 446-50
Dated: -12 / 05 /2026
DIP No:DIPK-NB-461/26
Sd/- Executive Engineer
TLMD-VII Srinagar



सेन्ट्रल बैंक ऑफ इंडिया
Central Bank of India
1911 से आपके लिए "केन्द्रित" "CENTRAL" TO YOU SINCE 1911

Regional Office (Gurugram)
1398, First Floor, Chandni Chowk,
Delhi-110006. Tel: 011-41028985

**E-AUCTION
SALE NOTICE**
(Under SARFAESI Act 2002)

APPENDIX- IV-A [SEE PROVISO TO RULE 8(6) & 9(1)] SALE NOTICE FOR SALE OF IMMOVABLE PROPERTY
E-Auction Sale Notice for Sale of Immovable Assets under the Securitization and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 read with proviso to Rule 8(6) & 9(1) of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002.
Notice is hereby given to the public in general and in particular to the borrower(s) and guarantor(s) that the below described immovable property mortgaged / charged to the secured creditor, the **Physical / Symbolic Possession** of which have been taken by the Authorized officer of **Central Bank of India**, secured creditors, will be sold on **04.06.2026 "As is where is", "As is what is" and "whatever there is"** basis for recovery of dues to the Central Bank of India from below mention Borrower(s) and Guarantor(s). The Reserve Price and earnest money deposit (EMD) is displayed against the details of respective properties. For detailed terms and conditions of the sale, please refer to the link provided in: www.centralbank.bank.in or (<https://BAANKNET.com>)
DESCRIPTION OF PROPERTIES TO BE AUCTIONED ON 04.06.2026 (15 DAYS NOTICE)

S. No.	Name of Branch	Authorised Officer/ B.M.	Name of the Account	Description of Property & Owner Name	Demand Notice Date & Amount Dues (Rs. in Lakhs)	Date & Type of Possession	Reserve Price EMD Bid Increase
1.	Old Rajapuri New Delhi	Ms. Nishat Fatima MOB: 8800013552	MR. MOHAN KUMAR GHOSHAL & MRS. SONALI GHOSHAL	Residential Property Bearing No.23, Third Floor, with Roof / Terrace Rights, built on land area measuring 60 Sq.Yds. or 50.16 Sq.Mtr. with Super Area 540 Sq.Ft. out of Khasra No.64/4, situated in the area of Village Hastsal Now the Residential Colony is known as Mohan Garden Block-K-1 Extension Near Kamal School & ICICI Bank, Uttam Nagar, New Delhi-110059.	Rs.11,41,846.38 on 01.05.2025 + Interest + Other Charges	08.04.2025 (Physical)	₹ 20,00,000.00 ₹ 2,00,000.00 ₹ 20,000.00
2.	Jonapur New Delhi	Mr. Bhushan Kumar Mobile: 9617493179	Mr. Ishwar Singh	EWS Residential Flat No. F-430*1-BHK, Ground Floor Nand Nikunj, NandGhrum, Ghaziabad-201003 Measuring area 19.53 SQ. MTRS in the Name of Mr.Ishwar Singh	Rs.8,00,095.00 on 05.05.2026 + Interest + Other Charges	03.12.2024 (Physical)	₹ 6,90,000.00 ₹ 69,000.00 ₹ 10,000.00

E-AUCTION DATE: 04.06.2026, TIME: 12:00 NOON TO 4:00 P.M WITH AUTO EXTENSION OF 10 MINUTES
Last Date & Time of Submission of EMD and Documents (Online) On or Before: **04.06.2026 Upto 3:30 P.M.** Bidder will register on website: (<https://BAANKNET.com>) and upload KYC documents and after verification of KYC documents by the service provider, EMD to be deposited in Global EMD Wallet through NEFT/RTGS/Transfer (after generation of challan from (<https://BAANKNET.com>)).
The auction will be conducted through the Bank's approved service provider "<https://BAANKNET.com>" E-auction will be held on "**As is where is", "As is what is" and "whatever there is"** basis. (All other charges/dues to the property will be borne by the purchaser).
For detailed terms and conditions please refer to the link provided in www.centralbank.bank.in. Secured Creditor or Auction Platform (<https://BAANKNET.com>) BAANKNET Helpdesk: (+91) 8291220220, E-mail: support.BAANKNET@psballiance.com
NOTICE FOR SUB STATUTORY 15 DAYS SALE NOTICE UNDER RULE 8(6) & 9(1) OF SARFAESI ACT 2002
The borrowers/guarantors/ mortgagors are hereby notified to pay the sum as mentioned above along with upto date interest and ancillary expenses before the date of e-auction, failing which the property will be auctioned/sold and balance dues, if any, will be recovered with interest and cost.
DATE: 12.05.2026
PLACE: DELHI
Authorised Officer, CENTRAL BANK OF INDIA,
Regional Office (Gurugram) Chandni Chowk, Delhi



NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY
E-Tendering Tender Notice

Divisional Railway Manager (Works) N.C. Railway, Jhansi for and behalf of President of India invites sealed "Open Tender" through on Line (E-Tendering) for the following work:
E-Tender No. : JHS-ENGG-N-2026-110 | Approx cost : 59306532.21
Description of work : Gwalior:-Extension of IOH Shed cum sick line in Gwalior coach care centre.
Earnest Money : 11861000 | Date of closing Tender. : 01.06.2026 at 15:00 hrs.
Date of completion/period from issue acceptance letter : 10 Months.
* Tender online can be submitted upto to 15:00 hrs on **01.06.2026** * For full details and submission of bid please see the Indian Railways website www.irops.gov.in 1042/26 (C)
North central railways | www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in | CPRONCR

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 82 (2) (ii) Cr. P.C.

Whereas a complaint has been made before me that accused persons namely **1.Raju Kumar @ Praveen S/o Seeta Ram 2.Smt. Rukmani Devi W/o Seeta Ram R/o B-109-112, Vijay Nagar, Mohan Garden, Uttam Nagar, Dwarka and Village: Binalpura Ki Dhani, PS. Bassi, Th. Govindgarh, Distt. Jaipur, Rajasthan and Kanauta Hardi ki Dhani, Jaipur, Dhosva Vale on Highways** have committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence under **FIR No. 303/2019 U/s 498A/406/34 IPC.**, has been registered at **P.S. Punjabi Bagh, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest there upon issued that the said, **1.Raju Kumar @ Praveen 2.Smt. Rukmani Devi** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said, **1.Raju Kumar @ Praveen 2.Smt. Rukmani Devi** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).
Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused, **1.Raju Kumar @ Praveen 2.Smt. Rukmani Devi** of **FIR No. 303/2019 U/s 498A/406/34 IPC.**, registered at **P.S. Punjabi Bagh, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **09.07.2026**.
By Order
Ms. Shivli Talwar
DP/5982/WD/2026 JMFC (Mahila Court)-01 (West)
(Court Notice) Tis Hazari Court, Delhi

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 82 Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused person Namely **Avinash Kumar S/o Nagendra Singh R/o 107, 1st Floor, Flat No. 12, Sarpanch Wada, Near Lucky Public School Mandawali, Delhi Also At: H. No. A-240, Gali No. 5, West Vinod Nagar Mandawali, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 1126/2014 U/s 394/34 IPC PS: Mandawali, Delhi**, and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Avinash Kumar** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Avinash Kumar** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).
Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Avinash Kumar** accused of (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 1126/2014 U/s 394/34 IPC PS: Mandawali, Delhi**, is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **22.07.2026**.
By Order
Sh. Sachin
DP/6245/ED/2026 JMFC-03, East Disstrict, Room No-16
(Court Matter) Karkardooma Court, Delhi



NORTHERN RAILWAY
INVITATION OF TENDERS
THROUGH E-PROCUREMENT SYSTEM

Tender Notice No. 11 /2026-2027 Date : 12.05.2026
Principal Chief Materials Manager, Northern Railway, New Delhi-110001, for and on behalf of the President of India, invites e-tenders through e-procurement system for supply of the following items:-

S. Tender N. No.	Brief Description	Qty.	Closing Date
01 19260899	SET OF AXLE BOX COMPLETE	31 SET	01.06.26
02 04260079	LIGHT DIESEL OIL	166 KLTR	02.06.26
03 77256427A	TUNGSTEN CARBIDE TAMPING TOOL (TCTT) FOR - 09-3X/DTIE MACHINE	27 SET	03.06.26
04 77256552A	TUNGSTEN CARBIDE TAMPING TOOLS (TCTT) FOR OLD CSM	16 SET	03.06.26
05 09263052	ALUMINIUM PAINT FOR GENERAL PURPOSES IN DUAL CONTAINER.	39284 LTR	08.06.26
06 08260026	ROUTE SIGNAL LIGHTING	3147 NOS	09.06.26
07 77269062	RUNNING CONTRACT FOR HVN LINERS (T-8993 & T-8994)	33500 SET	09.06.26
08 77265261	MANUFACTURING AND SUPPLY OF LEAF SPRING TO RDSO DRG. NO. T-6310	50400 NOS	09.06.26
09 07265033	SET OF SEATS AND BERTHS FOR LHB AC 3T COACHES	11 SET	10.06.26
10 08260026	RED ASPECT MAIN LED SIGNAL	2307 NOS	11.06.26
11 02260080	MICROPROCESSOR CONTROLLER FOR ROOF MOUNTED	472 NOS	15.06.26
12 08265205	RGC TENDER FOR 12 CORE X 1.5 SQ. MM	11538 KM	16.06.26
13 02261855	HIGH CAPACITY INTER VEHICULAR COUPLERS ZS	114 SET	22.06.26
14 02262141	CONDENSER FAN MOTOR 0.75KW	1847 NOS	20.07.26

NOTE -1. Vendors may visit the IREPS website i.e. www.irops.gov.in for details.
2. No Manual offer will be entertained.
1582/26
SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

वरिय पुलिस अधीक्षक का कार्यालय, रौंजी
सर्वसाधारण के लिए सूचना



नाम-उमर फारूख, उम्र-56 वर्ष, उँचाई-6 फीट, रंग-सॉबला, पहनावा-पिंक रंग का टी शर्ट एवं छिन्दार लूंगी पहने हुए हैं।
उपरोक्त लापता व्यक्ति उमर फारूख, उम्र-56 वर्ष, पिता-स्व0 मोहम्मद हुसैन, सा0-हरिश्चपुर सिमनागढ़, थाना-कोड़ा, जिला-कटिहार (बिहार) जो दिनांक-21.04.2026 को सी0आई0पी0 अस्पताल रौंजी से बगैर बताए कहीं चले गए जो आजतक अपने घर वापस नहीं आए हैं। जिनकी मानसिक स्थिति ठीक नहीं है। जिसके संबंध में कॉके थाना सन्धा सं0-10 / 2026, दिनांक-22.04.2026 दर्ज कर इनकी खोजबीन की जा रही है। उपरोक्त सूचना को सार्वजनिक किया जाना आवश्यक है।
अतः सभी जनसाधारण से अनुरोध है कि यदि उपरोक्त लापता व्यक्ति कहीं मिलता / दिखता है तो इसके संबंध में वरीय पुलिस अधीक्षक के कार्यालय में या निम्नांकित फोन नम्बर पर संपर्क कर इसकी सूचना दें।
Email ID(mc-dcb@jhpolice.gov.in)
पुलिस उपधीक्षक, मु0 प्रथम, रौंजी। -9431706141
थाना प्रभारी, कॉके, रौंजी। -9431706185
वरिय पुलिस अधीक्षक, रौंजी
PR 379603 Police(26-27).D



JHARKHAND BIJLI VITRAN NIGAM LIMITED
(CIN: U40108JH2013SGC001702)
Regd. Office:- Engineering Building, HEC, Dhurwa, Ranchi-834004.
fax # 0651-2400483 e-mail : cesp.jseb@rediffmail.com / gmsp.jbvn@rediffmail.com

Corrigendum Notice
Last date of uploading of bid documents, last date of online submission of tender fee and bid opening date of following tender notice no. is hereby revised as below :-

Sl. No.	NITs No.	Revised online bid uploading/ submission end date	Revised Last date of online submission of tender fee and EMD	Revised Technical bid opening date and time
1	65/PRJBVN/2026-27 33 KV, 1250 Amp. Outdoor type VCB with CT, PT & CRP	01.06.2026 upto 18:00 Hrs	01.06.2026 upto 18:00 Hrs.	02.06.2026 upto 18:00 Hrs.
2	66/PRJBVN/2026-27 11 KV, 1250 Amp. Outdoor type VCB with CT, PT & CRP	01.06.2026 upto 18:00 Hrs	01.06.2026 upto 18:00 Hrs.	02.06.2026 upto 18:00 Hrs.
3	67/PRJBVN/2026-27 Super Enamelled Aluminium Winding Wire of different size	01.06.2026 upto 18:00 Hrs	01.06.2026 upto 18:00 Hrs.	02.06.2026 upto 18:00 Hrs.
4	68/PRJBVN/2026-27 ISI Marked ACSR Panther Conductor	01.06.2026 upto 18:00 Hrs	01.06.2026 upto 18:00 Hrs.	02.06.2026 upto 18:00 Hrs.

Further details against the above NITs can be seen on website <http://jharkhandtenders.gov.in> and may be contacted on Mobile No. 9470378503/ 9430348596/ NIC helpline No. 0651-2400178. Only online payment mode of submission of Tender Fee & EMD will be accepted.

PR No. 379143
PR 379640 (Jharkhand Bijli Vitran Nigam Ltd)26-27*D

स्वहति एवं राष्ट्रहित में ऊर्जा बचाव। कृपया अपनी शिकायतोंको टोल फ्री नं० 1800 345 6570 पर दर्ज करावें।

Sd/-
Dy. General Manager
Purchase



GODREJ FINANCE

PUBLIC NOTICE
GODREJ FINANCE LIMITED
Registered office at Godrej One, Pirojshanagar, Eastern Express Highway, Vikhroli (East) Mumbai-400079 Maharashtra
Branch Office: Godrej Capital, R – 5, Green Park (M), Near Haldiram's, [New Delhi 110016
DEMAND NOTICE
Under Section 13(2) of the Securitisation And Reconstruction of Financial Assets And Enforcement Of Security Interest Act, 2002 read with Rule 3 (1) of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002. The undersigned is the Authorised Officer of Godrej Finance Limited under Securitisation And Reconstruction Of Financial Assets And Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 (the said Act). In exercise of powers conferred under Section 13(12) of the said Act read with Rule 3 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002, the Authorised Officer has issued Demand Notices under section 13(2) of the said Act, calling upon the following Borrower(s) (the "said Borrower(s)"), to repay the amounts mentioned in the respective Demand Notice(s) issued to them (that are also given below. In connection with above, Notice is hereby given, once again, to the said Borrower(s) to pay to Godrej Finance Limited, within 60 days from the publication of this Notice, the amounts indicated herein below, together with further interest as detailed in the said Demand Notice(s), from the date(s) mentioned below till the date of payment and/or realization, payable under the loan agreement read with other documents/writings, if any, executed by the said Borrower(s). As security for due repayment of the loan, the following assets have been mortgaged to Godrej Finance Limited by the said Borrower(s) respectively.

Name of the Borrower(s)/ Guarantor(s)/ Loan Account Number	Demand Notice Date, Amount and NPA Date	Description of secured asset (immovable property)
1. Mr. Nitin Sharma (Applicant/ Borrower), W/o Pitambar Dutt Sharma, 02, Pratap Khand, Vishawarkma Nagar, V. K. Nagar, PO Jhilmil, Dist East Delhi, New Delhi- 110095. 2. Mrs. Ritu Sharma (Co-Aplicant/ Co-Borrower), W/o Mr. Nitin Sharma, 02, Pratap Khand, Vishawarkma Nagar, V. K. Nagar, PO Jhilmil, Dist East Delhi, New Delhi- 110095. Loan Account No. GFL3301LD0048657	08.05.2026 Rs. 40,64,485/- (INR Forty Lakhs Sixty Four Thousand Four Hundred and Eighty Five Only) 8th May 2026	Description of The Property- Property Being A Flat No. S-4, Second Floor, With Roof Rights (Rear RHS Portion), Property No. 91, Gyan Khand-1, Indrapuram, Ghaziabad, Uttar Pradesh- 201014

If the said Borrowers shall fail to make payment to Godrej Finance Limited as aforesaid, Godrej Finance Limited shall proceed against the above secured assets under Section 13(4) of the Act and the applicable Rules, entirely at the risks of the said Borrowers as to the costs and consequences. The said Borrowers are prohibited under the Act from transferring the aforesaid assets, whether by way of sale, lease or otherwise without the prior written consent of Godrej Finance Limited. Any person who contravenes or abets contravention of the provisions of the said Act or Rules made there under, shall be liable for imprisonment and/or penalty as provided under the Act.
Date: May 13, 2026, Place: Ghaziabad
(Authorised Officer), Godrej Finance Limited



New Okhla Industrial Development Authority
Main Administrative Building, Sector-6, Noida, G.B. Nagar, (U.P.)
Website: www.noidaauthorityonline.in

E-TENDER NOTICE
E-Tender are invited from firms/contractors registered with UPLC Lucknow for the following jobs against which bids can be uploaded and same shall be opened/downloaded as per schedule mentioned. The details and conditions of all tenders are available on NOIDA Authority's official website: www.noidaauthorityonline.in & <http://etender.up.nic.in>. Please ensure to see these websites for any changes/ amendments & corrigendum etc.
(A)
1. **01/Advt./S.M./2026-27**, Advertising Rights on BOT Basis on Unipole at Kalandi Kunj for a period of 01 Year, Noida. Cost Rs. 12.17 Lacs.
Which can be uploaded by date:- 26.05.2026 upto 5.00 P.M. Pre-qualification shall be opened/downloaded on date:- 28.05.2026 at 11.00 AM.
(B)
1. **38/S.M.-Jal-III/E.T./2025-26**, Strengthening of Sewerage (P/Making Sewer Connection with Sewer Line from Pocket 7 & 12 Sector-82 to Across Road Deep Sewer Line Super MIG Sector-93), Noida. Cost Rs. 23.07 Lacs.
Which can be uploaded by date:- 19.05.2026 upto 5.00 P.M. Pre-qualification shall be opened/downloaded on date:- 20.05.2026 at 11.00 AM.
General Manager (Jal)
NOIDA
CLEAN, GREEN, SAFE & SECURE NOIDA



NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

No.-Dy.CEE/PUC/NB/26-27/T-03 Date- 12.05.2026
E-Tendering Tender Notice
Dy. Chief Electrical Engineer (Project), N.C. Railway, Kanpur for and behalf of President of India invites sealed "Open Tender" through on Line (E-Tendering) for the following work:
E-Tender No.: Dy.CEE/PUC/NB/26-27/T-03
Description of work: Design, Supply, Erection, Testing & Commissioning for upgradation of existing 1x25KV Electric Traction System into 2x25KV Electric Traction System between Govindpur (GOY)(excluding)-Virangana Lakshmi Bai Jhansi (VGLJ) (excluding) section of Jhansi Division of North Central Railway.
Approx Cost : ₹ 1599891246.43 **Earnest Money :** ₹ 31997800.00
Cost of Tender Form: ₹ 00 **Validity of Tender:** 90 days.
Date of closing Tender: 01.06.2026 15.00 hrs.
Date of completion/period from issue acceptance letter: 24 Months
* Tender online can be submitted upto to 15:00 hrs on **01.06.2026** * For full details and submission of bid please see the Indian Railways website www.irops.gov.in 1069/26 (A)
North central railways | CPRONCR | www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

Public Work Department
Office of the Executive Engineer Public Works (West)
Division Chhatrapati Sambhajnagar
Address :- Public Works Premise, Padampur, Chhatrapati Sambhajnagar 431005
E-mail address: westaurangabad.ee@mahapwd.gov.in
Telephone/Fax Number :-0240 2331288
E-Tender Notice No.(03) of 2026-27
E-Tender for the following work in B-1 Tender Form is invited via online e- tendering system from Eligible Contractor by the Executive Engineer, Public Works (west) Division, Chhatrapati Sambhajnagar on behalf of Public Works Department, Government of Maharashtra Tender Document are downloaded from government portal <https://pwd.maharashtra.gov.in> Right to select or reject is reserved by Executive Engineer, Public works (west) Division, Chhatrapati Sambhajnagar. Conditional Tender will be not accepted. (Number of 04 Works)
All information of e-tender is available on following portal.
A) <https://pwd.maharashtra.gov.in>
B) <https://mahatenders.gov.in>
If any change made in this e-tender is informed on above portal.
Sd/-Executive Engineer
Public Works (west) Division
Sambhajnagar
DGIPR/2026-2027 / 745

वरिय पुलिस अधीक्षक का कार्यालय, रौंजी
सर्वसाधारण के लिए सूचना



नाम-उसा कुमारी, उम्र-21 वर्ष, उँचाई-05 फिट, रंग-सॉबला, पहनावा-सलवार सूट पहनी हुई हैं।
उपरोक्त लापता महिला उसा कुमारी, पिता-शिवमंडल रविदास, पता-ग्राम-मदनडीह, पो0-लालालींग, थाना-लालालींग, जिला-चतरा जो दिनांक-22.04.2026 को बगैर बताए कहीं चली गई जो आजतक अपने घर वापस नहीं आई हैं। जिसके संबंध में अरगोड़ा थाना काण्ड सं0-28 / 2026, दिनांक-22.04.2026 दर्ज कर इनकी खोजबीन की जा रही है। उपरोक्त सूचना को सार्वजनिक किया जाना आवश्यक है।
अतः सभी जनसाधारण से अनुरोध है कि यदि उपरोक्त लापता महिला कहीं मिलती / दिखती है तो इसके संबंध में वरीय पुलिस अधीक्षक के कार्यालय में या निम्नांकित फोन नम्बर पर संपर्क कर इसकी सूचना दें।
Email ID(mc-dcb@jhpolice.gov.in)
पुलिस उपधीक्षक, हटिया, रौंजी। -9431706143
थाना प्रभारी, आरगोड़ा, रौंजी। -9431706170
वरिय पुलिस अधीक्षक, रौंजी
PR 379619 Police (26-27)_D



GOVT. OF JAMMU AND KASHMIR
OFFICE OF THE ASSISTANT DIRECTOR GOVT. SHEEP BREEDING FARM THATHRI
Email. Id:- adthathri-shdj@jk.gov.in
AUCTION NOTICE

It is to inform general public through the medium of this notice that general auction of 10 Govt. animals of Sheep Breeding Farm Thathri (Doda) will take place on 16-05-2026 at 11 A.M in the farm premises of Sheep Breeding Farm Thathri. All the interested individuals/entities are informed to participate in said auction and offer their Bid. The successful party shall have to deposit the bid amount with the committee on spot.
The auction shall take place before the committee of Officers constituted by the department and sanction accorded vide Director Sheep Husbandry Department Jammu's No. DSHJ/Tech/14/2026-27/1945-46 Dated 11-05-2026. The decision of committee shall be final and binding. Other terms and conditions shall be made public on spot.
(Dr. Azhar Moomin Bichoo)
Assistant Director
Govt. Sheep Breeding Farm
Thathri District Doda
DIP No: DIP/J-1912/26

APPENDIX IV-A
Sale Notice for sale of Immovable Property
E-Auction Sale Notice for sale of Immovable Assets under the Securitisation and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 read with proviso to Rule 8(6) of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002.
Notice is hereby given to the public in general and in particular to the Borrower(s) and Guarantor(s) that the below described Immovable Property mortgaged to Sammaan Capital Limited (formerly known as Indiabulls Housing Finance Ltd.) [CIN : L65922DL2005PLC136029] ("Secured Creditor"), the physical possession of which has been taken by the Authorised Officer of the Secured Creditor, will be sold on "as is where is", "as is what is" and "whatever there is" basis on 15.06.2026 from 05.00 P.M. to 06.00 P.M., for recovery of Rs. 31,55,104/- (Rupees Thirty One Lakh Fifty Five Thousand One Hundred Four only) pending towards Loan Account No. HHLNOD00448525, by way of outstanding principal, arrears (including accrued late charges) and interest till 04.05.2026 with applicable future interest in terms of the Loan Agreement and other related loan document(s) w. e. f. 05.05.2026 along with legal expenses and other charges due to the Secured Creditor from VARUN SHARMA and PINKI SHARMA.
The Reserve Price of the Immovable Property will be Rs. 37,26,800/- (Rupees Thirty Seven Lakh Twenty Six Thousand Eight Hundred only) and the Earnest Money Deposit ("EMD") will be Rs. 3,72,680/- (Rupees Three Lakh Seventy Two Thousand Six Hundred Eighty only) i. e. equivalent to 10% of the Reserve Price.
DESCRIPTION OF THE IMMOVABLE PROPERTY
FLAT NO. SF - 3, M. I. G., HAVING TOTAL COVERED AREA OF 45 SQ. MTRS., SECOND FLOOR, WITHOUT ROOF RIGHTS, BACK SIDE (LHS), PLOT NO. 3/828, SECTOR 3, VASUNDHARA, GHAZIABAD - 201012, UTTAR PRADESH.
BOUNDED BY:
EAST : COMMON PASSAGE AND FLAT NO. S. F. 4
WEST : OTHERS PROPERTY
NORTH : PLOT NO. S. F. 2
SOUTH : PLOT NO. 3/929
For detailed terms and conditions of sale, please refer to the link provided on the website of the Secured Creditor i.e. www.sammaancapital.com; Contact No : 0124-6910910, +91 7065451024; E-mail id : auctionhelpline@sammaancapital.com. For bidding, log on to www.auctionbazaar.com.
sdl/-
AUTHORISED OFFICER
SAMMAAN CAPITAL LIMITED
(Formerly known as
INDIABULLS HOUSING FINANCE LTD.)
Date : 05.05.2026
Place : GHAZIABAD



NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

T.Notic No.GSU/Elect/PRYJ/E-Tender Notice/2026/65 Date : 11.05.2026
E-TENDER NOTICE
Dy. Chief Electrical Engineer/GSU/N.C. Rly/Prayagraj, for and on behalf of the President of India, invite the following E- Tender, the details of the tenders are as under :-
Tender No.: GSU-EL-WC-79-2026 **Advertised value :** Rs. 55174239.65
Description of work : Modification in 132 kv 3 phase double circuit transmission line due to construction of 02 lane ROB in lieu of LC-24,31,83,85 Spl and 86B between F.TP-TDL section in Prayagraj division of North Central Railway.
Bid Security : Rs. 1103500/- **Completion Period :** 12 Months
Bidding system : Single Packet
Tender Closing date & Time: 01.06.2026 & 14.00 Hrs
Tender opening date & Time: 01.06.2026 & 15:00 Hrs
Note:- 1. The complete information along with tender document of above E-Tenders shall be available on Website www.irops.gov.in 21 days prior to the date of opening of the tender. 2. Bids other than in the form of E-Bids shall not be accepted against above tenders. For this purpose, vendors are required to get themselves registered with IREPS website along with Digital Signature Certificate. 3. In case of any difficulty helpdesk available on the website of IREPS may be approached. 1054/26(AS)
North central railways | www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in | CPRONCR



NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

E-Tender No. PRYJ-Sig-404-2026-27 Dated: 11.05.2026
E-Tender Notice
Senior Divisional Signal & Telecommunication Engineer / Co-ordination/North Central Railway/ Prayagraj, for and on behalf of the President of India, invite E-TENDER on prescribed form for the following works up to 15.00 hrs. on 03.06.2026. The detail of the Tender is as under :-
S. N. 1 | Tender No.: PRYJ-Sig-404-2026-27
Name of Work: "Comprehensive Annual Maintenance Contract for Frauscher make MSDAC, installed in Kaurara-Chhipiyana & branch line section of Sr.DSTE/AL/N of PRYJ division for a period of one year."
Approx. Cost of work (in ₹): ₹ 67204496.61/- (₹ Six Crore Seventy-Two Lakhs Four Thousand Four Hundred Ninety-Six & Sixty- One Paise Only)
Bid Security/Earnest Money (in ₹): 1344100.00
Completion Period: 12 Months **Date of Closing of tender:** 03.06.2026
2. Availability of tender form: Tender forms shall be available on www.irops.gov.in 21 days prior to date of opening of the tender.
3. Earnest Money to be deposited: The prescribed amount of Earnest Money as mentioned above must be deposited along with the tender form Online through Internet Banking or Online Payment gateway only. The tenderer(s) should note that, in any case, the Earnest Money in any other form than specified above shall not be acceptable. Tenders without earnest money shall be summarily rejected.
4. Time, date & place of opening of tender: Tender will be opened through E-tender at office of Divisional Railway Manager, Prayagraj on or after pre-determined date at 15.30 hours. In case tender opening date happens to be holiday, Tenders will be opened on the next working day.
5. Validity of offer: 60 days from the date of opening.
6. Right of Railway to deal with tender: Railway administration reserves the rights to postpone/modify or to cancel the tender without assigning any reasons. 1064/26(DG)
North central railways | CPRONCR | www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

APPENDIX IV-A
Sale Notice for sale of Immovable Property
E-Auction Sale Notice for sale of Immovable Assets under the Securitisation and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 read with proviso to Rule 8(6) and Rule 9(1) of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002.
Notice is hereby given to the public in general and in particular to the Borrower(s) and Guarantor(s) that the below described Immovable Property mortgaged to India SME Asset Reconstruction Company Limited [CIN : U67190MH2006PLC181062] ("Secured Creditor"), the physical possession of which has been taken by the Authorised Officer of the Secured Creditor, will be sold on "as is where is", "as is what is" and "whatever there is" basis on 30.05.2026 from 05.00 P.M. to 06.00 P.M., for recovery of Rs. 15,35,584/- (Rupees Fifteen Lakh Thirty Five Thousand Five Hundred Eighty Four only) pending towards Loan Account No. HHLDMT00437526, by way of outstanding principal, arrears (including accrued late charges) and interest till 05.05.2026 with applicable future interest in terms of the Loan Agreement and other related loan document(s) w. e

CLOCK 4TH STRAIGHT YEAR OF PROFITS

PSBs FY26 net grows 11.1% to ₹1.98 lakh crore: FinMin

Aggregate operating profit reached Rs 3.21 lakh crore

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Public Sector Banks (PSBs) have recorded an all-time high net profit of Rs 1.98 lakh crore in 2025-26 fiscal year, marking the fourth straight year of profitability, the Finance Ministry said on Tuesday.

Improved asset quality, healthy credit expansion and higher income contributed to improved profitability of PSBs during 2025-26, the ministry said.

Aggregate operating profit reached Rs 3.21 lakh crore, while aggregate net profit increased by 11.1 per cent y-o-y to a historic high of Rs 1.98 lakh crore, marking the fourth consecutive year of aggregate profitability for PSBs.

The aggregate business of PSBs increased to Rs 283.3 lakh crore as on March 31, 2026, registering growth of 12.8 per cent over the previous year.

Aggregate deposits rose 10.6 per cent year-on-year to Rs 156.3 lakh crore, reflecting continued depositor confidence and strong resource mobilisation by PSBs.

Gross advances registered growth of 15.7 per cent year-on-year at Rs 127 lakh crore,



Aggregate business of PSBs rose to Rs 283.3 lakh crore as on March 31, 2026, registering growth of 12.8% over the previous year

indicating sustained credit demand across sectors of the economy.

“Public sector banks (PSBs) continued to register strong financial performance during 2025-26, reflecting sustained business growth, improved asset quality, record profitability and strong capital position.

“The improved performance demonstrates the resilience, stability and enhanced institutional capacity of PSBs in supporting the credit needs of a fast-growing Indian economy,”

Key Points

- » Aggregate business of PSBs jumped to Rs 283.3 lakh crore as on March 31, 2026, registering growth of 12.8% over FY25
- » Asset quality of PSBs improved significantly during 2025-26, with gross NPA ratio declining to 1.93%
- » Net NPA ratio to 0.39 per cent as on March 31, 2026, reflecting historically low levels of stressed assets

the ministry said in a statement.

Asset quality of PSBs improved significantly during 2025-26, with gross NPA ratio (non-performing assets) declining to 1.93 per cent and net NPA ratio to 0.39 per cent as on March 31, 2026, reflecting historically low levels of stressed assets.

Further, each PSB maintained provisioning coverage ratio of above 90 per cent, indicating prudent provisioning practices, improved underwriting standards, effective

risk management mechanisms and strengthened balance sheet resilience, the ministry said.

Fresh slippages continued to decline during FY 2025-26, with slippage ratio reducing to 0.7 per cent.

Total recoveries, including recoveries from written-off accounts, stood at Rs 86,971 crore, reflecting improved recovery mechanisms and better credit discipline across PSBs.

The continued improvement in the performance of PSBs reflects the resilience of the Indian economy and the Government's sustained reforms aimed at strengthening the banking sector through improved governance, technology adoption, enhanced credit discipline and wider access to formal credit. These measures have contributed to lower stressed assets, improved operational efficiency and stronger financial position of PSBs, the ministry said.

“Today, PSBs are well-capitalised, profitable and institutionally stronger, enabling them to effectively support India's growth aspirations and contribute meaningfully towards the vision of Viksit Bharat by 2047,” the ministry added.

Stock markets decline 2% on elevated oil prices, Sensex crashes over 1450 pts

The market capitalisation of BSE-listed companies eroded by Rs 16.77 lakh crore to Rs 4,56,02,981.70 crore (\$4.77 trillion) in four days

OUR CORRESPONDENT

MUMBAI: Equity benchmark indices ended lower for the fourth consecutive session on Tuesday, with the Sensex and Nifty tumbling nearly 2 per cent, as a spike in crude oil prices and uncertainty surrounding the West Asia conflict clouded markets' confidence.

Unabated foreign fund outflows and the rupee depreciating to a lifetime low also impacted investor sentiment.

Amid a widespread sell-off, the 30-share BSE Sensex tanked 1,456.04 points, or 1.92 per cent, to settle at 74,559.24. During the day, it dived 1,565.78 points, or 2 per cent, to 74,449.50.

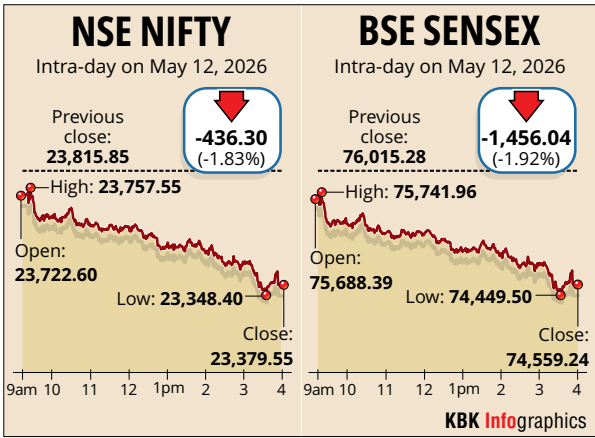
A total of 3,412 stocks declined, while 869 advanced and 129 remained unchanged on the BSE.

The 50-share NSE Nifty dropped 436.30 points, or 1.83 per cent, to end at 23,379.55.

The market capitalisation of BSE-listed companies eroded by Rs 16.77 lakh crore to Rs 4,56,02,981.70 crore (\$4.77 trillion) in four days.

In four trading days, the BSE gauge has tanked 3,399.28 points or 4.36 per cent, and the Nifty slumped 951.4 points or 3.91 per cent.

From the Sensex pack, Tech Mahindra, Adani Ports, HCL Tech, Tata Consultancy Ser-



From the Sensex pack, Tech Mahindra, Adani Ports, HCL Tech, Tata Consultancy Services, Titan and Bharat Electronics were among the major laggards. On the other hand, the State Bank of India was the only winner from the pack

vices, Titan and Bharat Electronics were among the major laggards.

On the other hand, the State Bank of India was the only winner from the pack.

In the broader market, the BSE MidCap Select index tanked 2.92 per cent, and the SmallCap Select index declined by 2.73 per cent.

Sectorally, realty dropped 4.22 per cent, Focused IT (3.61 per cent), services (3.51 per

cent), IT (3.37 per cent), consumer durables (3.35 per cent) and industrials (3 per cent).

Brent crude, the global oil benchmark, traded 2.75 per cent higher at \$107.1 per barrel, onment ahead,” he said.

Foreign Institutional Investors (FIIs) offloaded equities worth Rs 8,437.56 crore on Monday, according to exchange data.

In Asian markets, South Korea's benchmark Kospi,

Highlights

» A total of 3,412 stocks declined, while 869 advanced and 129 remained unchanged on the BSE

» The BSE MidCap Select index tanked 2.92%, & SmallCap Select index declined by 2.73%

» Sectorally, realty dropped 4.22%, Focused IT (3.61%), services (3.51%), IT (3.37%), consumer durables (3.35%) and industrials (3%)

» In four trading days, BSE gauge has tanked 3,399.28 points or 4.36%, Nifty slumped 951.4 points or 3.91%

Shanghai's SSE Composite and Hong Kong's Hang Seng ended lower, while Japan's benchmark Nikkei 225 settled higher.

Markets in Europe were trading lower.

US markets ended in positive territory on Monday.

On Monday, the BSE benchmark tanked 1,312.91 points or 1.70 per cent to settle at 76,015.28. The Nifty dropped 360.30 points or 1.49 per cent to end at 23,815.85.

Rupee falls 40 paise to record low of 95.68/dollar

MUMBAI: The rupee depreciated 40 paise to close at a fresh all-time low of 95.68 against the US dollar on Tuesday, as renewed tension between the US and Iran has led to risk aversion in global markets.

Forex traders said market sentiment remained dominated by fears that the 10-week-old conflict could further tighten global supply, particularly after President Donald Trump rejected Tehran's latest response to a US-backed peace proposal, calling it totally unacceptable.

Moreover, market participants interpreted Prime Minister Narendra Modi's comments over the weekend regarding fuel conservation and lower imports as a subtle acknowledgement that India's trade deficit and balance-of-payments pressures could worsen if crude prices remain elevated for longer.

At the interbank foreign exchange, the rupee opened at 95.57 and lost further ground to touch an all-time intraday low of 95.74 against the American currency.

The USD/INR pair eventually settled at a record closing low of 95.68, down 40 paise from its previous close.

On Monday, the rupee tanked 79 paise to settle at its record low of 95.28 against the US dollar.

Meanwhile, the dollar index, which gauges the greenback's strength against a basket of six currencies, was trading at 98.28, up 0.33 per cent. PFI

Sebi slaps ₹50 lakh fine on Kishore Biyani, others for failing to comply with disclosure rules

NEW DELHI: Markets regulator Sebi on Tuesday imposed a total penalty of Rs 50 lakh on three former officials of Future Retail Ltd (FRL), including Kishore Biyani for failing to comply with disclosure rules.

Apart from Kishore Biyani, who was chairman and managing director, other top executives of the company penalised by Sebi are former MD Rakesh Biyani and the ex-Chief Financial Officer (CFO) CP Toshniwal, according to an order passed by the Securities and Exchange Board of India.

Biyani was levied a fine of Rs 20 lakh each, while a Rs 10 lakh penalty was imposed on Toshniwal. The case pertains to violations of omitting the disclosure of certain related parties and RPTs (Related Party Transactions) in the annual report, or failing to seek approval from the



audit committee or shareholders, as applicable.

“This case is not a case of complete defiance but a case of partial disclosures,” Sebi said in its 202-page order. Sebi added, “FRL had repeatedly defaulted in disclosing the related party status and RPTs and in seeking the approval of the audit committee and the shareholders”.

It further said that noticees

No.1 and 2 (Biyani) are vicariously liable for this default and Noticee No. 3 (Toshniwal) is liable for abetting the default's occurrence. “Despite such persistent defaults, Noticee No. 1 and 2 have been placating the concerns of the Audit Committee, informing that everything was in order in FRL,” the order mentioned.

Through such acts, the offi-

Biyani was levied a fine of Rs 20 lakh each, while a Rs 10 lakh penalty was imposed on Toshniwal

cials violated the provisions of the LODR (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, and accordingly, Sebi imposed the penalty.

They have been directed to pay the fine within 45 days.

FRL is lingering on in the liquidation process before the NCLT. In July 2022, the NCLT admitted FRL to the Corporate Insolvency Resolution Process and appointed a Resolution Professional under the Insolvency and Bankruptcy Code, 2016. PFI

DSP MF launches Nifty FMCG ETF

NEW DELHI: DSP Mutual Fund on Tuesday announced the launch of DSP Nifty FMCG ETF, an open-ended exchange traded fund designed to replicate/track the Nifty FMCG Index.

The DSP Nifty FMCG ETF aims to help investors participate in few of the leading FMCG companies across categories such as household products, personal care, beverages and staples etc. by tracking the Nifty FMCG Index, subject to tracking error.

The Nifty FMCG Index comprises 15 FMCG companies listed on the National Stock Exchange* These include businesses manufacturing products that are part of everyday consumption across Indian households - from packaged

foods, beverages and personal care products to other daily-use essentials.

The FMCG sector has historically remained closely linked to India's domestic consumption growth and has demonstrated relatively resilient demand across market cycles. Unlike several sectors currently undergoing rapid technological disruption, demand for everyday consumption products continues to remain closely linked to household spending patterns.

The scheme will invest in the constituent companies of the Nifty FMCG Index in the same proportion as the underlying index and will be managed by DSP's dedicated passive investment team.

Commenting on the launch, Anil Ghelani, CFA, Head - Pas-

sive Investments & Products, DSP Mutual Fund, said, “Valuations in the FMCG space are currently below their 5-year, 10-year and 15-year averages, offering relatively better valuation comfort compared to recent years. At the same time, FMCG businesses continue to remain closely linked to everyday consumption demand, with growth driven by categories and products that are deeply embedded in daily life. Through the DSP Nifty FMCG ETF, investors can gain diversified exposure to this segment in a simple, transparent and cost-efficient passive format.”

The New Fund Offer for DSP Nifty FMCG ETF** opens on May 12, 2026, and closes on May 14, 2026. The scheme will reopen on May 22, 2026. MPOST

ITC's AI-based 'Crop Doctor' helps farmers in improving plant health for up to 70 crops

NEW DELHI: On the International Day of Plant Health, ITC highlighted the role of its ITCMAARS 'phygital' ecosystem in helping farmers detect crop diseases early and improve farm productivity through AI and machine learning-powered solutions.

Aligned with this year's theme, “Plant Biosecurity for Food Security”, promoted by the Food and Agriculture Organization (FAO) and the International Plant Protection Convention (IPPC), ITC said its AI-enabled 'Crop Doctor' tool is supporting real-time diagnosis of plant diseases and pest infestations.

Available on the ITC-



MAARS superapp, Crop Doctor covers 70 crops and has been used over 3 lakh times.

The feature uses AI-based image analytics to identify diseases and provides customised remedial measures, including chemical, biological and mechanical crop

management practices. Recommendations are offered in vernacular text and audio formats.

Launched in 2022, ITC-MAARS has evolved into a Farming as a Service (FaaS) platform integrating digital technologies with farmer producer organisations (FPOs).

The platform has benefited nearly 2.5 million farmers and 2,180 FPOs across 11 states. Pilot estimates indicate a 10-15 per cent reduction in fertiliser usage, a 15-20 per cent increase in crop yields and around 25 per cent improvement in farmer incomes.

The ecosystem also includes

ment (CEPA).

The CEPA with Chile aims to build upon the existing PTA and seeks to encompass a broader range of sectors, including digital services, investment promotion and cooperation, MSMEs (micro, small, and medium enterprises), and critical minerals.

The pact could help India access critical minerals, which are key inputs for electronics, auto, and solar sectors.

According to reports, Chile holds the world's largest lithium reserves and is the top producer of copper.

The bilateral trade between India and Chile is modest. In 2024-25, India's exports to Chile declined 2.46 per cent to just \$1.15 billion. Imports, however, grew 72 per cent to \$2.60 billion. PFI

Gold, silver prices jump as rupee slides to record low

NEW DELHI: Gold prices climbed Rs 1,500 to Rs 1.56 lakh per 10 grams in the national capital on Tuesday, and silver soared more than 4 per cent to Rs 2.77 lakh per kilogram, mainly due to a sharp fall in the rupee against the US dollar and firm domestic sentiment amid persistent geopolitical tensions.

According to the All India Sarafa Association, gold of 99.9 per cent purity increased by Rs 1,500, or nearly 1 per cent, to Rs 1,56,800 per 10 grams (inclusive of all taxes) from Monday's closing level of Rs 1,55,300 per 10 grams.

Silver prices also advanced

by Rs 12,000, or 4.53 per cent, to Rs 2,77,000 per kg (inclusive of all taxes). The white metal had settled at Rs 2,65,000 per kg in the preceding session, as per the association.

Meanwhile, spot gold slipped \$42.33, or 1 per cent, to \$4,692.64 per ounce while silver fell 3.04 per cent to \$83.49 per ounce in the overseas markets.

Brokerage firm Kotak Securities said spot gold retreated from a three-week high to trade near \$4,700 per ounce in international markets, and spot silver slipped below \$85, pressured by a firm dollar and rising Treasury bond yields. PFI

Tata Power Q4 profit rises 8% to ₹1,416 crore

Board has recommended a final dividend of Rs 2.50/equity share for FY26

NEW DELHI: Tata Power on Tuesday posted over 8 per cent rise in consolidated net profit to Rs 1,415.52 crore during the March quarter of FY 2025-26, supported by lower expenses.

It had reported a net profit of Rs 1,306.09 crore in the year-ago period, the company said in a stock exchange filing.

During the January-March quarter, the company's total income fell to Rs 15,455.48 crore from Rs 17,446.95 crore in the fourth quarter of FY25.

However, Tata Power trimmed its expenses to Rs 14,876.50 crore in Q4FY26 from Rs 16,179.77 crore in the

CLOSER LOOK

- » For full FY26, the company reported a net profit of Rs 5,117.56 crore, up from Rs 4,775.37 crore in FY25
- » However, total income dipped to Rs 64,171.66 crore for the full financial year from Rs 66,992.17 crore in FY25
- » Expenses for FY26 stood at Rs 59,401.41 crore, compared to Rs 60,367.67 crore in FY25

same period a year ago.

As per the regulatory filing, the company reduced its fuel cost to Rs 1,336.29 crore from Rs 3,720.35 crore in the fourth quarter of FY25.

The Tata group company's EBITDA increased 10 per

cent year-on-year to Rs 4,216 crore in Q4FY26. For the entire financial year, EBITDA rose 11 per cent to Rs 16,090 crore.

For the entire 2025-26 financial year, the company reported a net profit of Rs 5,117.56 crore, up from Rs

4,775.37 crore in the preceding fiscal.

However, total income dipped to Rs 64,171.66 crore for the full financial year from Rs 66,992.17 crore in FY25.

Expenses for FY26 stood at Rs 59,401.41 crore, compared to Rs 60,367.67 crore in FY25.

The board has recommended a final dividend of Rs 2.50 per equity share of Re 1 each for FY26.

In FY26, Tata Power supplied 49.52 billion units of electricity to the grid and its discoms supplied approximately 47.92 billion units to consumers. PFI

Dixon Technologies Q4 net profit falls 36% to ₹298 cr

NEW DELHI: Electronics manufacturing services firm Dixon Technologies on Tuesday reported a nearly 36 per cent decline in its consolidated net profit to Rs 297.97 crore in the fourth quarter of FY26. The company had a net profit of Rs 464.95 crore during the corresponding period a year ago, a regulatory filing showed.

During the quarter under review, its revenue from operations increased to Rs 10,510.51 crore from Rs 10,292.54 crore.

However, the company's

Its revenue from operations jumped to Rs 10,510.51 crore from Rs 10,292.54 crore

total expenses also shot up to Rs 10,230.77 crore, from Rs 9,981.92 crore a year ago.

The board of Dixon Technologies recommended a final dividend for the financial year 2025-26 at the rate of Rs 10 per equity share of the face value of Rs 2 each. PFI

India’s imports of Russian crude oil fall 15% in April

India imported €4.5 bn worth of crude oil from Russia in April, down from €5.3 bn in the preceding month

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: India’s crude oil purchases from Russia dropped over 15 per cent in April after the country’s buyer shut the refinery for routine maintenance, European think tank Centre for Research on Energy and Clean Air (CREA) said in a report.

India imported €4.5 billion worth of crude oil (raw material for making fuels like petrol and diesel) from Russia in April, down from €5.3 billion worth of imports in the preceding month.

CREA said India was the second-largest buyer of Russian fossil fuels in April 2026, importing a total of €5 billion of Russian hydrocarbons.

“Crude oil constituted 90 per cent of India’s purchases, totalling €4.5 billion. Coal (€297 million) and oil products (€209 million) constituted the remainder of their monthly imports,” it said.

In March, India imported a total of €5.8 billion of Russian hydrocarbons. That month, crude oil products constituted 91 per cent of India’s purchases, totalling €5.3 billion.

Coal (€337 million) and oil products (€178.5 million) constituted the remainder of their



‘India’s total crude import volumes recorded a 3.7 per cent reduction in April’

monthly imports.

“India’s total crude import volumes recorded a 3.7 per cent reduction in April. This is partially explained by a 19.4 per cent month-on-month decrease in Russian imports.

“There was a substantial change in the installations’ unloading of Russian crude, with Vadinar and Jamnagar refineries’ imports decreasing by almost 92 per cent and 38 per cent, respectively, while the state-owned IndianOil Vadinar’s increased by 87 per cent,” CREA said.

The decline in Russian crude imports by Nayara Energy’s Vadinar refinery

Highlights

- » In March, India imported a total of €5.8 billion of Russian hydrocarbons
- » That month, crude oil products constituted 91 per cent of India’s purchases, totalling €5.3 billion
- » Coal (€337 million) and oil products (€178.5 million) constituted the remainder of their monthly imports

was driven by maintenance-related shutdowns beginning on April 9, 2026, as the refinery runs exclusively on Russian feedstock.

Russian oil giant Rosneft is a major shareholder in Nayara Energy.

The state-owned New Mangalore and Visakhapatnam refineries had stopped Russian imports at the end of November 2025, but purchases resumed in March 2026 and continued into April, with Visakhapatnam’s Russian imports increasing by 149 per cent month-on-month.

The spurt in Russian oil imports in the last two months followed the US granting of a

sanctions waiver on Russian oil covering cargoes already at sea and shipments on previously sanctioned vessels.

The move was to ease prices that had spiked following Washington’s going to war with Iran.

The waiver led to state refiners, which had previously paused Russian oil purchases, resuming imports from Moscow.

CREA said from December 5, 2022, until the end of April 2026, China purchased 37 per cent of all Russian coal exports. India (19 per cent), Türkiye (15 per cent), South Korea (12 per cent), and Taiwan (4 per cent) round out the top five buyers’ list.

China has bought 49 per cent of Russia’s crude exports, followed by India (37 per cent), Türkiye (6 per cent), and the EU (5 per cent).

“Refineries using Russian crude in India, Türkiye, Brunei, and Georgia exported €760 million of oil products to sanctioning countries in April 2026. The importers included the EU (€145 million), Australia (€399 million), and the US (€216 million). An estimated €232 million of these products were refined from Russian crude,” the think tank said.

APSEZ to invest ₹13K crore in marine biz, enters Europe subsea market

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Adani Ports and Special Economic Zone Ltd is planning to invest Rs 13,000 crore by FY31 to build its marine business as the company expands into specialised subsea and ultra-deepwater operations in Europe through a partnership between its Astro Offshore platform and Oceaneering International Inc.

The company said its marine platform, Astro Offshore has entered into a contract with US-based engineering and applied technology company Oceaneering International Inc to pursue offshore and subsea opportunities in Europe, marking APSEZ’s entry into specialised deepwater engineering and underwater infrastructure services in the region.

As part of the expansion, Astro Offshore will add a 2021-built 97-metre DP2 multipurpose support vessel, Energy Savannah — to be renamed Astro Atlas — to strengthen its subsea construction and offshore execution capabilities.

The vessel, capable of operating in water depths of more than 3,000 metres, is equipped with a 150-tonne subsea crane, secondary crane, moonpool, and accommodation for up to 100 personnel, enabling offshore construction, cable laying and pipeline installation work.

APSEZ said the partnership combines Astro Offshore’s expanding fleet with Oceaneering’s remotely operated vehicle (ROV) and deepwater



‘As part of its long-term roadmap, APSEZ is targeting a 200-vessel fleet, along with marine revenue of Rs 6,000 crore and planned capex of Rs 13,000 crore by FY31’

engineering expertise as the company seeks to build one of the world’s largest integrated marine platforms. The company is targeting a 200-vessel fleet and marine revenue of Rs 6,000 crore by FY31 as it expands beyond ports into offshore logistics, subsea engineering and deepwater infrastructure services.

“As part of its long-term roadmap, the company is targeting a 200-vessel fleet, along with marine revenue of Rs 6,000 crore and planned capex of Rs 13,000 crore by FY31,” APSEZ said in a statement.

The development aligns with APSEZ’s strategy to build one of the world’s largest inte-

grated marine platforms spanning logistics, offshore support, underwater engineering, and deepwater infrastructure services. “This development supports APSEZ’s ambition to build a globally diversified marine platform,” Chief Executive Officer Ashwani Gupta said.

APSEZ said it has through its “marine platform Astro Offshore, has contracted with Oceaneering International Inc, a US-based engineering and applied technology company, to pursue specialised offshore and subsea opportunities in Europe”.

“The agreement marks a significant step in APSEZ’s expansion into ultra-deepwater operations and international markets, further supporting its strategy to build one of the world’s largest integrated marine platforms,” it said.

“For Astro Offshore, the introduction of Astro Atlas, the company’s first ultra-deepwater vessel, reflects its continued investment in strategically acquiring younger, high-spec vessels with advanced capabilities. This strengthens Astro’s ambition to operate one of the industry’s youngest and smartest fleets, while enabling entry into new offshore markets and supporting the broader growth ambitions of the APSEZ marine platform.”

By combining Astro Offshore’s expanding high-specification fleet with Oceaneering’s deepwater engineering and ROV expertise, capabilities in complex offshore operations are being enhanced while expand-

ing into Europe, said Gupta.

Mark Humphreys, CEO, Astro Offshore, said, “The introduction of Astro Atlas significantly enhances our operational capability and underscores our continued investment in a modern, high-spec fleet, particularly in ultra-deepwater environments. As our largest and most capable vessel to date, she enables us to support a broader range of complex offshore operations and respond more effectively to evolving client requirements.”

Subsea activities involve specialised underwater engineering critical to offshore energy and marine infrastructure projects, including cable laying, pipeline installation, underwater construction, inspection, maintenance, and intervention in deepwater environments.

These projects require advanced vessels, remotely operated vehicle (ROV) systems, and high-end operational capabilities. Astro Offshore has strengthened its deepwater fleet with the addition of Energy Savannah (to be renamed Astro Atlas), a modern 2021-built 97-metre DP2 multipurpose support vessel.

Equipped with a 150-tonne subsea AHC crane, a 25-tonne secondary crane, a moonpool, and accommodation for up to 100 personnel, the vessel is designed to support a wide range of offshore operations, including subsea construction, cable laying, and pipeline installation.

HZL & Group Nirmal ink MoU to set up wire mfg unit in Rajasthan

NEW DELHI: Vedanta group firm Hindustan Zinc Limited (HZL) on Tuesday said it has collaborated with Group Nirmal to set up a zinc wire manufacturing unit in Rajasthan.

Hindustan Zinc has signed a Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) with Group Nirmal to set up a zinc wire manufacturing facility at the company’s Zinc Industrial Park in Bhilwara district of Rajasthan, the company said in a regulatory filing.

The development further strengthens Hindustan Zinc’s long-term vision of building a robust downstream zinc manufacturing ecosystem in the domestic market focused on high-value industrial applications, said a company statement.

Under the pact, Group Nirmal will manufacture zinc wire products using Hindustan Zinc Limited’s special high-grade zinc, catering to sectors such as infrastructure, renewable energy, automotive and industrial engineering, the statement added.

Group Nirmal is a major manufacturer of steel, aluminium and zinc wires.

Zinc wire is a critical input material for thermal spray coating and metalising processes, where it is melted and sprayed onto steel surfaces to form a protective zinc coating. PII

Moody’s cuts 2026 India growth forecast to 6%

NEW DELHI: Moody’s Ratings on Tuesday slashed India’s GDP growth forecast for year 2026 by 0.8 percentage points to 6 per cent on subdued private consumption, capital formation, and industrial activity amid higher energy costs.

In its Global Macro Outlook May update, Moody’s said over the next six months, the impact from higher energy prices and fuel and fertilizer-related shortages will vary widely across countries, reflecting differences in exposure and resilience.

“The global outlook remains highly uncertain amid an increasingly prolonged confrontation and fragile ceasefire between the US and Iran. We estimate growth losses ranging from around 0.8 ppt for India,” Moody’s said.

For calendar year 2027, Moody’s slashed GDP growth estimates by 0.5 percentage points to 6 per cent for India,

reflecting lingering headwinds that gradually fade as shipping flows stabilise and energy supplies improve, allowing underlying economic activity to recover.

Moody’s said India is “particularly vulnerable” to high oil prices given its heavy reliance on imported crude and LNG. India imports about 90 per cent of its energy requirements.

As a net grain producer, agricultural exports will benefit in the near term from higher prices, but higher fuel and fertilizer costs would weigh on government finances, potentially constraining planned capital spending, Moody’s said.

Coal powers about 70 per cent of India’s electricity generation, while non-fossil sources (solar, wind, hydro) continue to expand. “Our central scenario projection of 6 per cent growth in both 2026 and 2027, following 7.5 per cent growth in 2025, reflects more subdued

private consumption, capital formation, and industrial activity amid tighter financial conditions and higher energy costs,” Moody’s said.

Persistently high energy costs would keep inflation elevated, compress profits, weaken investment and strain public finances, while major central banks remain on hold but ready to tighten financial conditions if necessary, it added.

The US-based rating agency said drawn-out negotiations between US and Iran, ongoing shipping blockades and the risk of military escalation threaten the truce’s durability.

Against this unstable backdrop, the global economy faces another potential energy and food-price shock, particularly if transit flows to and from the Gulf remain constrained, Moody’s said, adding the magnitude of growth and inflation effects hinges on the duration of

the Strait of Hormuz’s closure.

India imports 60 per cent of its LPG usage and of that, 90 per cent flows through the now-closed Strait of Hormuz. Several Asian economies are actively diversifying their supplier mix by expanding oil imports from existing partners and exploring new sources.

India is importing more Russian crude, while Japan and Korea are shifting incrementally toward US barrels, Moody’s said.

It also said economies face a mix of shared and idiosyncratic challenges from the fall-out. Strategic reserves offer only short-term protection as physical global energy shortages will become increasingly binding within months. Asia-Pacific is the most exposed region.

“China is partly insulated by its reliance on coal and renewables, while India remains vulnerable,” Moody’s said. PII

Adani Power Ltd secures CCI’s approval to acquire GVK Energy

NEW DELHI: Fair trade regulator CCI on Tuesday approved billionaire Gautam Adani-led Adani Power Ltd’s proposal to acquire GVK Energy.

GVK Energy Ltd, through its subsidiary AHPL, is engaged in the generation of power from a 330 MW hydroelectric power project in Srinagar, Uttarakhand.

“The proposed combination involves the acquisition of 100 per cent share capital and control of the target (GVK Energy Ltd) by the acquirer (Adani Power Ltd) pursuant to the corporate insolvency resolution process initiated under the Insolvency and Bankruptcy Code, 2016, in respect of the target,” the regulator said in a release.

Adani Power is a private thermal power producer and



operates plants spread across Gujarat, Maharashtra, Karnataka, Rajasthan, Chhattisgarh, Madhya Pradesh, Jharkhand, and Tamil Nadu, apart from a 40 MW solar power plant in Gujarat.

“CCI approves acquisition of 100 per cent share capital of GVK Energy Limited by Adani Power Limited,” the regulator said in a post on X. In a separate release, the Competition Commission of India (CCI) cleared the acquisition of a 7.14

per cent stake in Llyods Engineering Works Ltd by Thriveni Earthmovers Pvt Ltd.

Thriveni Earthmovers provides contract mining services, including exploration, drilling, mining, excavation, hauling, sizing, processing and transportation of minerals.

The regulator also granted its nod for the merger of three entities — Lloyds Infrastructure & Construction, Metafab Hightech and Techno Industries — into LEWL, which is the surviving entity, after the completion of the amalgamation.

“CCI approves the acquisition of 7.14 per cent stake in Llyods Engineering Works Limited by Thriveni Earthmovers Private Limited and merger of three entities into Lloyds Engineering Works Limited,” the anti-trust regulator said on X. PII

NSO revises March quarter, fiscal GDP data release date to June 7

NEW DELHI: The National Statistics Office (NSO) has revised the release date of the annual and March quarter GDP data to June 7 from the last working day of May.

In case June 7 is a holiday, the data will be released on the previous working day, as per a statement by Ministry of Statistics & Programme Implementation (MoSPI).

Consequently, GDP data for fiscal year 2025-26 and March quarter will be released on June 5.

The revision has been made after due consultation with the Advisory Commit-

tee on National Accounts Statistics (ACNAS) with a view to further strengthen the data quality.

“The National Statistics Office (NSO)... has revised the release date of the Provisional Estimates of Annual Gross Domestic Product (GDP) and Quarterly Estimates of GDP for Fourth Quarter (Q4) from last working day of May to 7th June (or the previous working day if 7th June is a holiday) of every year,” it said.

The need for revising the release date has arisen as certain critical datasets become available only after a lag of up

to two months.

In particular, the statutory timeline for filing audited Q4 and annual financial results by listed companies is 60 days from the end of financial year, resulting in a large number of companies furnishing their financial statements closer to the deadline of May 31.

Further, in respect of Central Government Accounts, key fiscal data relating to revenue expenditure, capital expenditure, taxes, subsidies, and interest payments for the month of March are finalized and become available only after a lag of two months. PII

NEW DELHI: Inflows into gold exchange-traded funds (ETFs) rose 34 per cent month-on-month to Rs 3,040 crore in April from Rs 2,265 crore in March, according to data released by the Association of Mutual Funds in India (AMFI).

In contrast, silver ETFs recorded outflows for the third consecutive month. Silver ETFs saw an outflow of Rs 126 crore in April, following outflows of Rs 683 crore in March and Rs 826 crore in February.

Nehal Meshram, Senior Analyst – Manager Research at Morningstar Investment Research India, said gold ETFs continued to attract net inflows in April 2026, though the pace remained below the exception-



ally strong inflows witnessed earlier in the year, particularly in January. He said the improvement in April flows reflected steady and incremental demand rather than a sharp rise in risk aversion.

Commodity-based ETFs remained largely flat during April. Gold ETFs declined marginally by up to 0.28 per cent, while silver ETFs gained up to 0.15 per cent.

Among the 26 gold ETFs active during the period, Nippon India ETF Gold BeES recorded the sharpest decline of around 0.28 per cent.

It was followed by Baroda BNP Paribas Gold ETF, Groww Gold ETF and Zerodha Gold ETF, which fell up to 0.27 per cent each.

Among the 18 silver ETFs, the category delivered an average return of 0.13 per cent. Aditya Birla SL Silver ETF gained the most at around 0.15 per cent, while Zerodha Silver ETF posted the lowest return of 0.08 per cent.

Viraj Gandhi, CEO of Samco Mutual Fund, said gold ETF inflows of Rs 3,040 crore remained below the FY26

monthly average of Rs 4,783 crore, indicating disciplined long-term investing rather than momentum chasing.

Umesh Sharma, CIO-Debt at The Wealth Company Mutual Fund, said ETFs and index funds continued to see strong inflows, while gold ETFs received moderate allocations, reflecting balanced positioning between risk and safety.

The assets under management (AUM) of gold ETFs rose 4 per cent month-on-month to Rs 1.78 lakh crore in April from Rs 1.71 lakh crore in March.

Silver ETF AUM increased 3 per cent to Rs 81,944 crore from Rs 79,805 crore in March, after declining 13 per cent in March compared with February. AGENCIES

India needs to build domestic risk capital, cut reliance on foreign fund: Uday Kotak

Speaking at a CII event, Kotak said a genuinely self-reliant country is the one that ‘does not need to depend on somebody else’s money or power’

NEW DELHI: Finance industry veteran Uday Kotak on Tuesday said India needs to reduce its dependence on foreign capital and focus on building a strong domestic pool of long-term risk capital to achieve true economic self-reliance.

Speaking at a Confederation of Indian Industry (CII) event, Kotak said a genuinely self-reliant country is the one that “does not need to depend on somebody else’s money or power.”

Referring to Prime Minister Narendra Modi’s call to celebrate weddings in India rather than overseas, Kotak said the message had a deeper

significance. “A true, truly Aatmanirbhar, self-reliant country is the one which does not need to depend on somebody else’s money or power,” he said.

Against the backdrop of global economic uncertainty triggered by the West Asia conflict, Modi had appealed to people to avoid destination weddings abroad, limit foreign travel and opt for work-from-home, a pandemic-era practice, wherever possible.

Kotak, who is the founder of private sector lender Kotak Mahindra Bank, said the global environment is becoming increasingly fragmented, with countries prioritising their own strategic interests, mak-

ing it imperative for India to strengthen its domestic economic foundations.

Calling it a “provocative” statement for a finance professional, Kotak said, “India has financialized too early.”

He said many companies have become excessively focused on quarterly earnings, stock prices and employee stock option gains, instead of building businesses with a three-to-five-year perspective.

“I would strongly urge companies to not be excessively focused on the short-term stock price... but think about building a company three to five years,” he said.

Kotak said India had relied

CLOSER LOOK

» Kotak said India had relied heavily on foreign portfolio investment (FPIs) for many years

» ‘It was Only after the pandemic did domestic investors begin to play a larger role in capital markets’

» According to Kotak, the rise of retail participation in mutual funds has helped create a domestic equity culture and provide a stable source of risk capital

heavily on foreign portfolio investment (FPIs) for many years and only after the pandemic did domestic investors begin to play a larger role in capital markets.

He urged companies to reinvest profits rather than simply managing large treasury

portfolios.

“Corporate India has got a phenomenal tax rate. What have you done with it? Are we reinvesting or running corporate treasuries?” he asked.

Kotak said governments are generally poor allocators of capital and suggested that

policy support should focus on encouraging fresh investments through additional investment allowances rather than relying solely on existing tax incentives.

He also stressed the need for India to strengthen its economic “balance sheet and P&L” by boosting domestic production, increasing exports and reducing import dependence.

“We need our balance sheet and P&L to be able to produce, or there will come a time when we will find it difficult to buy,” he said.

While acknowledging that India’s macroeconomic position has improved significantly, with a lower current account deficit and stronger foreign

exchange reserves, he warned that vulnerabilities remain, especially if oil prices rise sharply or foreign capital flows reverse. Kotak urged Indian businesses to move out of their comfort zones and focus on what they can do for the country rather than relying solely on government support.

He also advocated strengthening the country’s domestic private equity, venture capital and alternative asset ecosystem, saying these institutions are essential for funding entrepreneurship and long-term economic growth.

He said pension funds and insurance companies, which are accumulating large pools

of household savings, should gradually be allowed to allocate more money to private markets in a regulated manner with adequate safeguards.

Kotak highlighted the growing influence of mutual funds in reducing India’s dependence on foreign capital.

According to Kotak, the rise of retail participation in mutual funds has helped create a domestic equity culture and provide a stable source of risk capital.

“We have got domestic savings. If at all, our responsibility is... to make sure that mutual funds truly remain,” he said, stressing the need to preserve investor trust. PII

NOTICE

It is hereby informed to the general public that my minor daughter's previous name is Raunak Patel, whereas her correct name is Swara Umrao. Whose date of birth is 18/01/2012. To avoid any future problems, I want to have her name changed/replaced from Raunak Patel to Swara Umrao. Hence, from now on, Swara Umrao should be considered in place of Raunak Patel.

Rahul Kumar son of Sharad Chandra, resident of Vill- Paradan, Post Selavan, Tehsil- Bindki, Distt.- Fatehpur. U.P.

EAST CENTRAL RAILWAY
NOTICE TENDER

E-TENDER NOTICE No. SG-664-02/Tele-2026-27 Dhanbad, dt: 08-05-2026

E-TENDER IS INVITED ON BEHALF OF THE PRESIDENT OF INDIA FOR THE UNDERMENTIONED WORK.

1. Name of the work : 1) Provision of Communication Media for working of Block, Axle Counter and other telecum circuits on wireless channel at Bukru Station (BUKR)
2) Shifting of MTRC subscribers working over Dhanbad division from NR (New Delhi) MSC to NFR MSC (Guwahati). 3) Provision of station VHF communication recording facility at different Stations over Dhanbad.

2. Appox. Cost of the work : ₹ 5,81,53,617.09, 2. Earnest Money : ₹ 11,63,100.00, 4. Date & time for closing of tender : 01.06.2026 at (12.30 Hrs), 5. Any E-Tenders which is sent by Post / Courier / FAX or self, Manual proposals although the letter is on firms letter pad or received in time will not be accepted. The above E-Tenders, E-Tendering document alongwith full information is available on website i.e. <http://www.ireps.gov.in>

Note :- Tenderers are requested to visit the website <http://www.ireps.gov.in> atleast 10 days before last date of closing for latest corrigendum / corrections etc. in response to this E-tender.

Sr. D.S.T.E., Dhanbad
PR/208/DHN/S&T/IT/26-27/40

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr. P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Akash @ Ravi** S/o Bishan Kuamr Sharma R/o H. No. 313/1, Gali No. 3, Pandit Mohalla, Mandawali, Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence case FIR No. 117/2014 u/s 380/457 IPC at P.S. Mandawali, Delhi and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Akash @ Ravi** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Akash @ Ravi** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proceeding u/s 82 Cr. P.C. has been initiated in the case. Proclamation is hereby madae that the said **Akash @ Ravi** accused of FIR No. 117/2014 u/s 380/457 IPC at P.S. Mandawali, Delhi is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on **28.07.2026**.

By Order: **Sh. Sachin**
Judicial Magistrate First Class-03 (East)
Room No. 16,
Karkardooma Court, Delhi

DP/6242/ED/2026

OFFICE OF THE DEPUTY COMMISSIONER OF POLICE
NORTH EAST DISTRICT, SEELAMPUR, DELHI
Office No. 011-22829434, E-mail ID: dcp-northeast-dl@nic.in

PUBLIC NOTICE

The General Public is hereby informed that the following unclaimed Motor Vehicles of the different makes/models have been seized in u/s 66 Delhi Police Act, 1978 & proclamation has been done u/s 67 Delhi Police Act by the police stations of North East District, Delhi. If anyone has any claim on these vehicles, he or she may approach concerned police station within 21 days along with all relevant documents, providing the ownership to get the same released in his/her favour by adopting proper legal procedure. Failing which further proceedings for disposal of unclaimed vehicles would be done as per the procedure of law:-

THE LIST OF UNCLAIMED VEHICLES SEIZED U/S 66 D.P. ACT – 1978

S. No.	Police Station	DD No.	Date	Registration No.	Engine No.	Chassis No.	Type of Vehicle & Make
1	SEELAMPUR	93A	27/11/24	DL 13SU 7074	23791	00926	SCOOTY ACCESS
2	SEELAMPUR	09A	05/12/24	DL 13SS 1389	47255	05685	SCOOTY FASINO
3	SEELAMPUR	125A	10/12/24	DL 3SCK 5273	39089	38924	SCOOTY ACTIVA
4	NEW USMANPUR	43A	27/03/14	DL 1PB 3003	80207	33945	BUS
5	NEW USMANPUR	122A	02/04/21	DL 5SBD 1614	21962	04732	MOTOR CYCLE STUNNER
6	SHASTRI PARK	25A	26/09/24	DL 6SBL 1067	50960	51478	MOTOR CYCLE PULSAR
7	SHASTRI PARK	37A	24/10/24	DL 13SG 7544	07039	12512	MOTOR CYCLE PASSION
8	SHASTRI PARK	19A	23/10/24	HR 35H 7924	02388	01485	MOTOR CYCLE PASSION
9	SHASTRI PARK	65A	24/10/24	DL 5SAG 4357	12959	00663	MOTOR CYCLE SPLENDOR
10	SHASTRI PARK	58A	13/12/24	DL 5SCU 4811	08632	00048	SCOOTY NTORQ
11	SHASTRI PARK	65A	24/12/24	DL 14SF 9667	08650	82414	MOTOR CYCLE PASSION
12	SHASTRI PARK	68A	26/12/24	DL 5GD 2857	89766	89766	SCOOTY ELECTRIC PRAISE PRO
13	SHASTRI PARK	49A	15/02/25	DL 5SAW 6396	04989	04969	MOTOR CYCLE SUZUKI HAYATE
14	GOKALPURI	47A	17/09/24	DL 5SAG 1614	42157	24422	MOTOR CYCLE CD DELUXE
15	GOKALPURI	17A	30/11/24	UP 15CR 4879	34885	82713	SCOOTY JUPITER
16	GOKALPURI	47A	19/12/24	DL 5SAV 6973	04683	01356	SCOOTY MEASTRO
17	GOKALPURI	82A	27/01/25	DL 13S 7842	14437	11133	MOTOR CYCLE TWISTER
18	GOKALPURI	51A	15/02/25	DL 7SBZ 1013	63411	04798	MOTOR CYCLE DISCOVER
19	DAYALPUR	120A	07/09/24	DL 3SES 0712	67648	49028	SCOOTY BURGMAN
20	DAYALPUR	100A	20/10/24	UP 14CL 0556	17456	07725	MOTOR CYCLE PASSION PRO
21	DAYALPUR	99A	21/12/24	DL 6SAK 0740	04377	04336	MOTOR CYCLE PULSAR
22	DAYALPUR	135A	20/01/25	DL 5SL 3983	02050	01844	MOTOR CYCLE SPLENDOR
23	JYOTI NAGAR	32A	31/01/25	UP 14CQ 1116	47514	70898	MOTOR CYCLE PULSAR
24	JYOTI NAGAR	54A	22/02/25	DL 14SS 7896	00760	01375	SCOOTY JUPITER
25	KARAWAL NAGAR	116A	06/08/24	DL 14SD 3956	14386	11017	MOTOR CYCLE GLAMOUR
26	KARAWAL NAGAR	65A	03/02/25	DL 5SBA 5404	90802	91194	SCOOTY ACTIVA
27	SONIA VIHAR	33A	19/12/24	DL 5SDC 5717	10925	09255	MOTOR CYCLE SPLENDOR PLUS
28	SONIA VIHAR	38A	13/02/25	DL 13SF 6544	05575	03492	MOTOR CYCLE SPLENDOR
29	WELCOME	92A	26/09/24	DL 5SAF 1886	97673	10745	MOTOR CYCLE PULSAR
30	WELCOME	132A	13/12/24	DL 13SU 2400	56640	35617	SCOOTY ACTIVA
31	WELCOME	69A	14/01/25	DL 7SBK 3759	05270	61979	MOTOR CYCLE PULSAR
32	NAND NAGRI	60A	21/08/24	DL 6SAF 2758	13719	26300	MOTOR CYCLE PLATINA
33	NAND NAGRI	144A	10/12/24	UP 14EH 8560	30501	15891	MOTOR CYCLE SPLENDOR
34	NAND NAGRI	01A	19/01/25	DL 5SCR 9137	46797	12913	MOTOR CYCLE SPLENDOR
35	HARSH VIHAR	58A	23/11/24	DL 5SBX 8333	72614	72858	SCOOTY ACTIVA
36	HARSH VIHAR	83A	24/12/24	DL 3SCW 7811	04688	02670	MOTOR CYCLE PASSION
37	HARSH VIHAR	5A	29/12/24	DL 7SBG 9577	18917	17959	MOTOR CYCLE KTM
38	HARSH VIHAR	81A	11/01/25	DL 5SBG 9807	G9807	20494	SCOOTY AVIATOR
39	HARSH VIHAR	60A	20/01/25	DL 5SBJ 1018	09898	90511	MOTOR CYCLE SPLENDOR
40	HARSH VIHAR	24A	03/02/25	DL 9SAD 0023	71558	60422	SCOOTY ACTIVA

Sd/-
Addl. Dy. Commissioner of Police,
North East District, Delhi

DP/9876/NE/2026

SYMBOLIC POSSESSION NOTICE

ICICI Bank

Branch Office: ICICI Bank Limited Plot No-23, Shal Tower, 3rd Floor, New Rohtak Road, Karol Bagh, New Delhi- 110005

The Authorised ICICI Bank Officer under the Securitisation, Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 and in exercise of the powers conferred under section 13(12) read with Rule 3 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules 2002, issued Demand Notices to the borrower(s) mentioned below, to repay the amount mentioned in the Notice within 60 days from the date of receipt of the said Notice.

Having failed to repay the amount, the Notice is issued to the borrower and the public in general that the undersigned has taken symbolic possession of the property described below, by exercising powers conferred on him/her under Section 13(4) of the said Act read with Rule 8 of the said rules on the below-mentioned dates. The borrower in particular and the public in general are hereby cautioned not to deal with the property. Any dealings with the property will be subject to charges of ICICI Bank Limited.

Sr. No.	Name of the Borrower(s)/ Loan Account Number	Description of Property/ Date of Symbolic Possession	Date of Demand Notice/ Amount in Demand Notice (Rs)	Name of Branch
1.	Satnam Singh/ Divya (Deceased) Through Her Legal Heirs/ LBAMT00003391770/ LBAMT00002471349/ LBAMT00002471350	House Built Over Plot Private No. 15, Measuring 68.20 Sq. Yards, Comprised In Khastra No. 1260/694 Min. Khata Khatoni No. 239/592, As Per Jamabandi Year 2010-2011, Situated At Village Vadali Guru Urban, Within M.c. Limits, Abadi Kartar Nagar, Tehsil and District Amritsar, Punjab - 143001, Standing In The Name of Satnam Singh and Divya Vide Sale Deed Wasika No. 67, Dated 02/04/2014./ May 07, 2026	January 31, 2026 Rs. 20,30,013.29/-	Amritsar/ New Delhi

The above-mentioned borrower(s)/guarantors(s) is/are hereby issued a 30 day Notice to repay the amount, else the mortgaged properties will be sold after 30 days from the date of publishing this Notice, as per the provisions under Rules 8 and 9 of Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules 2002.

Date: May 13, 2026
Place: New Delhi

Sincerely Authorised Officer
For ICICI Bank Ltd.

SYMBOLIC POSSESSION NOTICE

ICICI Bank

Branch Office: ICICI Bank Limited Plot No-23, Shal Tower, 3rd Floor, New Rohtak Road, Karol Bagh, New Delhi- 110005

The Authorised ICICI Bank Officer under the Securitisation, Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 and in exercise of the powers conferred under section 13(12) read with Rule 3 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules 2002, issued Demand Notices to the borrower(s) mentioned below, to repay the amount mentioned in the Notice within 60 days from the date of receipt of the said Notice.

Having failed to repay the amount, the Notice is issued to the borrower and the public in general that the undersigned has taken symbolic possession of the property described below, by exercising powers conferred on him/her under Section 13(4) of the said Act read with Rule 8 of the said rules on the below-mentioned dates. The borrower in particular and the public in general are hereby cautioned not to deal with the property. Any dealings with the property will be subject to charges of ICICI Bank Limited.

Sr. No.	Name of the Borrower(s)/ Loan Account Number	Description of Property/ Date of Symbolic Possession	Date of Demand Notice/ Amount in Demand Notice (Rs)	Name of Branch
1.	Gaganmeet Kaur Bhatia/ Kamaldeep Singh Bansal/ LBDE00005743979/ LBFDB00005840885	Flat No. A7-808, Tower-A-7 8th Floor, Sector- 78, Habitat 78, Village Faridpur, Faridabad, Haryana, Faridabad- 121002, 08 May, 2026	January 30,2026 Rs. 20,07,303/-	Delhi & Ncr

The above-mentioned borrower(s)/guarantors(s) is/are hereby issued a 30 day Notice to repay the amount, else the mortgaged properties will be sold after 30 days from the date of publishing this Notice, as per the provisions under Rules 8 and 9 of Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules 2002.

Date: May 13, 2026
Place: Delhi & Ncr

Sincerely Authorised Officer
For ICICI Bank Ltd.

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

(SEE SECTION 84 BNSS)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person(s) **FARMAN @ PAYNDA S/o Yakub R/o J-270, Janta Majdoor Colony, Welcome, Delhi** has committed (or are suspected to have committed) the offence in case FIR No. **415/2018 U/s 392/353/337/411/34 IPC, PS Welcome, Distt. North-East, Delhi** and it has been returned to a Warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused person(s) **FARMAN @ PAYNDA** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person(s) **FARMAN @ PAYNDA** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation are hereby made that the said accused person(s) **FARMAN @ PAYNDA** of FIR No. **415/2018 U/s 392/353/337/411/34 IPC, PS Welcome, Distt. North-East, Delhi** required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before dated **12.06.2026 at 10:00 AM**.

By Order
Ms. Dipakshi Rana
Judicial Magistrate-First Class-03
Shahdara, Court No. 19
Karkardoom Courts, Delhi

DP/5936/NE/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 CrPc / 84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Vinay S/o Balwan, R/o H.No. 5-C/4, Vishnu Garden, Delhi**, has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 8148/25, U/S 305B/317 (2) Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, 2023, PS Keshav Puram, North-West Distt., Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Vinay** cannot be found, and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Vinay** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant);

Proclamation is hereby made that **Vinay** the said accused of **FIR No. 8148/25, U/S 305B/317 (2) Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, 2023, PS Keshav Puram, North-West Distt., Delhi**, is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **09.09.2026**.

By Order
Sh. Sanyam Jain
Judicial Magistrate First Class-04,
(North-West), Court No.-112, 1st Floor,
Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/6125/NW/2026
(Court Matter)

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

E-Procurement Tender Notice No. 15/2026 Dated : 08.05.2026

E-Procurement Tender Notice

On behalf of President of India, Sr. Divisional Materials Manager, North Central Railway, Prayagraj invites the E-procurement tenders:

Tender No. : 192581814A Qty. : 1141 Set

Description : 05 Watt VHF Digital Walkie Talkie Set.

EMD (Rs.) : 5,70,870/- Tender Opening Date : 02.06.2026

Note : 1. The complete information of above E-Procurement Tender is available on IREPS website i.e. <http://www.ireps.gov.in>. (2) Bids other than in the form of E-Bids shall not be accepted against Above Tender, for this purpose, Vendors are required to get themselves registered with IREPS website along with Class III Digital Signature certificates issued by CCA under IT Act-2000. (3) Rates entered into financial rate page and duly signed digitally shall only be considered. Rates and any other financial entity in any other form/letter head if attached by vendor shall be straight away ignored and shall not be considered. (4) Documents being attached should be signed on their body. The above tender notice has been uploaded on <http://www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in>. In case of any difficulty helpdesk available on the IREPS website may be approached. 1050/28 (C)

North central railways www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in CPRONCR

NORTHERN RAILWAY

Tender Notice

Invitation of tender through E-Tendering (E-Procurement Systems)

N.I.T.No. / 03/26-27/WE

Name of work with its location

(A) Provision of wooden flooring, false ceiling, tiles, doors, painting etc. in rooms/halls at 4th and 5th floor in Rail Bhawan and Renewal of certification (Indian Green Building Council Gold Rating) of Rail Bhawan Building, New Delhi in the section of SSE/W/RB under ADENE-III.

Approx. cost of work (A) Rs. 36654172.56

EMD amount (A) Rs. 733100.00

Completion period of work (A) 06 Months

Date and Time for submission of tender and opening of tender Closing date of tender on 02.06.2026 at 15.00 hrs.

Website particular notice board location complete details of tender can be seen and address of the office from where the tender form can be purchased etc.

Above tender available on website i.e. www.ireps.gov.in

No: 128-W/269/O.E.T/NIT No.03/26-27/WE/ Dated:-11.05.2026 1578/2026

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.PC.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person, namely, **Vikas@Nakka@Patta S/o Dhara R/o H.No. S-180, Mangolpuri, Delhi**, (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No.: 1007/2023, U/s: 25/54/59 A.ACT**, registered at **P.S.: Paschim Vihar West, Delhi**, and the warrant has been returned writing upon that the said accused person, **Vikas@Nakka@Patta**, cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person, **Vikas@Nakka@Patta**, has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said, accused person, **Vikas@Nakka@Patta**, **FIR No.: 1007/2023, U/s: 25/54/59 A.ACT**, registered at **P.S.: Paschim Vihar West, Delhi**, is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **11.06.2026**.

By Order
Sh. Ankit Karan Singh
Metropolitan Magistrate-08
(West) Room No.30
Tis Hazari Courts, New Delhi

DP/6272/OD/2026
(Court Matter)

Asset Reconstruction Company (India) Ltd. (Arcil)

Acting in its capacity as Trustee of various Arcil Trusts

Arcil office : The Ruby, 10th floor, 29, Senapati Bapat Marg, Dadar (West), Mumbai - 400 028.

Website : <https://auction.arcil.co.in>; CIN - U65999MH2002PLC134884

PUBLIC NOTICE FOR SALE THROUGH ONLINE E-AUCTION IN EXERCISE OF THE POWERS UNDER THE SECURITISATION AND RECONSTRUCTION OF FINANCIAL ASSETS AND ENFORCEMENT OF SECURITY INTEREST ACT, 2002 (SARFAESI ACT) READ WITH RULES 6, 8 & 9 OF SECURITY INTEREST (ENFORCEMENT) RULES, 2002

Notice is hereby given to the public in general and to the Borrower (s) / Guarantor (s) / Mortgagee (s), in particular, that the below described immovable property/ies mortgaged / charged to the Asset Reconstruction Company (India) Limited, acting in its capacity as Trustee of various Arcil Trusts ("ARCIL") (pursuant to the assignment of financial asset vide registered Assignment Agreements), will be sold on "As is where is", "As is what is", "Whatever there is" and "Without recourse basis" by way of online e- auction, for recovery of outstanding dues together with further interest, charges and costs etc., as detailed below in terms of the provisions of the Securitization and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 ("Act") read with Rules 6, 8 and 9 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002 ("Rules").

Name of the Borrower / Co - Borrower/s / Guarantor/s / Mortgagee/s	LAN No. & Selling Bank	Trust Name	Outstanding amount as per SARFAESI Notice dated 21.05.2021	Possession Type and Date	Date of Inspection	Type of Property and Area	Earnest Money Deposit (EMD)	Reserve Price	Date & Time of E-Auction
Borrower : 1. CYCLONE ENERGY PRIVATE LIMITED 2. MONA BHARTI 3. VIRENDER KUMAR BHARI	Loan Account No. HHLNOD00358059 Edelweiss Asset Reconstruction Company Ltd. ("EARC")	Arcil - CPS - IV - Trust	Rs. 23,23,798.18/- (Rupees Twenty Three Lakh Twenty Seven Hundred Ninety Eight and Paise Eighteen only) as on 31.03.2021 + further Interest thereon + Legal Expenses	Physical possession on 21.02.2026	Will be arranged on request	Residential - 20 sq. meters (covered area)	Rs. 2,15,000/- (Rupees Two Lakh Fifteen Thousand only)	Rs. 21,50,000/- (Rupees Twenty One Lakh Fifty Thousand only)	On 16.06.2026 at 06:00 P.M.

Description of the Secured Asset being auctioned : RESIDENTIAL FLAT BEARING NO. 106 - B, HAVING A TOTAL COVERED AREA OF 20 SQUARE METERS, SITUATED ON THE FIRST FLOOR, IN POCKET D - 1, IN THE RESIDENTIAL COLONY KNOWN AS "DDA COLONY", LOCATED IN KONDLI/ GHAROLI, MAYUR VIHAR PHASE - III, NEW DELHI - 110096, DELHI.

Pending Litigations known to ARCIL	Nil	Encumbrances / Dues known to ARCIL	Nil
Last Date for submission of Bid	Same day 2 hours before Auction	Bid Increment amount :	As mentioned in the BID document
Demand Draft to be made in name of :	ARCIL - CPS - IV - TRUST	Payable at par	
RTGS details	ARCIL - CPS - IV - TRUST, Trust Account No. - 57500001353101, HDFC Bank Limited, Branch : Kamla Mill, Mumbai, IFSC Code : HDFC0000542.		
Name of Contact person & number	Sanjeev Godara – 0124-6910910; +91 70654 51024 (auctionhelpline@sammaancapital.com).		

Terms and Conditions :

- The Auction Sale is being conducted through e-auction through the website <https://auction.arcil.co.in> and as per the Terms and Conditions of the Bid Document, and as per the procedure set out therein.
- The Authorized Officer ("AO") / ARCIL shall not be held responsible for internet connectivity, network problems, system crash down, power failure etc.
- At any stage of the auction, the "AO" may accept / reject / modify / cancel the bid / offer or post - pone the Auction without assigning any reason thereof and without any prior notice.
- The successful purchaser / bidder shall bear any statutory dues, taxes, fees payable, applicable GST on the purchase consideration, stamp duty, registration fees, etc. that is required to be paid in order to get the secured asset conveyed / delivered in his / her / its favour as per the applicable law.
- The intending bidders should make their own independent enquiries / due diligence regarding encumbrances, title of secured asset and claims / rights / dues affecting the secured assets, including statutory dues, etc., prior to submitting their bid. The auction advertisement does not constitute and will not constitute any commitment or any representation of ARCIL. The Authorized Officer of ARCIL shall not be responsible in any way for any third - party claims / rights / dues.
- The particulars specified in the auction notice published in the newspaper have been stated to the best of the information of the undersigned; however undersigned shall not be responsible / liable for any error, misstatement or omission.
- The Borrower / Guarantors / Mortgagees, who are liable for the said outstanding dues, shall treat this Sale Notice as a notice under Rules 8 and 9 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, about the holding of the above mentioned auction sale.
- In the event, the auction scheduled hereinabove fails for any reason whatsoever, ARCIL has the right to sell the secured asset by any other methods under the provisions of Rule 8(5) of the Rules and the Act.

Sd/-
Authorized Officer
Asset Reconstruction Company (India) Ltd.

Place : NEW DELHI
Date : 27.04.2026

Asset Reconstruction Company (India) Ltd. (Arcil)

Acting in its capacity as Trustee of various Arcil Trusts

Arcil office : The Ruby, 10th floor, 29, Senapati Bapat Marg, Dadar (West), Mumbai - 400 028.

Website : <https://auction.arcil.co.in>; CIN - U65999MH2002PLC134884

PUBLIC NOTICE FOR SALE THROUGH ONLINE E-AUCTION IN EXERCISE OF THE POWERS UNDER THE SECURITISATION AND RECONSTRUCTION OF FINANCIAL ASSETS AND ENFORCEMENT OF SECURITY INTEREST ACT, 2002 (SARFAESI ACT) READ WITH RULES 6, 8 & 9 OF SECURITY INTEREST (ENFORCEMENT) RULES, 2002

Notice is hereby given to the public in general and to the Borrower (s) / Guarantor (s) / Mortgagee (s), in particular, that the below described immovable property/ies mortgaged / charged to the Asset Reconstruction Company (India) Limited, acting in its capacity as Trustee of various Arcil Trusts ("ARCIL") (pursuant to the assignment of financial asset vide registered Assignment Agreements), will be sold on "As is where is", "As is what is", "Whatever there is" and "Without recourse basis" by way of online e- auction, for recovery of outstanding dues of together with further interest, charges and costs etc., as detailed below in terms of the provisions of the Securitization and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 ("Act") read with Rules 6, 8 and 9 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002 ("Rules").

Name of the Borrower / Co - Borrower/s / Guarantor/s / Mortgagee/s	LAN No. & Selling Bank	Trust Name	Outstanding amount as per SARFAESI Notices, both dated 02.09.2021 and 18.11.2021 respectively	Possession Type and Date	Date of Inspection	Type of Property and Area	Earnest Money Deposit (EMD)	Reserve Price	Date & Time of E-Auction
Borrower : 1. MANISH SRIVASTAVA 2. ANJANA SRIVASTAVA	Loan Account Nos. HHLDCP00326204 and HHLDCP00458483	Arcil - Trust - 2025-007	Rs. 19,74,703/- (Rupees Nineteen Lakh Seventy Four Thousand Seven Hundred Three only) as on 26.06.2021 + further Interest thereon + Legal Expenses and Rs. 6,35,651.36/- (Rupees Six Lakh Thirty Five Thousand Six Hundred Sixty One and Paise Thirty Six only) as on 17.11.2021 + further Interest thereon + Legal Expenses	Physical possession on 30.09.2024	Will be arranged on request	Freehold - 590 sq. ft. (super built - up area)	Rs. 2,50,000/- (Rupees Two Lakh Fifty Thousand only)	Rs. 25,00,000/- (Rupees Twenty Five Lakh only)	On 04.06.2026 at 05:00 P.M.

Description of the Secured Asset being auctioned : Property owned by ANJANA SRIVASTAVA : Immovable property and bounded as follows : PLOT NO. 4303 - FF/C, FIRST FLOOR (REAR PORTION), KHASRA NO. 362/1, 362/2, 363/2, 373/1, 375/1, 375/2, 376/1, 376/2, 377/1, 377/2 380MIN, RESIDENTIAL COLONY INDRAPRASTHA EXTENSION, OWNERS NO. II, T. P. SCHEME NO. 3 (PART - I), GANGA APARTMENT, FARIDABAD, HARYANA - 122901.

Pending Litigations known to ARCIL	Nil	Encumbrances / Dues known to ARCIL	Nil
Last Date for submission of Bid	Same day 2 hours before Auction	Bid Increment amount :	As mentioned in the BID document
Demand Draft to be made in name of :	ARCIL - TRUST - 2025-007	Payable at par	
RTGS details	ARCIL - TRUST - 2025-007, Trust Account No. – 57500001510599, HDFC Bank Limited, Branch : Kamla Mills, Mumbai, IFSC Code : HDFC0000542.		
Name of Contact person & number	Sanjeev Godara – 0124-6910910; +91 70654 51024 (auctionhelpline@sammaancapital.com).		

Terms and Conditions :

- The Auction Sale is being conducted through e-auction through the website <https://auction.arcil.co.in> and as per the Terms and Conditions of the Bid Document, and as per the procedure set out therein.
- The Authorized Officer ("AO") / ARCIL shall not be held responsible for internet connectivity, network problems, system crash down, power failure etc.
- At any stage of the auction, the "AO" may accept / reject / modify / cancel the bid / offer or post - pone the Auction without assigning any reason thereof and without any prior notice.
- The successful purchaser / bidder shall bear any statutory dues, taxes, fees payable, applicable GST on the purchase consideration, stamp duty, registration fees, etc. that is required to be paid in order to get the secured asset conveyed / delivered in his / her / its favour as per the applicable law.
- The intending bidders should make their own independent enquiries / due diligence regarding encumbrances, title of secured asset and claims / rights / dues affecting the secured assets, including statutory dues, etc., prior to submitting their bid. The auction advertisement does not constitute and will not constitute any commitment or any representation of ARCIL. The Authorized Officer of ARCIL shall not be responsible in any way for any third - party claims / rights / dues.
- The particulars specified in the auction notice published in the newspaper have been stated to the best of the information of the undersigned; however undersigned shall not be responsible / liable for any error, misstatement or omission.
- The Borrower / Guarantors / Mortgagees, who are liable for the said outstanding dues, shall treat this Sale Notice as a notice under Rules 8 and 9 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, about the holding of the above mentioned auction sale.
- In the event, the auction scheduled hereinabove fails for any reason whatsoever, ARCIL has the right to sell the secured asset by any other methods under the provisions of Rule 8(5) of the Rules and



Sonakshi Sinha reflects on her evolving choices

'System' is gearing up to bring a layered and emotionally charged narrative to the screen

OUR CORRESPONDENT

As stories around justice, morality and systemic power continue to resonate with audiences, Prime Video's 'System' is gearing up to bring a layered and emotionally charged narrative to the screen. Led by Sonakshi Sinha, the film explores how access to justice can shift depending on where one stands in society, while also diving deep into the emotional complexities of its characters. For the actress, the project stood out not only because of its world and themes, but also because of the depth of the character she plays.

Speaking about her character and its world in the film, Sonakshi shared, "What stayed with me the most was Neha as a character, she's layered, she's flawed and she's constantly evolving. And then the world of the film feels very real and relevant. The questions it raises about access to justice and how differently it can look depending on where you stand in society and that's what really



The film explores how access to justice can shift depending on where one stands in society

pulled me in." Over the years, Sonakshi has steadily moved towards roles that push her beyond conventional spaces, from commercial entertainers to more emotionally intense and morally layered characters.

Reflecting on that evolution, Sonakshi said, "I think it's been a very organic journey. 'Dabangg' was my introduction, 'Akira' allowed me to explore a very physical and intense space and 'System' is far more internal and layered. Over time, I've been drawn to characters that challenge me in different ways and right now I'm really enjoying exploring roles that have emotional depth and moral complexity."

BONG JOON HO'S FIRST ANIMATED FILM LANDS AYO EDEBIRI, BRADLEY COOPER IN VOICE CAST

Academy Award-winning filmmaker Bong Joon-ho's first animated film 'Ally' will feature the voices of Hollywood stars Ayo Edebiri, Bradley Cooper and many more. Dave Bautista, Finn Wolfhard, Alex Jayne Go, Rachel House and filmmaker Werner Herzog are also part of the cast, according to 'Variety'.

Neon, which previously partnered with Bong on the multiple Oscar-winning movie 'Parasite', has acquired North American rights to the film. 'CJ ENM', 'Penture Invest' and 'Pathe' have co-financed and will co-distribute the project.

Directed by Bong and co-written with Jason Yu, 'Ally' centres on a curious and endearing piglet squid living in the uncharted depths of the South Pacific Ocean who dreams of one day seeing the sun and



starring in a wildlife documentary. When a mysterious aircraft sinks into the ocean, she is thrust into an extraordinary journey alongside unlikely companions that take her all the way to the surface.

The film has been in development since 2019 and will be produced by Seo Woo-sik. It is expected to be completed in the first half of 2027 and released later that year.

Bong, also known for internationally acclaimed titles such as 'Memories of Murder', 'Mother', 'The Host' and 'Snowpiercer', last directed 'Mickey 17'. PFI

Anil Kapoor responds to criticism around 'Animal'

The actor said that the team approached the project with complete sincerity

Anil Kapoor recently opened up about the criticism surrounding Sandeep Reddy Vanga's 'Animal' and shared how deeply personal the father-son scenes in the film were for both him and co-star Ranbir Kapoor. Speaking to 'The Indian Express', the actor said that while people can have different opinions about a film after release, the team approached the project with complete sincerity. Reacting to the debates and criticism surrounding the film, Anil said that as actors, their responsibility is to honestly portray the characters given to them.

"As an artist and actor, you do your best for the character and the role. Nobody really knows before release what discussions or criticism will happen later," he said.

The actor added that the team worked very sincerely on the emotional core of the film, especially the complicated father-son relationship shown between his and Ranbir Kapoor's characters. Talking about the emotionally intense scenes in the film, Anil revealed that both he and Ranbir drew heavily from their own real-life experiences and family relationships.

"We dug a lot into our personal experiences. Ranbir's relationship with his father,



Anil revealed that both he and Ranbir drew heavily from their own real-life experiences and family relationships

my relationship with my son and my relationship with my father - all those dynamics came into scenes," he shared.

He further explained that while the dialogues may have been written differently, the emotional angst behind the scenes was very real for both actors. AGENCIES

THE RINGS OF POWER

Prime Video confirms Season 3

OUR CORRESPONDENT

During Amazon's annual 'Upfront' presentation, 'Prime Video' confirmed the early renewal of one of its flagship series, 'The Lord of the Rings: The Rings of Power', for a fourth season. Additionally, the premiere date of November 11, 2026, was announced for the eagerly awaited third season of the epic fantasy series.

"From the very beginning, this series has embodied the scale, ambition and cinematic storytelling that define Prime Video's biggest global series," said Peter Friedlander, Head of 'Global Television', 'Amazon MGM Studios'. "The extraordinary response from millions of fans around the world has made it clear that this journey through Middle-earth continues to resonate and that momentum has only grown heading into season three. We're thrilled to announce an early season four renewal and



The OTT streamer has also renewed its fourth season

continue our creative partnership with J D Payne, Patrick McKay and the entire exceptional cast and crew, who help us bring Tolkien's legendary Second Age to life."

"The Rings of Power" brings to screens for the very first time the heroic legends of the fabled Second Age of Middle-earth's history. This epic drama is set thousands of years before the events of J R R Tolkien's 'The Hobbit' and 'The Lord of the Rings' books and takes viewers back to an era in which great powers were forged, kingdoms

rose to glory and fell to ruin, unlikely heroes were tested, hope hung by the finest of threads and the greatest villain that ever flowed from Tolkien's pen threatened to cover all the world in darkness.

The series follows an ensemble cast of characters, both familiar and new, as they confront the long-feared re-emergence of evil in Middle-earth. From the darkest depths of the Misty Mountains to the majestic forests of the elf capital of Lindon, to the breathtaking island kingdom of Númenor, to the farthest reaches of the map, these kingdoms and characters will carve out legacies that live on long after they are gone.

Jumping forward several years from the events of season two, season three takes place at the height of the War of the Elves and Sauron, as the Dark Lord seeks to craft the One Ring that will give him the edge he needs to win the war, bind all peoples to his will and at last rule all Middle-earth.

Ben Kingsley, Max Minghella join 'White Lotus' season 4

Oscar winner Ben Kingsley and 'Industry' star Max Minghella are among the final additions to the cast of the fourth season of 'The White Lotus'. The new season of the Emmy-winning HBO series is set against the backdrop of the Cannes Film Festival. It is currently being filmed across Cannes, St Tropez and Monaco, with additional scenes in Paris.

Kingsley and Max Minghella, as well as actor Pekka Strang of 'Tom of Finland' fame, join as recurring characters.

The season's ensemble cast includes Vincent Cassel, Steve Coogan, Chris Messina, Kumail Nanjiani, Ari Graynor, Alexander Ludwig, AJ Michalka, Nadia Tereszkiewicz, Corentin Fila, Dylan Ennis, Caleb Jonte Edwards and Marissa Long. The guest cast features Chloe Bennet, Sandra Bernhard, Heather Graham, Max Greenfield, Frida Gustavsson, Rosie Perez, Ben Schnetzer, Laura Smet, Charlie Hall and Jarrod Paul.

Recently, Oscar winner Laura Dern, who previously collaborated with creator Mike White on his HBO comedy 'Enlightened', boarded the cast after British



The new season of the Emmy-winning HBO series is set against the backdrop of the Cannes Film Festival

star Helena Bonham Carter exited her role over creative differences.

Season four of 'The White Lotus' will follow the story of a fresh group of White Lotus hotel guests and employees over the span of a week.

According to 'Variety', this time around, the cast will be split into two rival film teams

competing at Cannes, with one group based at a grand hotel on the Croisette and the other at a hilltop retreat. The season is also expected to take aim at French customer service. For the first time in the show's history, two White Lotus properties will feature in the same season: the Aïres Chateau de la Messardière, serving as the White Lotus du Cap and the Hotel Martinez as the White Lotus Cannes.

Created, written and directed by White, the anthology series has previously been set in Hawaii (season one), Sicily (season two) and Thailand (season three), which aired from February to April 2025. PFI

CANNES FILM FESTIVAL 2026

A PLATFORM FOR 12 DAYS OF NON-STOP WORLD PREMIERES

The festivities kick off with the opening-night film, 'The Electric Kiss', a French period-comedy



The red carpet has been rolled out at the 79th Cannes Film Festival in the South of France. The French Riviera festival, to begin today, will include 12 days of non-stop world premieres before culminating on May 23 with the presentation of the Palme d'Or, the festival's top honour and one of the film industry's most prestigious awards.

The festivities kick off with the opening-night film, 'The Electric Kiss', a French period-comedy and the awarding of an honorary Palme d'Or to the 'Lord of the Rings' director Peter Jackson.

What isn't at Cannes has been as buzzed about as much as what is. Hollywood is largely

absent this year.

While blockbusters like 'Top Gun: Maverick' and 'Elvis' have touched down at previous incarnations, studio films this year have been either scared away by the possibility of a rocky reception or by the high cost of flying in A-listers to the Côte d'Azur. The closest thing on Cannes' slate is an anniversary celebration for 'Fast & Furious'.

Speaking to members of the press on Monday, Cannes artistic director Thierry Fremaux said Hollywood 'is reshaping' in the midst of Paramount

What isn't at Cannes has been as buzzed about as much as what is. Hollywood is largely absent this year

Skydance's proposed acquisition of 'Warner Bros. Discovery'. "I hope the studio films will come back," Frémaux said. Cannes has become better known for its lengthy standing ovations than its boos. This year, a long list of big-name filmmakers will have centre stage. Among the filmmakers set to unveil new movies are Pedro Almodovar ('Bitter

Christmas'), James Gray ('Paper Tiger'), Na Hong-jin ('Hope'), Pawel Pawlikowski ('Fatherland') and Ryusuke Hamaguchi ('All of a Sudden').

If Cannes has waned as a global launchpad for studio releases, it has grown as a breeding ground for Oscar contenders. Two years ago, Sean Baker's 'Anora' won the Palme d'Or in Cannes before

winning 'Best Picture'. Last year, Cannes selections like 'Sentimental Value', 'The Secret Agent' and 'It Was Just an Accident' went on to play prominent roles in awards season.

More often than not, the speciality distributor 'Neon' has been at the forefront of the Cannes-to-Oscars pipeline. 'Neon' has backed the past six Palme d'Or winners, an unprecedented streak that it may be poised to extend. 'Neon' is attached to more than a quarter of the 22 films in competition for the Palme d'Or. AGENCIES